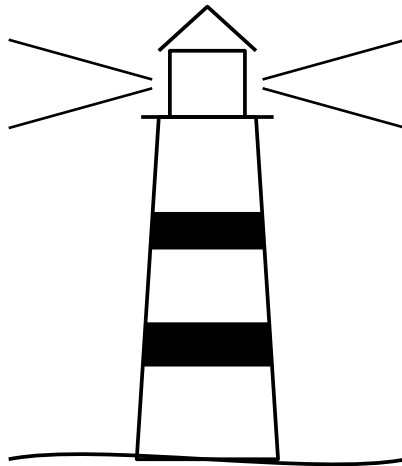


THE THIMBLE HARBOR PUZZLE SCHOOL · BOOK 1

Cozy Mystery Logic Puzzles for Beginners



100 Large Print Whodunit Grid Puzzles from Easy to
Expert, with Step-by-Step Lessons, 3 Hints per Puzzle,
and Every Solution Explained

Ivan Sikuten

Cozy Mystery Logic Puzzles for Beginners

The Thimble Harbor Puzzle School, Book 1

Copyright © 2026 Ivan Sikuten. All rights reserved.

No part of this book may be reproduced without written permission, except that the blank grids and the Scratch Pad pages may be copied for your own personal use.

This is a work of fiction. Thimble Harbor and everyone in it are invented; any resemblance to real people or places is coincidence.

Every puzzle in this book was checked by computer to have exactly one solution, and every solution was checked step by step against the clues.

First edition.

Contents

A Letter from Ada	iv
How This Book Works	v
Welcome to Thimble Harbor	viii
Chapter 1: First Clues	1
Lesson 1: Your First Grid	2
Chapter 2: The Full Grid	17
Lesson 2: The Staircase Grid	18
Chapter 3: First, Next, Last	55
Lesson 3: Lining Up	56
Chapter 4: Truth or Fib?	85
Lesson 4: Truth or Fib?	86
Chapter 5: Two Clues at Once	101
Lesson 5: Clues That Team Up	102
Chapter 6: Case Files	147
Lesson 6: One Careful Suppose	148
Chapter 7: The Lighthouse Affair	187
Putting It All Together	198
Hints	199
Solutions	225
Puzzle Index and Tracker	298
Clue Language at a Glance	302
Common Mistakes and Quick Repairs	304
Make Your Own Puzzle	305
Blank Grids	306
Your Certificate	310

A Letter from Ada

Welcome to the puzzle desk.

For forty-one years I edited the puzzle page of the *Thimble Harbor Gazette*. I am retired now, which in this town means I still come in every morning, I still keep a sharp pencil and a tin of lemon drops in the top drawer, and I still have opinions about clues.

What I need is an apprentice. That is you.

You do not need to be good at math. You do not need to have solved a logic puzzle before. If you can read a sentence carefully and keep track of what it does and does not say, you can solve every puzzle in this book. I will show you how, one small idea at a time.

Here is how we will work. Each of the first six chapters starts with a short lesson. Then come the puzzles, from gentle to genuinely tricky. When you get stuck, and you will, the hints at the back of the book come in small steps, so you can take only as much help as you need. Every solution explains the reasoning, not just the answer.

Along the way you will get to know the town. Somebody peeled the labels off the jams at the church supper. Somebody let a goat into the pie tent. And this winter, something will go missing from the lighthouse that nobody can explain. By then, you will be ready for it.

Sharpen your pencil, partner. We start with three neighbors and three pies.

Ada Quill Puzzle Editor (retired), the *Thimble Harbor Gazette*

How This Book Works

The puzzles

Each puzzle gives you a short story, a list of clues, and a grid or table to fill in. Every clue is true. Together, the clues lead to exactly one answer. You never need to guess, and you never need outside knowledge.

Every puzzle in this book was checked by computer to make sure it has one solution and only one.

The grid and its two marks

Each square in the grid asks a yes-or-no question, such as “Did Gus bring the cherry pie?”

- Put an **X** ✕ in a square when you know the answer is no.
- Put a **dot** ● in a square when you know the answer is yes.
- Leave a square **blank** while you are not sure. A blank square means undecided.

Lesson 1 shows you exactly how it works.

The stars

The stars at the top of each puzzle tell you how hard it is.

- One star: small grids. Read a clue, mark it, and fill in the only choice left.
- Two stars: bigger grids and first line-ups. Carry facts from one box to another.

- Three stars: order and number clues you come back to as the grid fills in, and truth-or-fib puzzles.
- Four stars: two clues working together, and many careful steps.
- Five stars: you will need one careful “Suppose” (Lesson 6).

The tick boxes

Each clue has a small box beside it. Tick it when you have used everything that clue can tell you. At the top of each puzzle you will also find a place to record that you solved it, how many hints you used, and how long it took. None of this is required. Some people like a record.

When you get stuck

The hints are at the back of the book, in separate sections so you cannot spoil the next step by accident. The page numbers are printed at the bottom of every puzzle page.

1. **Step 1, Where to Look**, points you at the right clue or row.
2. **Step 2, What to Notice**, tells you what that clue is really saying.
3. **Step 3, The Key Step**, spells out the turning point of the puzzle.
4. **Stuck Halfway?** For four- and five-star puzzles, a push through the middle.

Take one hint, then go back to the puzzle and try again. That is how the skill grows.

The solutions

Each solution starts with the finished answer table, so you can check your grid at a glance. Below it you will find the key idea and the reasoning in a few plain steps, and then what really happened in the story.

A few tools

A pencil with a good eraser. A quiet half hour. That is all. If you want to work a puzzle twice, there are blank grids at the back of the book, and Scratch Pad pages between the puzzles.

Welcome to Thimble Harbor

Thimble Harbor sits on a crooked thumb of the New England coast. It has one main street, one ferry, one lighthouse, and far too many opinions about pie.

At the tip of the point stands **Thimble Point Light**, built in 1876. It retired from guiding ships long ago, but this year its brass Keeper's Lamp turns one hundred and fifty, and the whole town is planning a party for it.

You will meet these neighbors again and again.

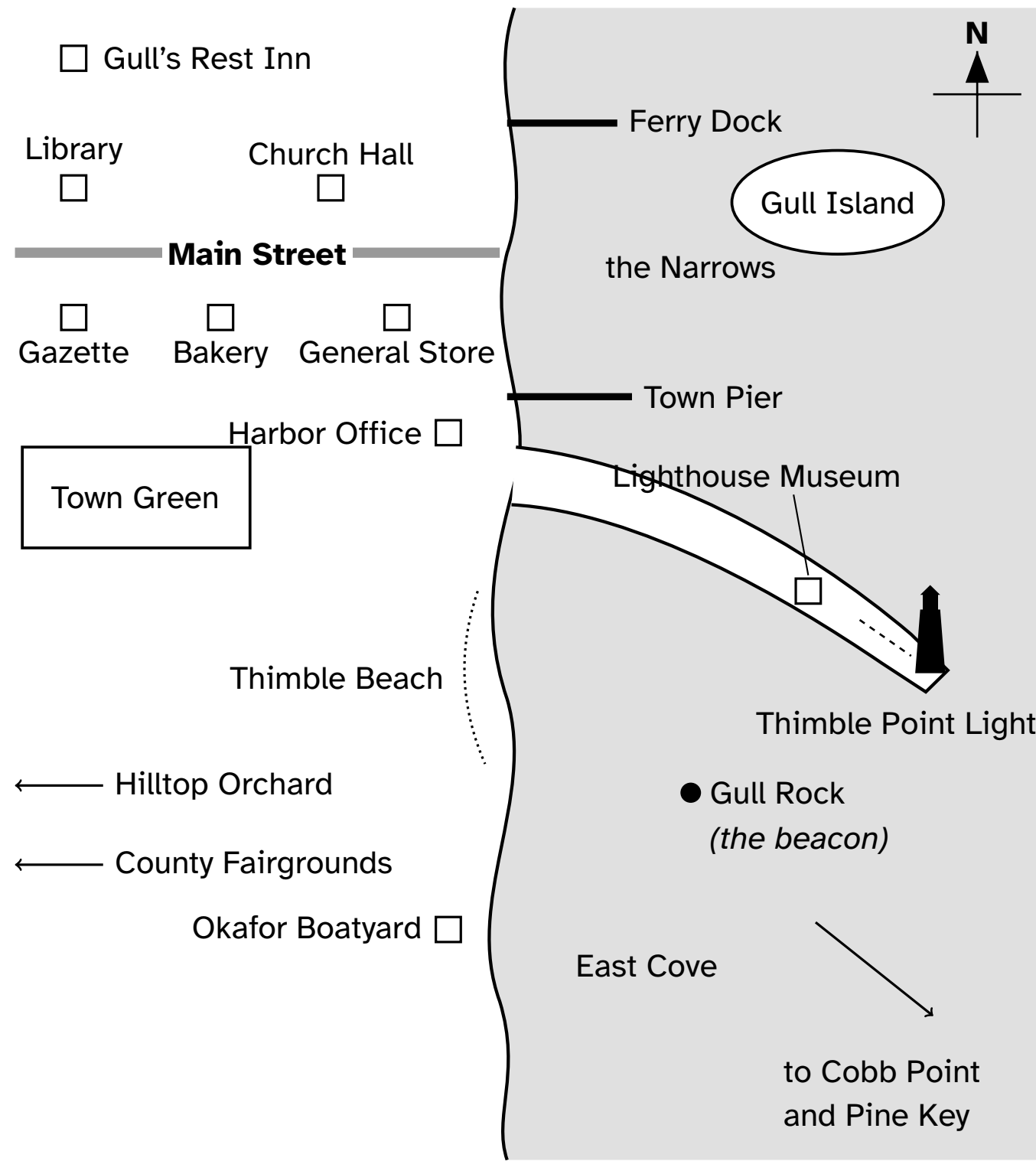
- **Hattie Pruitt** runs every supper and rummage sale at St. Brendan's Church Hall, with a clipboard listing her other lists.
- **Rosa Delgado** bakes at the Salt & Sugar Bakery and gives each of her sourdough starters a name and a birthday.
- **Otis Lund**, the harbormaster, whistles sea shanties slightly off-key and guards the spare lighthouse key.
- **Wren Takahashi**, the librarian, whispers even outdoors and remembers you by your overdue books.
- **Felix Okafor** builds boats at Okafor Boatyard and calls everything "shipshape."
- **Gus Mahoney** runs the general store and forecasts the weather by his left knee.
- **Priya Nair** keeps the Gull's Rest Inn and returns every one of its forty-one lost umbrellas.
- **Jonah**, the ferry captain, is never a minute late and tinkers with old brass in his workshop.

- **Mabel Fitch**, retired schoolteacher, corrects the grammar on signs and grows competitive dahlias.
- **Teddy Sousa** delivers the *Gazette* by bicycle and never goes anywhere without his camera.
- **Lena Kowalski** runs the lighthouse museum and wears white gloves to touch anything older than she is.
- **Nico Papas** catches lobsters and tells tall tales. The lobster gets bigger every time.

You will also meet **Inkwell**, the *Gazette*'s gray cat, who is suspected of everything and guilty of nothing, and **Pilot**, Jonah's old beagle, who rides the ferry in a small orange life vest.

Everyone else in these pages is a friend, a visitor, or a neighbor passing through. Nobody in this town is real, and every one of them could use your help.

Map of Thimble Harbor



CHAPTER 1

First Clues

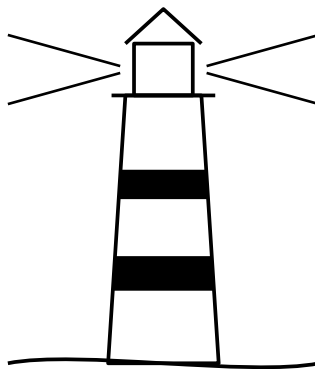
You will learn: Reading a clue, marking O and X, and the only choice left

Difficulty up to ★☆☆☆☆

Puzzles 1-10

April in Thimble Harbor. The rain is warm, the tulips are in, and the lighthouse has opened for the season. The town's troubles are small ones: a muddle of umbrellas, a lost glove, a mix-up at the seed swap.

They are the perfect place to start. Each puzzle has one list of names and one list of things to match. Read a clue, mark it, and look for the only choice left. Lesson 1, on the next page, shows you how.



LESSON 1

Your First Grid

Three neighbors, Hattie, Gus and Wren, each brought one pie to the spring bake sale at the church hall: apple, cherry or peach. Nobody brought two, and no two brought the same kind. Here are the clues.

- ☐ **1.** Gus brought the cherry pie.
- ☐ **2.** Wren did not bring the apple pie.

The grid

The names run down the side. The pies run across the top. Each square asks one question: does this person go with this pie? Right now every square is blank, and blank means undecided.

		Pie		
		apple	cherry	peach
Name	Hattie			
	Gus			
	Wren			

Nothing is decided yet.

Two marks

- An **X** ✕ means no.
- A **dot** ● means yes.

Clue 1: a yes

“Gus brought the cherry pie.” Put a dot where Gus’s row meets the cherry column.

Now the useful part. Gus brought only one pie, so the other squares in his row are X’s. And only one person brought the cherry pie, so the other squares in the cherry column are X’s too.

One dot brings its X’s with it. Every time you place a dot, cross out the rest of its row and the rest of its column.

		Pie		
		apple	cherry	peach
Name	Hattie		✕	
	Gus	✕	●	✕
	Wren		✕	

Clue 1 gives one dot and four X’s.

Clue 2: a no

“Wren did not bring the apple pie.” That is an X where Wren meets apple.

The only choice left

Look at Wren's row. Apple has an X from clue 2. Cherry has an X from clue 1. Only peach is left, so Wren brought the peach pie. Then Hattie's row has one blank square left: apple.

		Pie		
		apple	cherry	peach
Name	Hattie		X	
	Gus	X	●	X
	Wren	X	X	

Clue 2 adds an X.

		Pie		
		apple	cherry	peach
Name	Hattie	●	X	X
	Gus	X	●	X
	Wren	X	X	●

One choice left in each row.

So Hattie brought apple, Gus brought cherry, and Wren brought peach. Every clue is true, and every row and column has exactly one dot. That is how you know you are done.

Other clue words

- “Wren brought **either** the apple **or** the peach pie.” Wren goes with one of those two. Put an X on every other pie in Wren’s row.
- “Wren brought **neither** the apple **nor** the peach pie.” Two X’s, one for each.
- “The apple pie’s baker is not Hattie.” The same as “Hattie did not bring the apple pie.” Clues can name a person from either side.

A blank square means undecided. Never fill one in because it feels right. Fill it in because a clue, or the rest of its row, leaves no other choice.

1 Ada's Welcome Tea

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Ada Quill edited the Gazette's puzzle page for forty-one years, and this morning she put the kettle on at the puzzle desk to welcome her new apprentice: you. Three neighbors dropped by to say hello, and each chose a different tea. "Your first assignment, partner, is to remember who drinks what," Ada says, handing you a sharp pencil. Who drank which tea?

- ☐ 1. Teddy did not choose the mint tea.
- ☐ 2. Lena drank neither the mint nor the chamomile.

		Tea		
		Earl Grey	mint	chamomile
Guest	Teddy			
	Una			
	Lena			

Ada's tip: Mark every X a clue gives you first; the dot is usually waiting where the X's run out.

2 The Seed Swap Envelopes

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

April showers moved the library's spring seed swap indoors, and three gardeners left envelopes of saved seeds on the returns cart. Then someone opened the front door, and a draft sent every label skating under the shelves. Wren, who can recite every overdue book in town, whispers that each thank-you note must reach the right gardener. Who brought which seeds?

- ☐ 1. Rosa's envelope held either marigold or sweet pea seeds.
- ☐ 2. The sweet pea seeds came from Hugo.

		Seeds		
		zinnia	sweet pea	marigold
Gardener	Rosa			
	Della			
	Hugo			

Ada's tip: An either-or clue is a row of X's in disguise: cross out everything but the two choices.

3 The Lunch Pail Mix-Up

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

When the noon whistle blew at Okafor Boatyard, three workers reached for their lunch pails, which had spent the morning side by side on one sawhorse. The pails are identical, and nobody thought to label them. Felix pulls a pencil from behind one ear, calls the whole business “not shipshape,” and says he would like to eat his own lunch, thank you. Who packed which lunch?

- ☐ 1. The chowder was in either Ivan’s pail or Tova’s.
- ☐ 2. Tova’s pail held the egg salad.

		Lunch		
		chowder	egg salad	meatloaf
Worker	Felix			
	Tova			
	Ivan			

Ada’s tip: When a clue starts with the lunch instead of the person, read down that lunch’s column.

4 The Rummage Sale Hats

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Hattie Pruitt’s spring rummage sale runs on lists: a list of tables, a list of volunteers, and a list of her other lists. So when three hats turned up in the donation box without a single donor slip, the clipboard came out at once. Every donor gets a handwritten thank-you card, and Hattie does not guess. Who gave which hat?

- ☐ 1. Either Pearl or Linus gave the sou’wester.
- ☐ 2. The beret came from Pearl.

		Hat		
		sou’wester	straw hat	beret
Donor	Otis			
	Linus			
	Pearl			

Ada’s tip: Check your finished grid against every clue before you call it done.

5 The New Paper Route

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

On his first morning delivering the Gazette, Teddy Sousa pedaled down Main Street with his camera bouncing on his back, and three customers each asked for a little extra with tomorrow's paper. He was sure he would remember, so he wrote nothing down. He did not remember. Can you help him get the right extra to the right porch?

- ☐ 1. Either Sam or Amara asked for the tide table.
- ☐ 2. Neither Nico nor Sam asked for the coupons.

		Extra		
		tide table	puzzle book	coupons
Customer	Nico			
	Amara			
	Sam			

Ada's tip: A neither-nor clue is generous: two X's for the price of one clue.

6 The Muddled Umbrellas

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Gus’s left knee called for rain, and the knee was right: four people ducked into the Gull’s Rest Inn for breakfast, and when the sun came out, all four left without their umbrellas. Priya Nair already keeps forty-one lost umbrellas, and she has no intention of making it forty-five. She means to return every one before the noon ferry. Whose umbrella is whose?

- ☐ 1. The polka-dot umbrella was not Gus’s.
- ☐ 2. Mabel’s umbrella was the plaid one.
- ☐ 3. Kit’s umbrella was neither the yellow one nor the polka-dot one.

		Umbrella			
		plaid	yellow	polka-dot	navy
Guest	Mabel				
	Gus				
	Kit				
	Oscar				

Ada’s tip: Each time a dot goes in, cross out the rest of its row and column before reading on.

7

Opening Day at the Light

☆☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○ Time _____

Thimble Point Light opened for the season on a blustery April Saturday, and Lena Kowalski, white gloves and all, made an announcement from the top step. The 1876 Keeper’s Lamp, a ceremonial light since the lighthouse retired from guiding ships, turns 150 this year: it will shine every evening of Lantern Festival week and get a birthday lighting on Festival night. Four volunteers each took one opening-day job. Who did which job?

- ☐ 1. Imani ran the ticket desk.
- ☐ 2. Jonah’s job was either the gift shop or the tours.
- ☐ 3. Faye ran neither the tours nor the cocoa stand.

		Job			
		ticket desk	gift shop	tours	cocoa stand
Volunteer	Jonah				
	Imani				
	Boris				
	Faye				

8 The Sourdough Adoption

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Rosa Delgado’s Saturday bread class ended the way all her classes end: with jars. Each of four students carried home a jar of her sourdough starter, and every starter, naturally, came with its own name and a birthday. Now Rosa cannot remember which starter went home with whom, and she worries about them the way other people worry about puppies. Can you work out who adopted which starter and set her mind at rest?

- ☐ 1. Bubbles went home with either Enzo or Quinn.
- ☐ 2. Wren’s jar held either Admiral or Barnacle.
- ☐ 3. Quinn adopted Barnacle.

		Starter			
		Bubbles	Admiral	Pip	Barnacle
Student	Wren				
	Dev				
	Quinn				
	Enzo				

9 The Tulip Planting Gloves

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

The garden club planted four hundred tulip bulbs on the town green, and when the last bulb went in, four pairs of muddy gloves stayed behind on the bandstand bench. Mabel Fitch, club president and retired schoolteacher, has already written four polite notes about putting things away. Now she needs to know whose name goes on each envelope. Who wore which gloves?

- ☐ 1. Olive's gloves were either the floral ones or the striped ones.
- ☐ 2. Neither Priya nor Zeke wore the floral gloves.
- ☐ 3. The green gloves belonged to neither Zeke nor Cass.
- ☐ 4. Either Cass or Olive wore the leather gloves.

		Gloves			
		green	floral	leather	striped
Gardener	Priya				
	Zeke				
	Olive				
	Cass				

10 The Unsigned Letters

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Four letters to the editor landed on the Gazette's front counter this week, each on a different burning issue of the day, and not one of them was signed. The Gazette never prints an unsigned letter, so Ada lifted Inkwell off the stack, spread the letters across the puzzle desk, and sent you out to ask around. Who wrote which letter?

- ☐ 1. Either Gus or Hal wrote the bake sale letter.
- ☐ 2. Hal wrote either the pothole letter or the parking letter.
- ☐ 3. The parking letter came from either Hal or Vera.
- ☐ 4. Tariq wrote neither the seagull letter nor the bake sale letter.

		Letter			
		pothole	parking	seagull	bake sale
Writer	Gus				
	Tariq				
	Hal				
	Vera				

Scratch Pad

For working things out, testing a “Suppose,” or making notes.

CHAPTER 2

The Full Grid

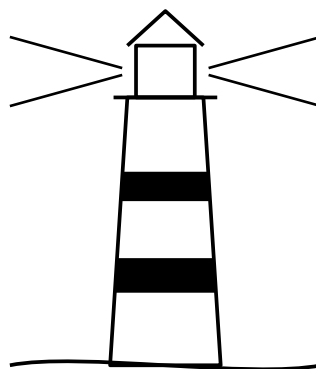
You will learn: The staircase grid and carrying facts from one box to another

Difficulty up to ★★☆☆☆

Puzzles 11–30

May and June bring the Spring Regatta, Kite Day and the Rhubarb Social, and twice as many things to keep straight. Now every neighbor has two things to match, and the grid grows into a staircase.

The new skill is carrying a fact from one box to another. Lesson 2 shows how. By the end of this chapter you will do it without thinking.



LESSON 2

The Staircase Grid

Now each neighbor has two things to match. Rosa, Felix and Mabel each made one jam (plum, fig or quince) and each used one container (a crock, a mason jar or a tin).

- ☐ **1.** Rosa made the fig jam.
- ☐ **2.** The fig jam's maker used the tin.
- ☐ **3.** Felix did not use the crock.
- ☐ **4.** The quince jam's maker did not use the mason jar.

The staircase grid

With three categories, the grid has three boxes arranged like a staircase. The top row of boxes matches names with jams and with jars. The bottom box matches jars with jams. Every pair of categories meets exactly once.

		Jam			Jar		
		plum	fig	quince	crock	mason jar	tin
Name	Rosa						
	Felix						
	Mabel						
Jar	crock						
	mason jar						
	tin						

Three boxes: names and jams, names and jars, jars and jams.

Clues 1 and 2

Clue 1 is a dot for Rosa and fig, in the names-and-jams box. Clue 2 is a dot for fig and tin, in the bottom box. Each dot brings its X's.

Carrying a fact

Here is the big idea of this lesson. Rosa made the fig jam, and the fig jam was in the tin. So Rosa used the tin. Put a dot for Rosa and tin, in the names-and-jars box.

Carry the dot. If A goes with B, and B goes with C, then A goes with C. The same is true for X's: if A goes with B, and B does not go with C, then A does not go with C.

		Jam		Jar	
Name		plum	fig	quince	
	Rosa	X	●	X	
	Felix		X		
	Mabel		X		
	crock		X		
	mason jar		X		
	tin	X	●	X	

Clues 1 and 2.

		Jam		Jar	
Name		plum	fig	quince	
	Rosa	X	●	X	
	Felix		X		
	Mabel		X		
	crock		X		
	mason jar		X		
	tin	X	●	X	

Carry it: Rosa used the tin.

Finishing up

Clue 3 says Felix did not use the crock. The tin is Rosa's, so Felix used the mason jar, and Mabel used the crock.

Clue 4 says the quince jam was not in the mason jar. In the bottom box the tin already belongs to fig, so the quince jam was in the crock and the plum jam was in the mason jar.

Now carry again. Mabel used the crock, and the crock held the quince jam, so Mabel made the quince jam. Felix used the mason jar, which held the plum jam.

		Jam			Jar		
Name		plum	fig	quince	crock	mason jar	tin
	Rosa	×	●	×	×	×	●
	Felix	●	×	×	×	●	×
	Mabel	×	×	●	●	×	×
	crock	×	×	●			
	mason jar	●	×	×			
	tin	×	●	×			

The finished grid. Every box agrees with every other box.

Check every box. When you finish, each of the three boxes should have exactly one dot in every row and column, and the boxes should tell the same story.

11 The Regatta Pennants

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

The Spring Regatta starts at ten sharp, and Otis has the starting horn in one hand and a mug of coffee in the other. Some of that coffee is now on the start sheet. Three sailors are flying three different pennants on three different boats, and Otis needs every line right before he sounds the horn. Can you match each sailor with a pennant and a boat?

- ☐ 1. The red pennant flew on either the dory or the catboat.
- ☐ 2. Whoever sailed the dory flew the gold pennant.
- ☐ 3. Arlo's pennant was not the gold one.
- ☐ 4. Neither Selma nor Arlo sailed the sloop.

		Pennant			Boat		
		red	blue	gold	sloop	catboat	dory
Sailor	Felix						
	Selma						
	Arlo						
Boat	sloop						
	catboat						
	dory						

12 The Swapped Jam Labels

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

For the blind tasting at the St. Brendan's spring supper, Hattie peeled the labels off all the jams, her own included. For once in her life, she did not make a list. The judges have their ribbons ready, and nobody can say whose jam is whose. Can you match each cook with a jam and a jar before the ribbons go out?

- ☐ 1. The fig jam was not in the mason jar.
- ☐ 2. Ruben's jam came in neither the mason jar nor the crock.
- ☐ 3. Whoever made the plum jam put it in the crock.
- ☐ 4. The crock was not Hattie's.

		Jam			Jar		
Cook		plum	fig	quince	mason jar	crock	tin
	Hattie						
	Ruben						
	Lou						
	Jar	mason jar					
		crock					
		tin					

13 The Book Drop Surprise

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Sometime overnight, three long-overdue books thumped into the library's book drop, each with a stray bookmark still tucked inside. Wren would like to clear the right accounts. "And return the bookmarks," she whispers. "People always want their bookmarks back." Who returned which book, and which bookmark was tucked in each?

- ☐ 1. Kenji brought back the atlas.
- ☐ 2. The ribbon was not tucked in the cookbook.
- ☐ 3. Della's book was either the whodunit or the atlas.
- ☐ 4. Neither Nico nor Kenji used the postcard as a bookmark.

		Book			Bookmark		
		atlas	cookbook	whodunit	ribbon	postcard	receipt
Reader	Nico						
	Della						
	Kenji						
Bookmark	ribbon						
	postcard						
	receipt						

14 The Mother's Day Corsages

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Mother's Day is tomorrow, and the garden club's corsage table has vanished under petals, ribbon ends and order slips. Three of the slips got shuffled on the counter. Mabel will not hand a single corsage to the wrong person, and she has her reading glasses on and her red pencil out. Who ordered which flower, and which ribbon goes with it?

- ☐ 1. Bea picked the peach ribbon.
- ☐ 2. Jonah's ribbon was neither lavender nor peach.
- ☐ 3. The rose was tied with neither the white nor the peach ribbon.
- ☐ 4. Jonah ordered either the rose or the peony.

		Flower			Ribbon		
		carnation	rose	peony	lavender	white	peach
Customer	Jonah						
	Bea						
	Cyrus						
Ribbon	lavender						
	white						
	peach						

15 Kite Day Tangle

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

A stiff May breeze on Kite Day sent three kites swooping over the town green, then into one another, then into a single glorious knot. Teddy took eleven photos of it before he remembered that one of the kites was his. Before anyone starts tugging, untangle the knot on paper: who flew which kite, with which tail?

- ☐ 1. Neither Teddy nor Una chose bows for a tail.
- ☐ 2. Una's kite was either the dragon or the box kite.
- ☐ 3. Una's tail was made of either tassels or bows.
- ☐ 4. The dragon kite had a tail of streamers.

		Kite			Tail		
		dragon	box	diamond	bows	streamers	tassels
Flier	Teddy						
	Una						
	Hugo						
Tail	bows						
	streamers						
	tassels						

16 The Boatyard Paint Cans

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Three hulls sit on sawhorses at Okafor Boatyard, scraped bare and ready for a fresh coat. The paint cans, unfortunately, have lost their tags, and Felix will not open a can on a guess. “Shipshape or nothing,” he says, reaching for the pencil behind his left ear. Which owner brought in which boat, and what color is going on it?

- ☐ 1. Imani’s boat is neither the Sea Pea nor the Wavelet.
- ☐ 2. Neither Gus nor Imani chose navy.
- ☐ 3. The navy paint is going on either the Lucky Gull or the Wavelet.
- ☐ 4. Imani picked either navy or sea green.

		Color			Boat		
		sea green	navy	cream	Sea Pea	Lucky Gull	Wavelet
Owner	Gus						
	Imani						
	Basil						
Boat	Sea Pea						
	Lucky Gull						
	Wavelet						

17 The Rhubarb Social

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Hattie lettered the place cards for her May rhubarb social a full week ahead, in her very best penmanship. Then three bakers swept in, set their desserts down wherever they found room, and drifted off to admire the lilacs. Now every card sits by the wrong plate. Can you match each baker to a dessert and a topping before the first fork goes in?

- ☐ 1. The pie was not Rosa's.
- ☐ 2. Neither Rosa nor Elsa brought the custard.
- ☐ 3. Whoever brought the ice cream baked either the pie or the shortcake.
- ☐ 4. Rosa's topping was either the ice cream or the custard.
- ☐ 5. The honey did not come from the crumble's baker.

		Dessert			Topping		
		shortcake	pie	crumble	custard	ice cream	honey
Baker	Rosa						
	Walt						
	Elsa						
Topping	custard						
	ice cream						
	honey						

18 The Buoys After the Storm

★☆☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Last night's gale sent lobster buoys bobbing all over the harbor, from Thimble Beach clear to the ferry dock. Otis spent the morning fishing them out with a boat hook, whistling a shanty slightly off-key. Three of the strays belong to three different lobstermen, and the harbor log has to say who fishes where. Whose buoy is whose, and where does each of them fish?

- ☐ 1. Whoever owns the striped buoy fishes at neither Gull Rock nor East Cove.
- ☐ 2. The East Cove lobsterman owns either the checkered or the striped buoy.
- ☐ 3. Oscar's buoy is either the checkered one or the striped one.
- ☐ 4. The checkered buoy belongs to either Nico or Oscar.
- ☐ 5. Oscar does not fish at East Cove.

		Buoy			Spot		
Lobsterman	Spot	orange	striped	checkered	Gull Rock	East Cove	the Narrows
	Oscar						
	Nico						
	Pablo						
	Gull Rock						
	East Cove						
	the Narrows						

19 The Memorial Day Floats

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Every year the Gazette prints one big photo of the Memorial Day floats, and every year somebody's name ends up under somebody else's lighthouse. This morning four floats rolled down Main Street to the green, each builder riding on top and playing a different instrument. Ada would like the caption right the first time. Who built which float, and who played what?

- ☐ 1. Whoever built the lighthouse float played either the fiddle or the tuba.
- ☐ 2. The banjo player's float was either the tall ship or the lobster.
- ☐ 3. The tall ship float was not Marta's.
- ☐ 4. Of the fiddle player and the banjo player, one was Zeke and the other was Lena.
- ☐ 5. Neither Zeke nor Marta built the lighthouse float.
- ☐ 6. Zeke built either the lighthouse float or the whale float.

Ada's tip: An either-or clue is half a clue until another clue crosses off one of its choices.

		Float				Music			
Builder		tall ship	lobster	lighthouse	whale	fiddle	tuba	banjo	accordion
	Lena								
	Gus								
	Zeke								
	Marta								
Music	fiddle								
	tuba								
	banjo								
	accordion								

Your answers

Builder	Float	Music
Lena		
Gus		
Zeke		
Marta		

20 The Swapped Room Keys

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Friday evening brought a rush to the Gull's Rest Inn: four guests checked in within ten minutes, all talking at once about the traffic. Somewhere in the hubbub, the room keys got swapped on the front desk. Priya has returned forty-one umbrellas to forty-one owners, and she is not about to lose track of four guests. Who is staying in which room, and where is each guest from?

- ☐ 1. Amara's hometown is neither Boston nor Portland.
- ☐ 2. Vito and Amara are staying in the Puffin Room and the Gull Room, one in each.
- ☐ 3. The guest from Boston has either the Puffin Room or the Heron Room.
- ☐ 4. Of Vito and Kit, one comes from Boston and the other from Albany.
- ☐ 5. Whoever is in the Heron Room comes from either Hartford or Portland.

Ada's tip: When two clues mention the same room, read them side by side.

		Room				Hometown			
		Gull	Tern	Puffin	Heron	Boston	Albany	Hartford	Portland
Guest	Vito								
	Amara								
	Kit								
	Hal								
Hometown	Boston								
	Albany								
	Hartford								
	Portland								

Your answers

Guest	Room	Hometown
Vito		
Amara		
Kit		
Hal		

21 The Spring Bird Count

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

At first light on bird count morning, Mabel and three other garden club members fanned out across Thimble Harbor with binoculars, thermoses and very sharp pencils. Each came back with one special sighting from one favorite spot, and the other three all tried to tell Mabel about theirs at once. Her report goes to the state by Friday, and Mabel has never mailed an untidy report in her life. Who spotted which bird, and where?

- ☐ 1. Dev and the osprey's spotter kept watch at the dunes and the old pier, one at each.
- ☐ 2. Of Mabel and the birder at the dunes, one saw the loon and the other saw the oriole.
- ☐ 3. Ivan and whoever saw the loon kept watch at the dunes and the salt marsh, not necessarily in that order.

Your answers

Birder	Bird	Spot
Mabel		
Dev		
Tova		
Ivan		

		Bird				Spot			
Birder		osprey	heron	oriole	loon	salt marsh	old pier	dunes	orchard
	Mabel								
	Dev								
	Tova								
	Ivan								
Spot	salt marsh								
	old pier								
	dunes								
	orchard								

22 The Lighthouse Paint Crew

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Thimble Point Light turns 150 this year, so on a bright May Saturday four volunteers climbed out to the Point with drop cloths to make it look the part. Each painted one part of the lighthouse with one kind of tool, while the old Keeper's Lamp waited safely under a sheet. Lena, white gloves on, wants the work log exactly right before the big birthday night. Who painted what, and with which tool?

- ☐ 1. Either Faye or Jonah used the wide brush.
- ☐ 2. The stairs were painted by either Ruben or Faye.
- ☐ 3. Of the roller and the small brush, one was used on the door and the other on the stairs.
- ☐ 4. Jonah's part was either the shutters or the railing.
- ☐ 5. Whoever painted the shutters did not use the wide brush.
- ☐ 6. The roller went on neither the door nor the railing.
- ☐ 7. Neither Jonah nor Ruben painted the railing.

Ada's tip: Mark the plain no's first; the either-or clues go easier once those X's are in.

		Part				Tool			
Volunteer	Teddy	door	railing	stairs	shutters	roller	wide brush	sponge	small brush
	Jonah								
	Faye								
	Ruben								
Tool	roller								
	wide brush								
	sponge								
	small brush								

Your answers

Volunteer	Part	Tool
Teddy		
Jonah		
Faye		
Ruben		

23 The Ferry Lost-and-Found

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Jonah's ferry leaves at 7:30, not 7:31, and his lost-and-found is kept just as strictly. After Tuesday's morning run, Pilot the beagle trotted from deck to deck in his little orange life vest and sniffed out four forgotten belongings, each left by a different regular passenger. No item goes on the shelf without a proper tag. Who left what behind, and where did each passenger ride?

- ☐ 1. One of Otis and Yusuf left the novel behind, and the other left the sun hat.
- ☐ 2. Yusuf left either the scarf or the sun hat, and Carmen left the other one.
- ☐ 3. Linus did not ride on the foredeck.
- ☐ 4. Otis and Carmen rode separately: one on the upper deck, the other on the aft deck.
- ☐ 5. Whoever left the novel rode on either the lower deck or the aft deck.

Ada's tip: A clue that leaves someone out tells you something about them, too.

		Item				Deck			
Passenger	Otis	scarf	thermos	novel	sun hat	upper deck	lower deck	foredeck	aft deck
	Carmen								
Deck	Yusuf								
	Linus								
	upper deck								
	lower deck								
	foredeck								
	aft deck								

Your answers

Passenger	Item	Deck
Otis		
Carmen		
Yusuf		
Linus		

24 The Garden Tour Signs

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○ Time _____

Ten minutes before the tour bus was due, a gust off the harbor flattened every sign on the garden club's June tour and piled them on the sidewalk, red-pencil corrections and all. Four gardens, four flowers, four ornaments, and one garden club president who would rather not admit she has lost track. Can you help Mabel work out whose garden has which flower and which ornament?

- ☐ 1. Enzo's flowers are either irises or lupines.
- ☐ 2. There are no irises in Gideon's garden.
- ☐ 3. The sundial and the gnome stand in two different gardens: one with the roses, the other with the peonies.
- ☐ 4. Neither Gideon nor Pearl grows the roses.
- ☐ 5. Gideon's ornament is either a birdbath or a gnome.
- ☐ 6. The gnome is not in Gideon's garden, and not in Pearl's.

Your answers

Gardener	Flower	Ornament
Hattie		
Gideon		
Pearl		
Enzo		

		Flower				Ornament			
		roses	irises	lupines	peonies	birdbath	sundial	gnome	trellis
Gardener	Hattie								
	Gideon								
	Pearl								
	Enzo								
Ornament	birdbath								
	sundial								
	gnome								
	trellis								

25 Supper at the Clam Shack

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○ Time _____

Nico was halfway through the one about the lobster the size of a canoe (a smaller canoe than last time) when he and three friends gave their orders at the harbor clam shack. Nobody was listening, the cook included. Now the fryer is hot, the cook is waiting, and the order pad says only “four suppers, four drinks.” Who ordered which dish, and who drank what?

- ☐ 1. Whoever drank the cider ordered either the lobster roll or the fried clams.
- ☐ 2. One of Felix and the diner who ordered the crab cake drank iced tea, and the other drank lemonade.
- ☐ 3. Sam’s drink was neither iced tea nor cider.
- ☐ 4. Bea’s supper was either the fish tacos or the lobster roll.
- ☐ 5. The lemonade drinker had either the lobster roll or the fish tacos.

Your answers

Diner	Dish	Drink
Nico		
Felix		
Bea		
Sam		

		Dish				Drink			
		lobster roll	fried clams	fish tacos	crab cake	lemonade	iced tea	root beer	cider
Diner	Nico								
	Felix								
	Bea								
	Sam								
Drink	lemonade								
	iced tea								
	root beer								
	cider								

26 The Grown-Up Spelling Bee

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Four grown-ups made it to the final round of the library's spelling bee, each given one fiendish word and each clutching a lucky charm. Wren spelled in a whisper, as usual, and Mabel judged with her red pencil poised. Then Mabel's score sheet slipped under the cookie table and came out with a coffee ring on it. Who spelled which word, and which charm did each finalist hold?

- ☐ 1. Of the acorn holder and the wishbone holder, one spelled kayak and the other spelled zucchini.
- ☐ 2. Whoever spelled rhythm was clutching either the sea glass or the wishbone.
- ☐ 3. Either Cyrus or Oscar clutched the sea glass.
- ☐ 4. Wren's word was either zucchini or rhythm.
- ☐ 5. Between them, Oscar and Imani held the wishbone and the sea glass, one each.

Ada's tip: Read each clue twice: once for what it says, and once for what it rules out.

		Word	Charm							
Finalist	Wren									
	Oscar									
	Imani									
	Cyrus									
	lucky penny									
Charm	acorn									
	sea glass									
	wishbone									

Your answers

Finalist	Word	Charm
Wren		
Oscar		
Imani		
Cyrus		

27 The Graduation Cakes

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

June means graduations, and in Thimble Harbor graduations mean cake from the Salt & Sugar Bakery. Rosa took four cake orders while feeding Gloria, her sourdough starter, and jotted the flavors on one slip and the toppers on another, but not a single customer's name. Pickup starts at noon. Which customer ordered which flavor, and which topper goes on each cake?

- ☐ 1. Neither the mortarboard nor the owl went on the carrot cake.
- ☐ 2. The carrot and coconut cakes went to Elsa and Gus, in some order.
- ☐ 3. Jade's cake was either lemon or carrot.
- ☐ 4. The star topper went on either the chocolate or the lemon cake.
- ☐ 5. Neither Tariq nor Gus picked the mortarboard.
- ☐ 6. Tariq's topper was either the owl or the diploma.

Your answers

Customer	Flavor	Topper
Tariq		
Gus		
Jade		
Elsa		

		Flavor				Topper			
Customer		lemon	carrot	chocolate	coconut	mortarboard	diploma	owl	star
	Tariq								
	Gus								
	Jade								
	Elsa								
	mortarboard								
	diploma								
	owl								
Topper	star								

28 The Tide Pool Walk

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○ Time _____

Lena left her white cotton gloves at the museum this morning, since nothing in a tide pool is likely to be older than she is. On her walk along Thimble Beach, she and three others each found one creature in a different pool. Everything must go back exactly where it came from before the tide turns. Who found what, and in which pool?

- ☐ 1. Neither the crab nor the snail came from Moon Pool.
- ☐ 2. The snail was found in either Mermaid Pool or Moon Pool.
- ☐ 3. Whoever explored Kettle Pool found neither the crab nor the urchin.
- ☐ 4. Neither Lena nor Hugo explored Bathtub Pool.
- ☐ 5. Marta's find was either the snail or the sea star.
- ☐ 6. Kettle Pool was explored by either Zeke or Hugo.

Your answers

Walker	Creature	Pool
Lena		
Marta		
Hugo		
Zeke		

		Creature				Pool				
Walker		Lena	sea star	crab	snail	urchin	Bathtub Pool	Kettle Pool	Mermaid Pool	Moon Pool
		Marta								
		Hugo								
		Zeke								
	Pool	Bathtub Pool								
		Kettle Pool								
		Mermaid Pool								
		Moon Pool								

29 The Water Day Photos

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Teddy shot four terrific photos at Water Day on Thimble Beach: four winners, four races, and four prizes, one of them a whole strawberry-rhubarb pie. As usual, he did not write down a single name. The Gazette goes to press at five, and Ada will not run a photo without a proper caption. Who won which race, and what did each winner take home?

- ☐ 1. Either Kenji or Priya went home with the trophy.
- ☐ 2. One of Vera and whoever took home the medal won the sailboard race, and the other won the rowing race.
- ☐ 3. Kenji and the winner of the rowing race took home the ribbon and the pie, one each.
- ☐ 4. Of Kenji and the swim race winner, one got the ribbon and the other got the trophy.

Your answers

Winner	Race	Prize
Priya		
Vera		
Kenji		
Della		

		Race				Prize			
		kayak	swim	rowing	sailboard	trophy	ribbon	medal	pie
Winner	Priya								
	Vera								
	Kenji								
	Della								
Prize	trophy								
	ribbon								
	medal								
	pie								

30 The Borrowed Oars

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Before Saturday's dinghy race, four rowers, Felix among them, took oars from the rack at Okafor Boatyard, and afterward every pair went back on the wrong hook. Felix wants each pair matched to its dinghy, shipshape. He has also noticed that his own little dinghy sits a few yards farther up the beach than he left it, which is not shipshape at all. Who rowed which dinghy, and with which oars?

- ☐ 1. Otis rowed either the Minnow or the Skipjack.
- ☐ 2. Amara and Felix rowed the Skipjack and the Teacup, in some order.
- ☐ 3. Neither the varnished nor the ash oars went out on the Skipjack.
- ☐ 4. Whoever had the blue-tipped oars rowed either the Pebble or the Teacup.
- ☐ 5. Neither Felix nor Otis used the varnished oars.
- ☐ 6. One of Felix and Amara used the varnished oars, and the other used the spruce oars.

Ada's tip: When two people share two dinghies in some order, cross everyone else off those dinghies at once.

		Oars				Dinghy			
		varnished	blue-tipped	spruce	ash	Minnow	Pebble	Skipjack	Teacup
Rower	Felix								
	Otis								
	Walt								
	Amara								
Dinghy	Minnow								
	Pebble								
	Skipjack								
	Teacup								

Your answers

Rower	Oars	Dinghy
Felix		
Otis		
Walt		
Amara		

Scratch Pad

For working things out, testing a “Suppose,” or making notes.

CHAPTER 3

First, Next, Last

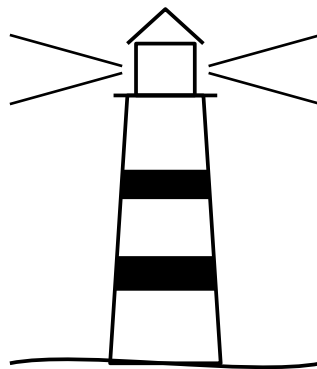
You will learn: Line-ups, before and after, and exact gaps

Difficulty up to ★★☆☆☆

Puzzles 31–46

Summer. The Fourth of July parade, fireworks on the green, a clambake on Thimble Beach, and lines for everything: the ferry, the creamery window, the library book sale.

This chapter is about order: who came first, who stood right behind whom, and who arrived exactly an hour later. Lesson 3 explains the difference between “before” and “right before.” It matters more than you think.



LESSON 3

Lining Up

Four neighbors waited in line at the bakery counter one morning. Who stood where?

- ☐ 1. Priya stood somewhere ahead of Jonah.
- ☐ 2. Teddy stood right behind Priya.
- ☐ 3. Lena was not first in line.
- ☐ 4. Jonah was not fourth in line.

A line-up is a grid like any other, with places in line instead of pies. But order clues let you rule out more than you might think.

“Somewhere ahead” is not “right ahead”

Clue 1 says Priya stood somewhere ahead of Jonah. It does **not** say she was right in front of him. Someone could stand between them.

What clue 1 does tell you is this: Priya cannot be last, because someone stands behind her. And Jonah cannot be first, because someone stands ahead of him.

Before does not mean immediately before. “Ahead of,” “earlier than” and “before” leave room for others in between. Only words like “right ahead of,” “right behind” or “next to” mean no gap.

“Right behind” means no gap

Clue 2 says Teddy stood right behind Priya. So Teddy cannot be first, and Priya cannot be last.

Clues 3 and 4 are plain X's: Lena was not first, and Jonah was not fourth.

		Place			
		first	second	third	fourth
Name	Jonah	X			X
	Priya				X
	Teddy	X			
	Lena	X			

Every X the clues give on a first reading.

Who is first?

Look down the column for first place. Lena, Jonah and Teddy are crossed out. So Priya was first. Teddy is right behind her, so Teddy was second. Jonah was not fourth, so Jonah was third, and Lena was fourth.

		Place			
		first	second	third	fourth
Name	Jonah	X	X	●	X
	Priya	●	X	X	X
	Teddy	X	●	X	X
	Lena	X	X	X	●

The line, front to back: Priya, Teddy, Jonah, Lena.

Read down the columns too. In line-ups, the question “Who could be first?” is often quicker than “Where could Jonah be?”

Other order words

- “Lena stood **exactly two places** behind Teddy”: count. If Teddy is first, Lena is third.
- “**Next to**”: right in front or right behind, either side.
- “**At one end** of the line”: first or last.

31 The Creamery Line

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○ Time _____

On the first hot afternoon of July, even Rosa left her ovens for a cone, and four customers waited in a tidy line at the creamery window by the pier. After they had gone, the scooper found a five-dollar bill on the boards right where the second customer had stood. Ada believes every lost dollar has an owner. Who stood where in line, and whose five dollars is it?

- ☐ 1. Kit stood exactly three places ahead of Ivan.
- ☐ 2. Whoever stood third in line was either Ivan or Rosa.

Your question: Who dropped the five-dollar bill?

		Place			
		first	second	third	fourth
Customer	Rosa				
	Ivan				
	Faye				
	Kit				

32 The Fourth of July Parade

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Four homemade floats rolled down Main Street for the Fourth of July, each with its builder riding proudly on top, and Nico swears the cardboard lobster on his was the size of a canoe. Then the Gazette's parade program came out with the floats in the wrong order. Hattie is already at the front desk with her clipboard. For the correction box, who rode on which float, front to back?

- ☐ 1. Hattie's float rolled exactly two floats ahead of Arlo's.
- ☐ 2. Hattie rode either at the very front of the parade or at the very back.
- ☐ 3. Selma rode on the float right in front of Arlo's.

		Float			
		first	second	third	fourth
Rider	Hattie				
	Nico				
	Selma				
	Arlo				

33 The Twice-Punched Ticket

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○ Time _____

Jonah runs the 8 a.m. ferry to the minute. This morning four passengers came up the gangway one at a time, and Pilot the beagle greeted each of them in his little orange life vest. Somewhere in there, Jonah's old ticket punch jammed and bit the third ticket twice, and he would like to apologize to the right passenger. Who boarded in which order?

- ☐ 1. Yusuf boarded exactly two turns before Lou.
- ☐ 2. Lou was either the first passenger aboard or the last.
- ☐ 3. Otis boarded sometime after Yusuf.

Your question: Whose ticket was punched twice?

		Boarded			
		first	second	third	fourth
Passenger	Otis				
	Lou				
	Yusuf				
	Greta				

34 The Sandcastle Row

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○ Time _____

Sandcastle Saturday brought out every bucket in Thimble Harbor. Four builders worked in one row running out from the pier; Teddy photographed his own turrets from six angles, and Mabel's moat came with a sign, correctly punctuated. The judges' sheet numbers the castles from the pier outward, with no names at all, and the tide is on its way in. Who built which castle?

- ☐ 1. The fourth castle out from the pier was not Teddy's.
- ☐ 2. Teddy's castle and Mabel's did not stand side by side.
- ☐ 3. Mabel built her castle closer to the pier than Teddy did.
- ☐ 4. Enzo's castle was either the third or the fourth from the pier.

		Castle			
		first	second	third	fourth
Builder	Teddy				
	Mabel				
	Enzo				
	Carmen				

35 The Last Ear of Corn

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Butter, wood smoke and a whiff of seaweed: the July clambake on Thimble Beach was ready, and five hungry people lined up at the buffet before the tarp was even off the pit. There was exactly one ear of corn apiece, so the person at the very back of the line got the last one. Felix calls that shipshape planning. Who stood where in the buffet line, and who got the last ear of corn?

- ☐ 1. Vera stood somewhere behind Felix in the buffet line.
- ☐ 2. Priya was either second or third in line.
- ☐ 3. Hugo's place in line was either third or fourth.
- ☐ 4. Hugo was somewhere ahead of Felix in the line.

Your question: Who got the last ear of corn?

		Place				
		first	second	third	fourth	fifth
Diner	Priya					
	Felix					
	Dot					
	Hugo					
	Vera					

36 The Fireworks Blankets

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○ Time _____

Gus's knee promised clear skies for the Fourth, and his knee was right. Five friends spread their blankets in a single row on the town green and waited for the first rocket. From the bandstand, the Gazette's panorama photo caught all five faces lit up red and gold, and the caption needs their names, left to right as the camera saw them. Who sat on which blanket?

- ☐ 1. Amara's blanket was somewhere to the right of Pablo's.
- ☐ 2. Pablo sat exactly three blankets to the right of Lena.
- ☐ 3. Tova sat exactly three blankets to the left of Amara.

		Blanket				
		first	second	third	fourth	fifth
Friend	Lena					
	Gus					
	Tova					
	Amara					
	Pablo					

37 The Book Sale Early Birds

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○ Time _____

Doors open at nine for the library's summer book sale, but by half past seven, five early birds were already waiting on the steps with folding chairs and thermoses. Wren had promised, in a whisper, that the first in line would get first pick from the box of rare books. By eight, all five remembered being first. Who really held which spot in line?

- ☐ 1. Oscar was not second in line.
- ☐ 2. The first spot in line did not belong to Jonah.
- ☐ 3. Whoever stood fourth in line was either Jonah or Nadia.
- ☐ 4. Elsa was somewhere ahead of Oscar in line.
- ☐ 5. Elsa and Milo did not stand next to each other.
- ☐ 6. Nadia stood somewhere behind Oscar in line.

Your question: Who gets first pick of the rare books?

		Spot				
		first	second	third	fourth	fifth
Early bird	Oscar					
	Nadia					
	Jonah					
	Elsa					
	Milo					

38 The Committee Photo

★★☆☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○ Time _____

Teddy lined up the Lighthouse Anniversary Committee in one row in front of Thimble Point Light and took forty-two pictures to get one where nobody blinked. The Gazette needs the caption, left to right as the camera saw them. Studying the contact sheet with her magnifier, Ada notes that in every frame one member is glancing up at the lantern room. Can you name all five, left to right?

- ☐ 1. Otis stood somewhere to the left of Jonah.
- ☐ 2. Gus stood directly to the left of Otis, with nobody in between.
- ☐ 3. Lena's spot was somewhere to the right of Hattie's.
- ☐ 4. Counting from the left, Hattie was either second or fourth.

		Spot				
		first	second	third	fourth	fifth
Member	Otis					
	Hattie					
	Jonah					
	Lena					
	Gus					

Scratch Pad

For working things out, testing a “Suppose,” or making notes.

39 The Canoe-Sized Lobster

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

From Monday to Thursday, Nico took one summer visitor out on his lobster boat, Persistence, each morning, and no two came from the same town. He keeps his bookings in his head, right next to his lobster stories, and the two have begun to mix. He does know that Wednesday's guest hauled up the week's biggest lobster, which has since grown to the size of a canoe. Who went out on which day, and where was each visitor from?

- ☐ 1. Cass and Boris went out on Monday and Wednesday, one on each day.
- ☐ 2. Imani went out exactly three days after the visitor from Dover.
- ☐ 3. Boris was not the visitor from Reno.
- ☐ 4. Of Boris and the visitor from Tulsa, one went out on Tuesday and the other on Wednesday.

Your question: Who hauled up the canoe-sized lobster?

Your answers

Visitor	Hometown	Day
Cass		
Hal		
Imani		
Boris		

		Hometown				Day			
Visitor		Buffalo	Tulsa	Dover	Reno	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday
	Cass								
	Hal								
	Imani								
	Boris								
	Monday								
	Tuesday								
	Wednesday								
Day	Thursday								

40 A Piano on the Ferry

★★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Pilot the beagle has greeted plenty of odd cargo from the ferry's deck, but never a week like this one: a piano, a beehive, a canoe and an armchair, one a day from Tuesday to Friday, each from a different sender and each bound for Gull Island. The island postmaster signed every slip on the wrong line. Jonah keeps his log to the minute and wants it right. Who sent what, and on which day?

- ☐ 1. Gus shipped his cargo on Thursday.
- ☐ 2. Tariq's cargo was either the canoe or the beehive.
- ☐ 3. The armchair did not go over on Friday.
- ☐ 4. Una shipped earlier in the week than Tariq.
- ☐ 5. Of Faye and the piano's sender, one shipped on Thursday and the other on Friday.
- ☐ 6. The canoe went over earlier in the week than Gus's cargo.

Your answers

Sender	Cargo	Day
Gus		
Faye		
Tariq		
Una		

		Cargo				Day				
Sender	Day	Gus	piano	beehive	canoe	armchair	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
		Faye								
		Tariq								
		Una								
		Tuesday								
		Wednesday								
		Thursday								
		Friday								

41 The Blueberry Picking Map

★★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Wild blueberries ripen all over the hills behind Thimble Harbor in late July, just in time for the August festival. Mabel and three neighbors each picked a different patch, one picker a day from Wednesday to Saturday. Now Mabel is drawing a picking map for next year, every label spelled just so, to show which patch ripens when. Who picked which patch, and on which day?

- ☐ 1. The north field patch was picked earlier in the week than the hilltop patch.
- ☐ 2. One of Jade and Mabel worked the hilltop patch, and the other picked on Wednesday.
- ☐ 3. Vito did not pick on Thursday or Friday.
- ☐ 4. Mabel's day was neither Wednesday nor Friday.
- ☐ 5. Ruben kept clear of both the north field and the creekside patch.

Your answers

Picker	Patch	Day
Mabel		
Ruben		
Jade		
Vito		

		Patch				Day			
Picker		north field	hilltop	stone wall	creekside	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
	Mabel								
	Ruben								
	Jade								
	Vito								
	Wednesday								
	Thursday								
	Friday								
Day	Saturday								

42 Once Upon a Story Hour

★★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Once a week through July, a different volunteer settled onto the library's story-hour rug and read aloud to a circle of small children in sun hats. Wren took her turn too, in her usual whisper, and the children leaned in so far they nearly tipped over. The newsletter thanking all four readers goes to print tomorrow. Who read on which date, and what kind of book did each one choose?

- ☐ 1. The poems were read by either Olive or Kenji.
- ☐ 2. One of Wren and Kenji read on July 8, and the other on July 15.
- ☐ 3. Of Olive and the July 29 volunteer, one read the pirate tale and the other the poems.
- ☐ 4. Wren read on an earlier date than whoever read the fairy tale.

Your answers

Volunteer	Book	Week
Wren		
Kenji		
Sam		
Olive		

		Book				Week			
		pirate tale	fairy tale	poems	fables	July 8	July 15	July 22	July 29
Volunteer	Wren								
	Kenji								
	Sam								
	Olive								
Week	July 8								
	July 15								
	July 22								
	July 29								

43 A Flicker After Closing

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

At the lighthouse museum, whoever locks up for the night writes one line in the lock-up log. Four volunteers took the nights from Thursday to Sunday, and each wrote about something different, but not one of them signed or dated a line. Lena, gloves on, is most curious about one note: an odd flicker, high in the dark lantern room, after closing time. Who locked up on which night, and who saw the flicker?

- ☐ 1. Sunday's note was about either the gull nest or the stuck latch.
- ☐ 2. The stuck latch was noted exactly two nights after the odd flicker.
- ☐ 3. Priya wrote about either the odd flicker or the wet paint.
- ☐ 4. Arlo locked up on the night after the odd flicker was logged.
- ☐ 5. The wet paint note was written on either Thursday or Sunday.
- ☐ 6. Either Priya or Della locked up on Thursday.
- ☐ 7. Neither Teddy nor Arlo locked up on Sunday.

Your question: Who noticed the odd flicker?

Ada's tip: Two either-or clues that meet on the same square can settle it between them.

		Note				Night			
		stuck latch	gull nest	wet paint	odd flicker	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
Volunteer	Teddy								
	Della								
	Priya								
	Arlo								
Night	Thursday								
	Friday								
	Saturday								
	Sunday								

Your answers

Volunteer	Note	Night
Teddy		
Della		
Priya		
Arlo		

44 Mostly Shipshape

★★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Felix gave four sailing lessons on Saturday morning, one each hour, each in a different little boat from his yard. He kept the lesson sheet in his head, which he calls shipshape. It is mostly shipshape. Every student is owed a certificate naming the boat and the hour, so who sailed when, and in which boat?

- ☐ 1. The Ripple went out later in the morning than the Tern.
- ☐ 2. Pearl's lesson came before the Tern's.
- ☐ 3. Emil sailed later than whoever took the Bluebell.
- ☐ 4. Walt's lesson was at either 9 a.m. or 11 a.m.
- ☐ 5. Neither Emil nor Pearl sailed the Bluebell.
- ☐ 6. The Bluebell went out at either 10 a.m. or noon.

Your answers

Student	Boat	Time
Walt		
Carmen		
Emil		
Pearl		

		Boat				Time			
		Whelk	Tern	Bluebell	Ripple	9 a.m.	10 a.m.	11 a.m.	noon
Student	Walt								
	Carmen								
	Emil								
	Pearl								
Time	9 a.m.								
	10 a.m.								
	11 a.m.								
	noon								

45 Four Orders on the Back Shelf

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Rosa's order book is her pride, second only to Gloria, her oldest sourdough starter. On Friday morning four special orders waited on the back shelf at Salt & Sugar, among them a cinnamon bun the size of a dinner plate. Four customers came to collect them, each at a different hour. In the rush, Rosa never wrote down who took what. Can you set her book straight before the next rush?

- ☐ 1. Of Zeke and whoever came at 10 a.m., one had ordered the rye loaf and the other the cinnamon bun.
- ☐ 2. One of the 7 a.m. and 10 a.m. customers took the rye loaf, and the other took the layer cake.
- ☐ 3. Lou came in before whoever ordered the baguettes.
- ☐ 4. Zeke came in after the baguettes had been collected.
- ☐ 5. The baguettes were not Nico's.

Your answers

Customer	Order	Pickup
Nico		
Zeke		
Lou		
Milo		

		Order				Pickup			
Customer	Nico								
	Zeke								
	Lou								
	Milo								
Pickup	7 a.m.								
	8 a.m.								
	9 a.m.								
	10 a.m.								

46 Last Call for Pickles

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

The county fair office stops taking entries at five o'clock on the eve of the fair, and this year four last-minute exhibitors came puffing up the steps an hour apart, starting at one. The clerk stamped every entry, listened politely to Otis's off-key sea shanty, and then knocked a lemonade across the entry sheet. The judges arrive at eight tomorrow morning. Who brought which entry, and at what time?

- ☐ 1. The quilt was entered by either Otis or Hugo.
- ☐ 2. Hugo brought either the honey or the quilt.
- ☐ 3. Dev arrived later than whoever brought the zucchini.
- ☐ 4. The quilt came in exactly two hours after Dev did.
- ☐ 5. Selma arrived sometime after the pickles.

Your answers

Exhibitor	Entry	Time
Hugo		
Selma		
Dev		
Otis		

		Entry				Time			
		pickles	quilt	honey	zucchini	1 p.m.	2 p.m.	3 p.m.	4 p.m.
Exhibitor	Hugo								
	Selma								
	Dev								
	Otis								
Time	1 p.m.								
	2 p.m.								
	3 p.m.								
	4 p.m.								

Scratch Pad

For working things out, testing a “Suppose,” or making notes.

CHAPTER 4

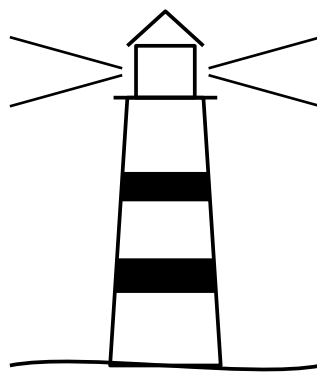
Truth or Fib?

You will learn: Testing one suspect at a time against what everyone says

Difficulty up to ★★☆☆☆ Puzzles 47–58

August means the County Fair: goats, quilts, a pie tent and a Ferris wheel. Something always goes missing at the fair, and everybody has something to say about it.

In these puzzles, people make statements, and not all of them are true. You will test one suspect at a time against what everyone says. Lesson 4 gives you a simple table, and a shortcut for when two people contradict each other.



LESSON 4

Truth or Fib?

At the county fair, the last caramel apple vanished from the candy stand. Three people were nearby, and each said one thing.

Bea: “Kit didn’t eat the last caramel apple.”

Hugo: “Kit ate the last caramel apple.”

Kit: “Either Bea or Hugo ate the last caramel apple.”

The rule: Exactly one of these statements is true.
--

One suspect at a time

Here is the method. Pretend one person did it. Then go through the statements one by one and decide whether each would be true or false. Count the true ones. If the count matches the rule, that suspect fits. Then try the next suspect.

Exactly one suspect will fit.

Testing Bea

Suppose Bea ate the caramel apple. Bea’s own statement, “Kit didn’t eat the last caramel apple,” would be true. Hugo’s, “Kit ate the last caramel apple,” would be false. Kit’s, “Either Bea or Hugo ate the last caramel apple,” would be true. That is two true statements, but the rule says exactly one. So it was not Bea.

Test Hugo and Kit the same way. Only Kit gives exactly one true statement.

Bea: “Kit didn’t eat the last caramel apple.”

Hugo: “Kit ate the last caramel apple.”

Kit: “Either Bea or Hugo ate the last caramel apple.”

The rule: Exactly one of these statements is true.

Suspect tested	Bea	Hugo	Kit	True	Fits?
If Bea did it	T	F	T	2	no
If Hugo did it	T	F	T	2	no
If Kit did it	F	T	F	1	yes

The shortcut: opposites. When two people say opposite things, as Bea and Hugo do here, exactly one of them is telling the truth. Here that uses up the only true statement, so Kit’s statement must be false. Neither Bea nor Hugo did it, so it was Kit.

Things to watch for

- “I didn’t do it” is true for everyone except the culprit.
- “Hugo is lying” is true exactly when Hugo’s statement is false.
- Some puzzles use a different rule: “only the culprit is fibbing,” which means the culprit’s statement is false and everyone else’s is true. The method is the same.

47

Who Ate the Last Scone?

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○ Time _____

Every Friday, Rosa sets aside one cranberry scone for Ada, still warm from the Salt & Sugar ovens. This week Ada left it on the puzzle desk while she took a phone call, and she came back to a plate of crumbs. Inkwell, the usual suspect, slept on the proofs through the whole thing, which leaves the three people in the Gazette office, and each of them says one thing. Who owes Ada a scone?

- Teddy:** “Gus ate the last scone.”
Bea: “Teddy didn’t eat the last scone.”
Gus: “Teddy ate the last scone.”

The rule: The culprit is lying. Everyone else is telling the truth.

Test each suspect. Write T (true) or F (false) for each statement.

	Teddy	Bea	Gus	True	Fits?
If Teddy did it					
If Bea did it					
If Gus did it					

48 Who Let the Goat Out?

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Clementine the goat has never met a pie she didn't like, so when her pen came open at the county fair, she trotted straight into the pie tent. Nico swears she ate a dozen; the judges count two. Three people were leaning on the fence by her pen just before, and each says one thing. Can you work out who let her loose?

Nico: "Linus didn't leave the goat pen open."

Faye: "Either Nico or I left the goat pen open."

Linus: "Nico didn't leave the goat pen open."

The rule: Exactly two of these statements are true.

Test each suspect. Write T (true) or F (false) for each statement.

	Nico	Faye	Linus	True	Fits?
If Nico did it					
If Faye did it					
If Linus did it					

49 Who Tasted the Pie Early?

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

The pie tent had barely recovered from Clementine’s visit when a contest pie on the judges’ table turned up with a slice missing, a slice far too neat for any goat. The judging is an hour away, and the judges are not amused. Three people had been setting out entries near the table, and each has one thing to say. Which of them is the early taster?

Hal: “Either Mabel or Kit cut the contest pie.”

Mabel: “Kit didn’t cut the contest pie.”

Kit: “Either Hal or I cut the contest pie.”

The rule: The culprit is lying. Everyone else is telling the truth.

Test each suspect. Write T (true) or F (false) for each statement.

	Hal	Mabel	Kit	True	Fits?
If Hal did it					
If Mabel did it					
If Kit did it					

50 Who Sounded the Ferry Horn?

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

At the stroke of midnight, the ferry’s horn let out one long, tremendous blast and woke half the harbor. Jonah was home asleep with Pilot the beagle at his feet, and only three other people have a key to the wheelhouse. Each of them has made one statement. Can you give Jonah a name before the 7:30 sailing?

- Otis:** “Either Vito or I sounded the ferry horn.”
Jade: “Either Vito or I sounded the ferry horn.”
Vito: “Neither Jade nor I sounded the ferry horn.”

The rule: Exactly one of these statements is true.

Test each suspect. Write T (true) or F (false) for each statement.

	Otis	Jade	Vito	True	Fits?
If Otis did it					
If Jade did it					
If Vito did it					

51 Who Swapped the Quilt Ribbons?

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Overnight, the blue ribbon and the red ribbon at the fair’s quilt show traded places, and two quilters are now being extremely polite to each other. Four people were in the quilt hall after closing, Hattie and her clipboard among them. Each of them has something to say. Can you sort out who did it before the doors open at nine?

- Hattie:** “Cyrus swapped the quilt ribbons.”
Wren: “Either Hattie or I swapped the quilt ribbons.”
Cyrus: “Wren swapped the quilt ribbons.”
Elsa: “I didn’t swap the quilt ribbons.”

The rule: Exactly three of these statements are true.

Test each suspect. Write T (true) or F (false) for each statement.

	Hattie	Wren	Cyrus	Elsa	True	Fits?
If Hattie did it						
If Wren did it						
If Cyrus did it						
If Elsa did it						

52 Who Hid the Gavel?

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Forty folding chairs, a long agenda and strong feelings about the new Main Street crosswalk were all in place for the August town meeting. The one thing missing was the moderator's gavel, and the moderator refuses to start without it. Four people were in the hall early setting out chairs, and each has a statement ready. Who is holding up the meeting?

Priya: "Either Una or I hid the gavel."

Gideon: "Neither Priya nor Ruben hid the gavel."

Una: "I didn't hide the gavel."

Ruben: "Una hid the gavel."

The rule: The culprit is lying. Everyone else is telling the truth.

Test each suspect. Write T (true) or F (false) for each statement.

	P.	G.	U.	R.	True	Fits?
If Priya did it						
If Gideon did it						
If Una did it						
If Ruben did it						

53 Who Took the Postcards?

★★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Lena Kowalski ordered five hundred postcards for the lighthouse’s 150th anniversary, each one showing Thimble Point Light at sunset. By closing time on Tuesday, the whole stack had vanished from the gift shop counter. Lena counts four visitors that afternoon, and each has one sentence to offer. Can you tell her which visitor walked off with them?

- Felix:** “Marta didn’t take the postcards.”
- Teddy:** “Marta took the postcards.”
- Marta:** “Neither Teddy nor I took the postcards.”
- Sam:** “I didn’t take the postcards.”

The rule: Exactly three of these statements are true.

Test each suspect. Write T (true) or F (false) for each statement.

	Felix	Teddy	Marta	Sam	True	Fits?
If Felix did it						
If Teddy did it						
If Marta did it						
If Sam did it						

54 Who Borrowed the Berry Rake?

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○ Time _____

Mabel Fitch has won the Blueberry Festival picking contest three summers running, and she gives all the credit to her old berry rake. On festival morning, the rake was gone from its nail on her porch, and the contest starts at ten. Four neighbors walked past early, and each has a word to say about it. Mabel is sure it was only borrowed, but by whom?

Dot: "I didn't borrow the berry rake."

Rosa: "Neither Dot nor Enzo borrowed the berry rake."

Enzo: "Rosa didn't borrow the berry rake."

Quinn: "Enzo borrowed the berry rake."

The rule: Exactly two of these statements are true.

Test each suspect. Write T (true) or F (false) for each statement.

	Dot	Rosa	Enzo	Quinn	True	Fits?
If Dot did it						
If Rosa did it						
If Enzo did it						
If Quinn did it						

55 Who Unplugged the Ferris Wheel?

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

On the last night of the county fair, the Ferris wheel's lights went dark, and the operator sensibly stopped the wheel with Gus Mahoney at the very top. Gus spent twenty peaceful minutes up there forecasting next week's weather for the whole fairground. Four people had been standing by the power box, and each has one thing to report. Who pulled the plug?

Nadia: "Oscar unplugged the lights."

Lena: "Neither Nadia nor I unplugged the lights."

Ivan: "Lena is lying."

Oscar: "Ivan is lying."

The rule: Exactly two of these statements are true.

Test each suspect. Write T (true) or F (false) for each statement.

	Nadia	Lena	Ivan	Oscar	True	Fits?
If Nadia did it						
If Lena did it						
If Ivan did it						
If Oscar did it						

56 Who Salted the Lemonade?

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Hattie’s August ice cream social at St. Brendan’s ran like clockwork until the first sip of lemonade made a whole row of faces pucker the wrong way. Someone had filled the big pitcher from the salt tin instead of the sugar tin, which sit side by side on the kitchen shelf. Five people worked in the hall kitchen that afternoon, and each makes one statement. Whose mix-up was it?

- Arlo:** “Della salted the lemonade.”
- Hattie:** “I didn’t salt the lemonade.”
- Della:** “Yusuf didn’t salt the lemonade.”
- Pablo:** “Yusuf is telling the truth.”
- Yusuf:** “Either Arlo or Pablo salted the lemonade.”

The rule: The culprit is lying. Everyone else is telling the truth.

Test each suspect. Write T (true) or F (false) for each statement.

	A.	H.	D.	P.	Y.	True	Fits?
If Arlo did it							
If Hattie did it							
If Della did it							
If Pablo did it							
If Yusuf did it							

57 Who Fed the Gulls?

★★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Nine pots of chowder were simmering for the cook-off on the town pier when someone tossed a bag of popcorn off the end, and two hundred gulls came down on the tasting tables. Otis whistled a sea shanty at them, slightly off-key, which only seemed to encourage them. Five people were out at the end of the pier, and each says one thing. Before the gulls come back for seconds, can you name the popcorn tosser?

- Carmen:** “Basil didn’t feed the gulls.”
- Otis:** “Either Imani or Zeke fed the gulls.”
- Imani:** “Carmen is telling the truth.”
- Basil:** “Neither Otis nor Imani fed the gulls.”
- Zeke:** “Basil is telling the truth.”

The rule: Exactly four of these statements are true.

Test each suspect. Write T (true) or F (false) for each statement.

	C.	O.	I.	B.	Z.	True	Fits?
If Carmen did it							
If Otis did it							
If Imani did it							
If Basil did it							
If Zeke did it							

58 Who Gave the Trophy a Mustache?

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

An hour before the Harbor Days awards, the sandcastle trophy turned up on the prize table wearing a curly mustache in grease pencil. It wipes right off, and the committee admits the trophy has never looked more distinguished. Still, five people had been near the table, and each has one statement to make. Can you find the artist before the awards begin?

Vera: “Lou is telling the truth.”

Gideon: “Vera is telling the truth.”

Felix: “Neither Vera nor I drew the mustache on the trophy.”

Priya: “Gideon didn’t draw the mustache on the trophy.”

Lou: “Neither Gideon nor Priya drew the mustache on the trophy.”

The rule: Exactly one of these statements is true.

Test each suspect. Write T (true) or F (false) for each statement.

	V.	G.	F.	P.	L.	True	Fits?
If Vera did it							
If Gideon did it							
If Felix did it							
If Priya did it							
If Lou did it							

Scratch Pad

For working things out, testing a “Suppose,” or making notes.

CHAPTER 5

Two Clues at Once



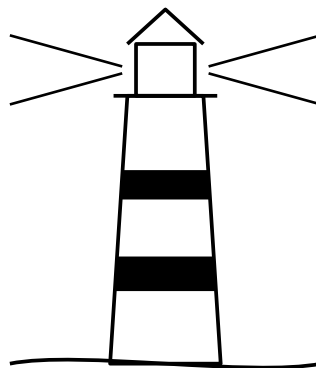
You will learn: Number clues, comparisons, and clues that work as a team

Difficulty up to ★★☆☆☆

Puzzles 59–78

September and October: apple picking, the fishing derby, the pumpkin weigh-off and the harvest supper. The puzzles now come with numbers: ages, prices, weights and times.

Here clues start working in pairs. One clue tells you a little; two together tell you a lot. Lesson 5 shows you how to make clues team up. Keep a pencil handy, and read the clues twice.



LESSON 5

Clues That Team Up

Three old friends keep boats in the harbor. They are 60, 65 and 70 years old, and they own a dory, a skiff and a sloop.

- ☐ **1.** Walt is older than Mabel.
- ☐ **2.** Of Mabel and the skiff's owner, one is 65 and the other is 70.
- ☐ **3.** Nico does not own the dory.

Comparisons rule out the ends

Clue 1 says Walt is older than Mabel. So Walt cannot be the youngest, 60, and Mabel cannot be the oldest, 70. Mark those two X's straight away.

A pair clue

Clue 2 says: of Mabel and the skiff's owner, one is 65 and the other is 70. A pair clue tells you three things at once.

- Mabel is 65 or 70.
- The skiff's owner is 65 or 70.
- Mabel is not the skiff's owner, because they are two different people.

		Age			Boat		
		60	65	70	dory	skiff	sloop
Name	Walt	X					
	Nico						
	Mabel	X		X		X	
Boat	dory						
	skiff	X					
	sloop						

Clues 1 and 2, each read on its own.

Two clues together

Now let them team up. Clue 2 says Mabel is 65 or 70. Clue 1 says she is not 70. So Mabel is 65, and by clue 2 the skiff's owner is 70.

Clue 1 again: Walt is older than Mabel, who is 65, so Walt is 70. That makes Walt the skiff's owner, and Nico is 60.

Finally, clue 3: Nico does not own the dory, and the skiff is Walt's, so Nico owns the sloop and Mabel owns the dory.

		Age			Boat		
		60	65	70	dory	skiff	sloop
Name	Walt	×	×	●	×	●	×
	Nico	●	×	×	×	×	●
	Mabel	×	●	×	●	×	×
Boat	dory	×	●	×			
	skiff	×	×	●			
	sloop	●	×	×			

The finished grid.

Go back to the clues. A clue that told you only a little at first can tell you much more once other facts are in. When you are stuck, read every clue again, slowly.

Number words

- **“Older than,” “cost more than,” “later than”:** the first person cannot have the smallest number, and the second cannot have the largest.
- **“Exactly 10 years older”:** the gap is fixed. If the younger is 60, the older is 70.
- **“One hour after”:** a gap of exactly one step.

Scratch Pad

For working things out, testing a “Suppose,” or making notes.

59 Apples by the Pound

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Crisp September air brought four friends to Hilltop Orchard, and each came down from the ladders with one basket of one kind of apple. The farm stand charges by the pound, but the scale’s paper tape has jammed, and Mabel is busy removing a stray apostrophe from the sign that reads “Fresh Apple’s.” Who picked which apple, and how much did each friend pick?

- ☐ 1. The Macoun picker’s basket held exactly 15 pounds more than Pablo’s.
- ☐ 2. Of Pablo and Sam, one picked 10 pounds and the other picked 20 pounds.
- ☐ 3. Pablo’s basket held neither Baldwin nor Empire apples.
- ☐ 4. The Baldwin basket weighed neither 20 pounds nor 25 pounds.
- ☐ 5. Mabel’s basket weighed either 20 pounds or 25 pounds.

Your answers

Picker	Apple	Weight
Pablo		
Mabel		
Kit		
Sam		

		Apple				Weight			
Picker		Cortland	Macoun	Baldwin	Empire	10 pounds	15 pounds	20 pounds	25 pounds
	Pablo								
	Mabel								
	Kit								
	Sam								
Weight	10 pounds								
	15 pounds								
	20 pounds								
	25 pounds								

60 The Elm Street Yard Sale

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Over Labor Day weekend, four neighbors on Elm Street hauled a hundred odds and ends onto one long table and shared a single cash box. By the time the rain came, right when Gus's knee said it would, each of them had sold exactly one treasure, and the notes in the cash box had turned into soggy scribbles. Before anyone splits the money, who sold what, and for how much?

- ☐ 1. Dot took in more money than Gus did.
- ☐ 2. Vera made more than whoever sold the teapot.
- ☐ 3. Of the \$4 seller and the \$8 seller, one was Vera and the other was Linus.
- ☐ 4. Of the teapot and the records, one sold for \$8 and the other for \$2.
- ☐ 5. Neither Linus nor Dot sold the lamp.

Your answers

Seller	Item	Price
Linus		
Vera		
Gus		
Dot		

		Item				Price			
Seller	Linus	lamp	teapot	birdcage	records	\$2	\$4	\$6	\$8
	Vera								
	Gus								
	Dot								
Price	\$2								
	\$4								
	\$6								
	\$8								

61 The Smudged Class Roll

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Tuesday is school night again in Thimble Harbor, this time for grown-ups, with evening classes until nine. Mabel, who now teaches the grammar class, keeps the roll for the whole building. Four new students each signed up for one class and wrote an age on the form, in a pencil that has since smudged, and Mabel does not accept a smudged roll. Who is taking which class, and how old is each?

- ☐ 1. Jade is younger than Felix.
- ☐ 2. Hugo is older than Felix.
- ☐ 3. Una is younger than Jade.
- ☐ 4. The guitar student is exactly 15 years older than the watercolor student.
- ☐ 5. Jade did not sign up for Spanish.

Your answers

Student	Class	Age
Felix		
Jade		
Hugo		
Una		

		Class				Age			
		watercolor	Spanish	pottery	guitar	40	45	50	55
Student	Felix								
	Jade								
	Hugo								
	Una								
Age	40								
	45								
	50								
	55								

62 The Fishing Derby Trophy

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

At dawn on derby day, four anglers cast their lines from the town pier, and each landed one fish of a different kind and a different length before the noon horn. Otis measured every catch, whistling a shanty off-key, then wrote the lengths on a tide chart that the wind carried straight into the harbor. The trophy goes to the longest fish. Who caught what, and who takes the trophy home?

- ☐ 1. Oscar's fish was longer than the mackerel.
- ☐ 2. The bluefish measured either 16 inches or 18 inches.
- ☐ 3. Cyrus landed a shorter fish than Oscar did.
- ☐ 4. Elsa reeled in either the flounder or the scup.
- ☐ 5. The fish that measured 16 inches was either the mackerel or the flounder.
- ☐ 6. Elsa's fish was longer than Oscar's.

Your question: Who wins the derby trophy?

		Fish				Length			
Angler	Elsa	scup	bluefish	mackerel	flounder	12 inches	14 inches	16 inches	18 inches
	Nico								
	Oscar								
	Cyrus								
Length	12 inches								
	14 inches								
	16 inches								
	18 inches								

Your answers

Angler	Fish	Length
Elsa		
Nico		
Oscar		
Cyrus		

63 The Ferry Schedule Shuffle

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Jonah's ferry leaves every half hour on September mornings, never a minute late. Last Tuesday, four regulars each rode a different morning run to a different stop, and Pilot greeted each of them in his little orange life vest. Now two of the four say they saw a light blink out at Thimble Point on the way, though the old lamp is supposed to be dark. Jonah wants his passenger log straight. Who rode when, and where?

- ☐ 1. Of the Pine Key passenger and the mainland passenger, one sailed at 7:00 a.m. and the other at 8:00 a.m.
- ☐ 2. Amara and Tova took the 7:00 a.m. and 8:30 a.m. ferries, one apiece.
- ☐ 3. Tova's ticket was for neither Gull Island nor the mainland.
- ☐ 4. The Gull Island passenger sailed exactly half an hour after Ruben.

Your answers

Passenger	Stop	Ferry
Ruben		
Priya		
Amara		
Tova		

		Stop				Ferry			
		Gull Island	Cobb Point	Pine Key	the mainland	7:00 a.m.	7:30 a.m.	8:00 a.m.	8:30 a.m.
Passenger	Ruben								
	Priya								
	Amara								
	Tova								
Ferry	7:00 a.m.								
	7:30 a.m.								
	8:00 a.m.								
	8:30 a.m.								

64 The Whispered Fines

★★★☆☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Rain drummed on the library roof, and four patrons came in to pay overdue fines, each for a different book. Wren whispered every amount as she took it, so softly that not even Wren heard herself. She whispers one more puzzle, too: the 1876 keeper's logbook is checked out to an "S. Bell," and Silas Bell, the last keeper, has been gone for eighty years. First things first: who paid how much, and for which book?

- ☐ 1. Marta and Basil were the two who paid 50 cents and 75 cents, in some order.
- ☐ 2. The biography fine was exactly a quarter more than the atlas fine.
- ☐ 3. One of Marta and Ivan paid the atlas fine, and the other paid the biography fine.
- ☐ 4. The poetry fine was either 50 cents or 75 cents.
- ☐ 5. Whoever paid 25 cents owed it for either the atlas or the biography.

Your answers

Patron	Book	Fine
Teddy		
Basil		
Marta		
Ivan		

		Book				Fine			
		biography	atlas	poetry	thriller	25 cents	50 cents	75 cents	\$1.00
Patron	Teddy								
	Basil								
	Marta								
	Ivan								
Fine	25 cents								
	50 cents								
	75 cents								
	\$1.00								

65 The Pumpkin Weigh-Off

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Wagons groaned onto the town green for the October weigh-off with four giant pumpkins, each with a pet name painted on its side and a secret fertilizer its grower will not discuss. The big scale worked perfectly; its printout came out blank. Mabel, whose dahlia rivalry has spread to squash, wants every ribbon pinned on the right pumpkin. Whose pumpkin is whose, what was each one fed, and how much does each weigh?

- ☐ 1. Zeke did not use compost.
- ☐ 2. The coffee-fed pumpkin was either Sunny or Big Mo.
- ☐ 3. The pumpkin that weighed 400 pounds was fed either seaweed or coffee.
- ☐ 4. Whoever used seaweed grew either Tubby or Sunny.
- ☐ 5. Tubby did not weigh 600 pounds.
- ☐ 6. Gus's pumpkin weighed less than the one fed seaweed.
- ☐ 7. Of Tubby's grower and the compost user, one brought in 500 pounds and the other 600 pounds.
- ☐ 8. Kenji and Zeke were, in some order, the grower who used fish meal and the grower whose pumpkin weighed 600 pounds.
- ☐ 9. Big Mo belonged to either Kenji or Mabel.

		Pumpkin	Fertilizer				Weight						
Grower	Zeke	Big Mo	Sunny	Tubby	Duchess	seaweed	compost	fish meal	coffee	300 pounds	400 pounds	500 pounds	600 pounds
	Gus												
	Kenji												
	Mabel												
Weight	300 pounds												
	400 pounds												
	500 pounds												
	600 pounds												
Fertilizer	seaweed												
	compost												
	fish meal												
	coffee												

Your answers

Grower	Pumpkin	Fertilizer	Weight
Zeke			
Gus			
Kenji			
Mabel			

66 The Harvest Supper Arrivals

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Of all the nights on Hattie's clipboard, the harvest supper is the biggest. Her four cooks arrived fifteen minutes apart, each with a different dish carried in a different way, and Hattie wrote down every detail on the one sheet she now cannot find. The doors of St. Brendan's Church Hall open at six, and the table plan is still blank. Who brought what, how, and when?

- ☐ 1. Dev arrived exactly 30 minutes after whoever came with the wagon.
- ☐ 2. The squash soup arrived exactly 45 minutes after Lou did.
- ☐ 3. Either Rosa or Selma carried the basket.
- ☐ 4. The apple crisp came through the door later than Rosa did.
- ☐ 5. The baked beans were not Rosa's.
- ☐ 6. The box showed up exactly 30 minutes after the basket.

Your answers

Cook	Dish	Carrier	Arrival
Rosa			
Lou			
Selma			
Dev			

		Dish				Carrier				Arrival			
		squash soup	cornbread	baked beans	apple crisp	basket	wagon	tote bag	box	5:00 p.m.	5:15 p.m.	5:30 p.m.	5:45 p.m.
Cook	Rosa												
	Lou												
	Selma												
	Dev												
Arrival	5:00 p.m.												
	5:15 p.m.												
	5:30 p.m.												
	5:45 p.m.												
Carrier	basket												
	wagon												
	tote bag												
	box												

67 The Corn Maze Chalkboard

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Hilltop Orchard's corn maze has four ways in: two gates, the old barn door, and a gap beside the scarecrow. Four friends each took a different one and chose a different snack at the exit. The farmer chalked their times on the board, and then a squall washed it clean. Jonah, who keeps his ferry on time to the minute, had left his watch at home. Who went in where, with which snack, and how fast?

- ☐ 1. Whoever went in by the scarecrow got through faster than whoever went in by the barn door.
- ☐ 2. Quinn's snack was not the kettle corn.
- ☐ 3. The friend who used the barn door finished in either 20 minutes or 30 minutes.
- ☐ 4. Jonah took longer than Quinn.
- ☐ 5. The friend who entered by the north gate had neither the kettle corn nor the donut.
- ☐ 6. Of the south gate friend and the 25-minute friend, one picked the donut and the other picked the kettle corn.
- ☐ 7. The 25-minute finisher picked either the donut or the candy apple.
- ☐ 8. Either Quinn or Jonah took 30 minutes.
- ☐ 9. The friend with the candy apple needed either 30 minutes or 35 minutes.
- ☐ 10. Quinn and Faye were, in some order, the 20-minute finisher and the 35-minute finisher.

		Entrance				Snack				Time			
		north gate	south gate	barn door	scarecrow	cider	kettle corn	candy apple	donut	20 minutes	25 minutes	30 minutes	35 minutes
Friend	Jonah												
	Faye												
	Quinn												
	Hal												
Time	20 minutes												
	25 minutes												
	30 minutes												
	35 minutes												
Snack	cider												
	kettle corn												
	candy apple												
	donut												

Your answers

Friend	Entrance	Snack	Time
Jonah			
Faye			
Quinn			
Hal			

68 The Sticky Auction Receipts

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Going once, going twice: four antique clocks sold at the St. Brendan's autumn auction, each made in a different year from a different wood, and each to a different buyer. Hattie wrote a receipt for every sale, then set her mug of hot cider down on the stack. The receipts are now one sticky brick. Can you match each buyer to a clock, a wood, and a year?

- ☐ 1. Della and Otis were, in some order, the buyers of the 1880 clock and the 1890 clock.
- ☐ 2. Otis went home with a newer clock than the mantel clock.
- ☐ 3. Neither Otis nor Della bought the cuckoo clock.
- ☐ 4. The oak clock is exactly 30 years newer than the walnut clock.
- ☐ 5. Of Otis and Carmen, one bought the cherry clock and the other bought the maple clock.
- ☐ 6. The banjo clock is exactly 20 years newer than the clock Otis bought.
- ☐ 7. The maple clock was made exactly 10 years after the cherry clock.

		Clock				Wood				Year			
Buyer		mantel clock				cuckoo clock				banjo clock			
		ship's clock				oak				walnut			
						cherry				maple			
						1880				1890			
						1900				1910			
Year													
Wood													

Your answers

Buyer	Clock	Wood	Year
Otis			
Della			
Carmen			
Pablo			

69 The Lobster Trap Tally

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Ask Nico about Tuesday's haul off Seal Ledge and the numbers grow with every telling, along with the lobster, which is now the size of a wheelbarrow. Four skippers went out that morning, each with a different bait and buoys of a different color. The lobster co-op's tally sheet wants facts, not fish stories. Who used which bait and which buoys, and how many traps did each skipper haul?

- ☐ 1. Nico's bait was not herring.
- ☐ 2. Yusuf hauled more traps than Nico.
- ☐ 3. Whoever had the orange buoys hauled neither 20 traps nor 50 traps.
- ☐ 4. The herring skipper's buoys were lime.
- ☐ 5. Arlo hauled more traps than whoever baited with squid.
- ☐ 6. Of Arlo and Yusuf, one baited with pogies and the other hauled 30 traps.
- ☐ 7. Between the pogies skipper and the squid skipper, one hauled 40 traps and the other hauled 50.
- ☐ 8. Whoever baited with pogies did not have white buoys.

		Bait				Buoy				Traps			
		herring	pogies	redfish	squid	orange	white	purple	lime	20	30	40	50
Skipper	Arlo												
	Yusuf												
	Greta												
	Nico												
Traps	20												
	30												
	40												
	50												
Buoy	orange												
	white												
	purple												
	lime												

Your answers

Skipper	Bait	Buoy	Traps
Arlo			
Yusuf			
Greta			
Nico			

70 The Apple Pie Bake-Off

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Rosa judged the apple pie bake-off at the Salt & Sugar Bakery, and four pies came out of the ovens smelling like October itself. Each baker chose a different crust and a different spice, and each pie spent a different time in the oven. Rosa wants the secrets for her recipe box, and she has promised not to tell her sourdough starters. Who made which crust, with which spice, and how long did each pie bake?

- ☐ 1. Of the pie with the crumble crust and the pie that baked 55 minutes, one had nutmeg and the other had ginger.
- ☐ 2. The cardamom pie stayed in the oven longer than the ginger pie.
- ☐ 3. Imani's pie baked for less time than the lattice pie.
- ☐ 4. Priya's crust was not the plain one.
- ☐ 5. The lattice pie baked exactly 5 minutes longer than the ginger pie.
- ☐ 6. Of Vito and the baker whose pie baked 40 minutes, one made the crumble crust and the other the braided one.
- ☐ 7. The lattice pie baked for 50 minutes.

		Crust				Spice				Bake			
Baker	Priya												
	Vito												
	Imani												
	Boris												
Bake	40 minutes												
	45 minutes												
	50 minutes												
	55 minutes												
Spice	cinnamon												
	nutmeg												
	ginger												
	cardamom												

Your answers

Baker	Crust	Spice	Bake
Priya			
Vito			
Imani			
Boris			

71 The Hiking Club Summits

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Fall color peaked on the long October weekend, and four members of the hiking club set off up four different hills. Wren whispered the whole way up hers, though there was nobody to disturb but a chipmunk. Back at the trailhead, the club's logbook shows four summit heights and not one name, and Felix calls that anything but shipshape. Who hiked which hill, what did each pack for a snack, and how high did each one top out?

- ☐ 1. Felix topped out at neither 1,000 feet nor 1,200 feet.
- ☐ 2. Whoever hiked Bramble Hill did not top out at 1,200 feet.
- ☐ 3. Cass topped out lower than whoever packed the jerky.
- ☐ 4. Neither Felix nor Enzo packed the figs.
- ☐ 5. The hiker with the trail mix topped out exactly 200 feet above the hiker with the jerky.
- ☐ 6. Of Wren and Enzo, one topped out at 1,400 feet and the other at 1,200 feet.
- ☐ 7. The hiker on Fiddler Hill topped out exactly 400 feet higher than Cass.
- ☐ 8. Crow's Nest was climbed by neither Felix nor Enzo.
- ☐ 9. Neither Enzo nor Cass topped out at 1,400 feet.

		Hill	Snack	Height
Hiker	Felix			
	Wren			
	Enzo			
	Cass			
Height	800 feet			
	1,000 feet			
	1,200 feet			
	1,400 feet			
Snack	trail mix			
	jerky			
	cheese			
	figs			

Your answers

Hiker	Hill	Snack	Height
Felix			
Wren			
Enzo			
Cass			

72 The Gazette Ad Rates

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Autumn is ad season at the Gazette, and four advertisers have bought space. Lena's ad is the proudest of the lot: it announces the Keeper's Lamp's 150th-birthday lighting at the Lantern Festival. Gus's ad sells rubber boots, because his knee says rain. But every invoice went out wrong, and Ada would like them fixed before anyone pays twice. Who chose which border, in which section, and what did each ad cost?

- ☐ 1. Of the plain-bordered ad and the wavy-bordered ad, one ran in the puzzles section and the other in the tides section.
- ☐ 2. Olive paid exactly 20 dollars less than whoever advertised in the tides section.
- ☐ 3. Tariq's ad cost exactly 20 dollars more than the one with the dotted border.
- ☐ 4. Gus did not pick the wavy border.
- ☐ 5. The ad in the tides section and the \$20 ad came from different advertisers: one had a plain border, the other a dotted border.
- ☐ 6. The ad in the recipes section cost exactly 10 dollars less than Olive's.

		Border				Section				Price			
		plain	dotted	wavy	rope	sports	recipes	tides	puzzles	\$10	\$20	\$30	\$40
Advertiser	Gus												
	Lena												
	Tariq												
	Olive												
Price	\$10												
	\$20												
	\$30												
	\$40												
Section	sports												
	recipes												
	tides												
	puzzles												

Your answers

Advertiser	Border	Section	Price
Gus			
Lena			
Tariq			
Olive			

73 The Lamp Fund Jar

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Since spring, the Keeper's Lamp fund jar has sat by the register at Mahoney's, collecting for the lamp's 150th-birthday celebration. One October afternoon four donors fed it, each tucking a little note in with the money. Gus counted it all in a hurry, and now the notes and the gifts are hopelessly shuffled. The Gazette wants to thank each donor properly. Who gave how much, how did each one pay, and who left which note?

- ☐ 1. Of the donor who tucked in a poem and the one who gave \$25, one was Jonah and the other was Lena.
- ☐ 2. Tova gave exactly 25 dollars less than whoever left the thank-you.
- ☐ 3. Of Lena and the \$100 donor, one paid by check and the other in cash.
- ☐ 4. Tova did not pay in coin.
- ☐ 5. The check came with either a riddle or a drawing.
- ☐ 6. Whoever gave \$50 tucked in either a thank-you or a riddle.

		Paid				Note				Gift			
Donor	Gift	\$25	\$50	\$75	\$100	poem	drawing	thank-you	riddle	check	cash	coin	money order
	Note	poem	drawing	thank-you	riddle	check	cash	coin	money order	\$25	\$50	\$75	\$100

Your answers

Donor	Paid	Note	Gift
Lena			
Jonah			
Tova			
Gus			

74 The Firewood Orders

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

When the first cold snap hit, four households on Hattie's lane wanted firewood, so she took every order on one of her lists. That list is now somewhere on another list, possibly clipped to a third. The wood came Saturday, every neighbor had a load stacked by Sunday night, and the woodcutter's bill still needs checking. Who chose which wood, how many cords did each neighbor order, and where was each load stacked?

- ☐ 1. Of the neighbor who chose oak and the one who ordered 3 cords, one stacked the wood by the garage and the other by the porch.
- ☐ 2. Amara ordered exactly 2 fewer cords than whoever chose ash.
- ☐ 3. Hattie's wood was either ash or oak.
- ☐ 4. Ruben ordered fewer cords than the neighbor who chose maple.
- ☐ 5. The neighbor who stacked wood by the garage ordered fewer cords than the one who chose birch.
- ☐ 6. The neighbor who chose maple and the one who stacked by the shed were different people; one ordered 3 cords and the other 2 cords.

		Wood				Stacked				Cords			
		oak	birch	maple	ash	porch	shed	barn	garage	1 cord	2 cords	3 cords	4 cords
Neighbor	Kit												
	Hattie												
	Ruben												
	Amara												
Cords	1 cord												
	2 cords												
	3 cords												
	4 cords												
Stacked	porch												
	shed												
	barn												
	garage												

Your answers

Neighbor	Wood	Stacked	Cords
Kit			
Hattie			
Ruben			
Amara			

75 The Harvest Shuttle Fares

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Twice an hour on harvest weekend, a hay wagon rattles from Main Street to Hilltop Orchard's fields. Four riders paid different fares to different stops, and each rode home with an armful from the market barn, Teddy with his camera perched on top of the pile. Now the fare can is a dollar off, and the farmer wants it to balance before the next run. Where did each rider go, what did each carry home, and what did each pay?

- ☐ 1. Basil paid exactly \$2 more than the rider bound for the farm stand.
- ☐ 2. The rider headed for the corn maze paid exactly \$6 more than Teddy.
- ☐ 3. Teddy and the orchard gate rider were two different people: one carried home the apple crate, the other the cider jug.
- ☐ 4. Nadia's fare was higher than Zeke's.
- ☐ 5. Whoever rode to the corn maze paid more than whoever took home the pumpkin.
- ☐ 6. The rider with the pumpkin paid more than the one bound for the farm stand.
- ☐ 7. Whoever carried home the apple crate paid more than Teddy.
- ☐ 8. The rider with the apple crate did not pay \$5.

		Stop	Carried				Fare			
Rider		corn maze	cider stand	orchard gate	farm stand	pumpkin	apple crate	cider jug	mums	
Fare										
Carried										

Your answers

Rider	Stop	Carried	Fare
Teddy			
Basil			
Nadia			
Zeke			

76 The Quilt Raffle

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Hattie hung four quilts across the church hall stage for the fall raffle, each a year's work by the sewing circle. Four hopefuls bought tickets, each for a different quilt and with a different room already picked out for it. Wren, for one, whispers that she has measured twice. Before the drawing, Hattie wants every stub checked against her list. Who entered for which quilt, how many tickets did each buy, and which room did each have in mind?

- ☐ 1. Of the entrant who bought 2 tickets and the one who bought 4, one entered for the star quilt and the other for the nine patch.
- ☐ 2. Whoever entered for the nine patch quilt bought exactly 2 more tickets than the one with the bedroom in mind.
- ☐ 3. The entrant with the porch in mind bought more tickets than the one who entered for the nine patch quilt.
- ☐ 4. Jade's tickets were for either the nine patch or the wedding ring quilt.
- ☐ 5. The entrant with the den in mind bought exactly 4 more tickets than Emil.
- ☐ 6. Pablo bought more tickets than whoever wanted a quilt for the porch.

		Quilt				Wants it for				Tickets			
Entrant		log cabin	star	nine patch	wedding ring	bedroom	den	porch	guest room	2	4	6	8
	Emil												
	Wren												
	Jade												
	Pablo												
Tickets	2												
	4												
	6												
	8												
Wants it for	bedroom												
	den												
	porch												
	guest room												

Your answers

Entrant	Quilt	Wants it for	Tickets
Emil			
Wren			
Jade			
Pablo			

77 The Cider Press Batches

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Come October, Felix wheels the old cider press out of the boatyard's paint shed and lends it to the neighbors for a fair share of each batch. This year four pressed, Felix included, each with a different apple mix and a hand-drawn label for the jugs. Nobody wrote down the gallons, and a fair share needs numbers. Who pressed which mix, who drew which label, and how much cider did each one make?

- ☐ **1.** The neighbor who drew the owl label made more cider than the one who drew the moon.
- ☐ **2.** Of the neighbor who made 5 gallons and the one who made 10, one pressed the wild mix and the other the tart.
- ☐ **3.** The tart and spicy mixes came from two different neighbors: one made 5 gallons, the other 15 gallons.
- ☐ **4.** Cyrus made more cider than Felix.
- ☐ **5.** Whoever drew the star label made exactly 5 gallons more than whoever pressed the spicy mix.
- ☐ **6.** Marta made less cider than the neighbor who drew the moon.
- ☐ **7.** Felix made exactly 5 gallons more than the neighbor with the moon label.

		Mix	Label				Gallons			
Neighbor	Marta									
	Priya									
	Cyrus									
	Felix									
Gallons	5 gallons									
	10 gallons									
	15 gallons									
	20 gallons									
Label	owl									
	anchor									
	moon									
	star									

Your answers

Neighbor	Mix	Label	Gallons
Marta			
Priya			
Cyrus			
Felix			

78 The Costume Parade

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Candy rained on Main Street as the Halloween parade closed out October. Four grown-ups marched in costume, each handing out a different sweet from a different-sized bag, and every last piece was gone by the bandstand. Ada wants the counts for Thursday's write-up. "The Gazette prints numbers, not guesses," she says. Who wore which costume, who brought which candy, and how many pieces did each one hand out?

- ☐ 1. Of the marcher with the caramels and the one with the licorice, one was a mermaid and the other a robot.
- ☐ 2. Either Dot or Hugo handed out 100 pieces.
- ☐ 3. The taffy came from either Otis or Mabel.
- ☐ 4. Hugo was not the pirate.
- ☐ 5. Hugo handed out more pieces than the scarecrow did.
- ☐ 6. The taffy and the licorice came from two different marchers: one gave away 50 pieces, the other 125 pieces.
- ☐ 7. The mermaid handed out fewer pieces than Otis.
- ☐ 8. Whoever had the caramels handed out exactly 25 more pieces than the pirate.

		Costume				Candy			Handed out				
		pirate	mermaid	scarecrow	robot	taffy	caramels	licorice	gumdrops	50 pieces	75 pieces	100 pieces	125 pieces
Marcher	Mabel												
	Otis												
	Hugo												
	Dot												
Handed out	50 pieces												
	75 pieces												
	100 pieces												
	125 pieces												
Candy	taffy												
	caramels												
	licorice												
	gumdrops												

Your answers

Marcher	Costume	Candy	Handed out
Mabel			
Otis			
Hugo			
Dot			

Scratch Pad

For working things out, testing a “Suppose,” or making notes.

CHAPTER 6

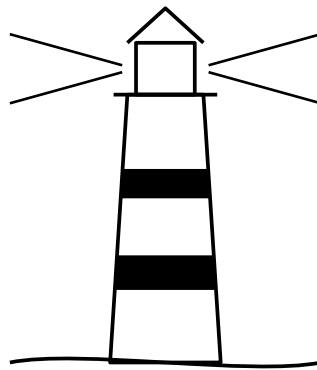
Case Files

You will learn: Five-suspect cases and your first careful 'Suppose'

Difficulty up to ★★★★★ Puzzles 79–95

November. The boats are hauled out, the first frost is on the boatyard, and the mysteries are bigger: a missing heirloom, a sunk rowboat, a key that wandered off for a day.

These are full case files, with five suspects and three things to match for each, and every one ends with a question to answer. The last nine need one careful “Suppose.” Lesson 6 shows you how to test an idea in pencil and know for certain.



LESSON 6

One Careful Suppose

Sometimes every clue has told you all it can, and the grid still has blanks. That is when you use a “Suppose.” It is not guessing. It is testing.

Four neighbors returned library books one morning, one each hour from 9 a.m. to noon.

- ☐ **1.** The diary borrower came later than the almanac borrower.
- ☐ **2.** Of the atlas borrower and the cookbook borrower, one is Dot and the other is Wren.
- ☐ **3.** The diary borrower came one hour after the cookbook borrower.
- ☐ **4.** Dot came earlier than the atlas borrower.
- ☐ **5.** Basil borrowed neither the atlas nor the diary.

As far as the clues go

Clue 4 says Dot came earlier than the atlas borrower, so Dot did not borrow the atlas. By clue 2, Dot borrowed the cookbook and Wren the atlas. Clue 5 leaves Basil only the almanac, so Otis borrowed the diary.

The time clues give a few X's. Clue 1: the diary was not at 9 a.m., and the almanac was not at noon. Clue 3: the cookbook was not at noon. Clue 4: Dot was not at noon, and the atlas was not at 9 a.m. Carry each X across to the names.

		Book				Time			
		atlas	cookbook	diary	almanac	9 a.m.	10 a.m.	11 a.m.	noon
Name	Wren	●	X	X	X	X			
	Otis	X	X	●	X	X			
	Dot	X	●	X	X				X
	Basil	X	X	X	●				X
Time	9 a.m.	X		X					
	10 a.m.								
	11 a.m.								
	noon		X		X				

Names and books are done. The times are not.

That is all the clues can say. The times still have several choices. So we test one.

Suppose

Pick a row with only two or three choices left and test one of them in pencil. Suppose Dot came at 9 a.m.

Then the cookbook came at 9 a.m. By clue 3, the diary came one hour later, at 10 a.m. By clue 1, the almanac came earlier than the diary, so at 9 a.m. But 9 a.m. already belongs to Dot and her cookbook. Two people cannot come at the same time. The supposition breaks.

		Book				Time			
		atlas	cookbook	diary	almanac	9 a.m.	10 a.m.	11 a.m.	noon
Name	Wren	●	X	X	X	X			
	Otis	X	X	●	X	X			
	Dot	X	●	X	X	●	X	X	X
	Basil	X	X	X	●	X			X
Time	9 a.m.	X	●	X	X				
	10 a.m.	X	X	●	X				
	11 a.m.		X	X	X				
	noon		X	X	X				

In pencil: if Dot came at 9 a.m., the almanac has nowhere to go.

So Dot did not come at 9 a.m. Erase the pencil marks and put a firm X there.

Now the clues work again. Who came at 9 a.m.? Not Dot. Not Wren, whose atlas came later than Dot (clue 4). Not Otis, whose diary came later than the almanac (clue 1). So Basil and the almanac came at 9 a.m. Who came at 10 a.m.? Not Otis: his diary came one hour after Dot's cookbook (clue 3), and Dot came at 10 a.m. at the earliest. Not Wren: her atlas came

later than Dot (clue 4). So Dot came at 10 a.m., the diary at 11 a.m., and Wren's atlas at noon.

Suppose in pencil, conclude in pen. Write "Suppose" above the grid. If you reach a contradiction, erase everything you added and mark one firm X on the square you tested. If you do not reach a contradiction, the test tells you nothing: erase it and try another square.

When to Suppose

- Only after every clue has been read again and nothing new comes.
- Choose a row with two choices if you can. Then a contradiction settles the row at once.
- One Suppose at a time. Every five-star puzzle in this book needs only one.

79 The Case of the Pie Server

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Sixty years of church suppers, and Hattie's grandmother's silver pie server had never gone astray. Then came the early-November pie auction, where the town orders its Thanksgiving pies, and somewhere between bids it vanished. Five helpers each baked one pie, arrived at a different time and worked a different spot. The server turned up that night in a coat in the cloakroom, and only the cloakroom helper had handled the coats. Who slipped the pie server into a coat pocket?

- ☐ 1. Whoever worked the stage arrived exactly 45 minutes after the mince pie's baker.
- ☐ 2. Neither Della nor Vito baked the pecan pie.
- ☐ 3. Of the pecan pie's baker and the helper at the bake table, one was Rosa and the other was Della.
- ☐ 4. Whoever baked the mince pie worked either the kitchen or the bake table.
- ☐ 5. The pumpkin pie's baker arrived 15 minutes after the stage helper did.
- ☐ 6. Of the pumpkin pie's baker and the porch helper, one was Gus and the other was Imani.
- ☐ 7. The helper on the porch arrived later than the one at the bake table.
- ☐ 8. Vito and Imani baked the apple pie and the mince pie, one apiece.

Your question: Who slipped the pie server into a coat pocket?

		Pie					Spot					Time				
		pecan	pumpkin	apple	mince	cherry	kitchen	stage	cloakroom	porch	bake table	6:00 p.m.	6:15 p.m.	6:30 p.m.	6:45 p.m.	7:00 p.m.
Helper	Rosa															
	Gus															
	Della															
	Vito															
	Imani															
Time	6:00 p.m.															
	6:15 p.m.															
	6:30 p.m.															
	6:45 p.m.															
	7:00 p.m.															
Spot	kitchen															
	stage															
	cloakroom															
	porch															
	bake table															

80 The Case of the Loose Mooring

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Frost silvered the town pier one November morning, the week before haul-out, when someone untied Felix's sailboat, the Ripple, and let her drift onto Gull Rock. She has a scraped keel; Felix has a long face. Five early risers came down to the dock, each at a different time, in a different coat, on a different errand. A dog walker on the seawall saw someone in a yellow slicker bent over the Ripple's mooring line. Who untied the Ripple?

- ☐ 1. Whoever wore the fleece arrived half an hour after whoever came for mail.
- ☐ 2. Of Hal and the early riser in the barn coat, one came at 6:30 a.m. and the other at 7:00 a.m.
- ☐ 3. The 7:00 a.m. arrival came for neither bait nor mail.
- ☐ 4. Of the person in the peacoat and the one who came for mail, one was Walt and the other was Hal.
- ☐ 5. The person who arrived at 8:00 a.m. came for either diesel or mail.
- ☐ 6. The person in the slicker was there for neither bait nor coffee.
- ☐ 7. Quinn was not the one in the slicker.
- ☐ 8. Of the person who came for mail and the 8:00 a.m. arrival, one wore the fleece and the other the parka.
- ☐ 9. Either Walt or Bea came for coffee.

Your question: Who untied the Ripple?

		Coat					Errand					Time				
		slicker	peacoat	parka	barn coat	fleece	bait	mail	coffee	ice	diesel	6:00 a.m.	6:30 a.m.	7:00 a.m.	7:30 a.m.	8:00 a.m.
Early riser	Walt															
	Quinn															
	Bea															
	Nico															
	Hal															
Time	6:00 a.m.															
	6:30 a.m.															
	7:00 a.m.															
	7:30 a.m.															
	8:00 a.m.															
Errand	bait															
	mail															
	coffee															
	ice															
	diesel															

81 The Case of the Recipe Card

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Rosa's great-grandmother's cranberry bread recipe, in faded pencil on a card, has hung on the bakery corkboard for years. On Saturday morning it vanished, and Rosa swears even Gloria, her sourdough starter, looks worried. Five customers came in that morning, each at a different time, each ordering something different and sitting somewhere different. The corkboard hangs right beside the window table, out of reach of every other seat. Who pocketed the recipe card?

- ☐ 1. Neither Lou nor Mabel ordered the scone.
- ☐ 2. Selma came in later than whoever took the window seat.
- ☐ 3. Either Kenji or Priya ordered the croissant.
- ☐ 4. Neither Selma nor Priya came in at 8:00 a.m.
- ☐ 5. Of Priya and the bagel customer, one came in at 8:00 a.m. and the other at 7:30 a.m.
- ☐ 6. The 8:30 a.m. customer sat neither at the counter nor on the patio.
- ☐ 7. Whoever came in at 8:30 a.m. ordered either the danish or the croissant.
- ☐ 8. Mabel ordered neither the muffin nor the bagel.
- ☐ 9. The window seat went to either Selma or Lou.
- ☐ 10. The customer in the corner seat came in half an hour after the one in the window seat.
- ☐ 11. Whoever ordered the bagel sat either in the corner or at the counter.

Your question: Who pocketed the recipe card?

		Order					Seat					Time				
		muffin	scone	bagel	croissant	danish	window	counter	corner	patio	booth	7:00 a.m.	7:30 a.m.	8:00 a.m.	8:30 a.m.	9:00 a.m.
Customer	Selma															
	Priya															
	Kenji															
	Lou															
	Mabel															
Time	7:00 a.m.															
	7:30 a.m.															
	8:00 a.m.															
	8:30 a.m.															
	9:00 a.m.															
Seat	window															
	counter															
	corner															
	patio															
	booth															

82 The Case of the Copper Whale

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

For as long as anyone can remember, a copper whale has swung on the boatyard roof. On Wednesday morning the roof was bare, and Felix called it the least shipshape thing he had ever seen. Five visitors were in the yard the evening before, each with a different tool and a different excuse. The roof is too high to reach without a ladder, and fresh ladder marks dent the frost under the eaves. Who took down the copper whale?

- ☐ 1. Whoever carried the lantern is younger than whoever carried the ladder.
- ☐ 2. The visitor with the rope is older than the one with the ladder.
- ☐ 3. Of Milo and the visitor carrying the rope, one is 60 years old and the other is 40.
- ☐ 4. The visitor who claimed to be fishing is exactly 30 years older than the one who claimed to be sketching.
- ☐ 5. Whoever gave the fishing excuse is older than whoever brought the wrench.
- ☐ 6. Boris said he had been either jogging or sketching.
- ☐ 7. Of Cass and the visitor with the fishing excuse, one is 20 years old and the other is 60.
- ☐ 8. Jade's excuse was neither fishing nor stargazing.
- ☐ 9. Of the visitor who claimed to be jogging and the 50-year-old, one is Arlo and the other is Cass.

Your question: Who took down the copper whale?

		Tool					Excuse					Age				
Visitor		ladder	rope	wrench	lantern	crowbar	fishing	jogging	sketching	lost dog	stargazing	20	30	40	50	60
	Jade															
	Arlo															
	Boris															
	Cass															
	Milo															
Age	20															
	30															
	40															
	50															
	60															
Excuse	fishing															
	jogging															
	sketching															
	lost dog															
	stargazing															

83 The Case of the Crossword

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

The night before press day, someone changed three answers in Ada's crossword, and the Gazette came within one proofread of printing GULL as a kind of cheese. Five visitors used the puzzle desk that evening, each at a different time, with a different pen and a different snack. Inkwell the cat was a suspect for about a minute. All three changes are in green ink. Who scrambled the crossword?

- ☐ 1. Of Otis and Faye, one stopped by at 5:00 p.m. and the other at 6:30 p.m.
- ☐ 2. Of the visitor with the purple pen and the one who came at 5:30 p.m., one brought pretzels and the other brought almonds.
- ☐ 3. Whoever brought the almonds stopped by earlier than whoever brought the grapes.
- ☐ 4. Tariq and the visitor with the black pen were two different people: one brought grapes, the other pretzels.
- ☐ 5. The 6:00 p.m. visitor had either the blue pen or the green pen.
- ☐ 6. Whoever brought popcorn stopped by at either 5:30 p.m. or 6:30 p.m.
- ☐ 7. The 5:30 p.m. visitor, the one with almonds, the one with grapes, Otis, and the one with the blue pen were five different people.
- ☐ 8. Wren stopped by later than the visitor who brought grapes.

Your question: Who scrambled the crossword?

		Pen					Snack					Time				
Visitor		green	red	blue	black	purple	pretzels	fudge	grapes	popcorn	almonds	5:00 p.m.	5:30 p.m.	6:00 p.m.	6:30 p.m.	7:00 p.m.
Time	Otis															
	Faye															
	Emil															
	Tariq															
	Wren															
Snack	5:00 p.m.															
	5:30 p.m.															
	6:00 p.m.															
	6:30 p.m.															
	7:00 p.m.															
	pretzels															
	fudge															
	grapes															
	popcorn															
	almonds															

84 The Case of the Wandering Key

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○ Time _____

Otis keeps the spare lighthouse key on a hook in the harbor office. One November Thursday the hook sat empty, and by Friday morning the key was quietly back, as if it had never left. Five people visited the office that Thursday, each at a different hour, on a different errand, standing in a different spot. The hook is on the key wall, and only someone at that wall could have lifted the key unseen. Who borrowed the spare key?

- ☐ 1. Whoever stood by the window was neither Nadia nor Sam.
- ☐ 2. Teddy came to ask about either the tide chart or the radio.
- ☐ 3. Sam stood either by the window or by the map table.
- ☐ 4. The visitor with the permit question came in at either noon or 1:00 p.m.
- ☐ 5. Of the visitor who asked about the lost cap and the one by the desk, one came in at 9:00 a.m. and the other at 10:00 a.m.
- ☐ 6. The visitor by the window and the 10:00 a.m. visitor were two different people: one asked about the lost cap, the other about the permit.
- ☐ 7. The noon visitor asked about neither the radio nor the permit.
- ☐ 8. Whoever asked about the radio came in later than whoever stood by the stove.
- ☐ 9. Sam came in earlier than Teddy.
- ☐ 10. Of Lena and the visitor who came about the mooring fee, one came in at 10:00 a.m. and the other at 9:00 a.m.

Your question: Who borrowed the spare key?

		Visit	Spot					Time								
Visitor	Lena	tide chart	mooring fee	lost cap	radio	permit	key wall	desk	window	map table	stove	9:00 a.m.	10:00 a.m.	11:00 a.m.	noon	1:00 p.m.
	Gus															
	Nadia															
	Sam															
	Teddy															
Time	9:00 a.m.															
	10:00 a.m.															
	11:00 a.m.															
	noon															
	1:00 p.m.															
Spot	key wall															
	desk															
	window															
	map table															
	stove															

85 The Case of the Silent Bell

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

On the Sunday before Thanksgiving, the bell ringer at St. Brendan's heaved on the rope and got nothing but a soft thump: someone had wrapped the clapper in a wool scarf. The tower sign-in sheet (Hattie's idea, naturally) lists five climbers that week, each on a different weekday, each with a different scarf and a different reason. The scarf on the clapper is cable-knit. Who muffled the bell?

- ☐ 1. Whoever wore the striped scarf went up exactly 3 days after whoever climbed for the view.
- ☐ 2. Tova did not climb the tower for the view.
- ☐ 3. The climber who went up about the pigeons wore either the plaid or the cable scarf.
- ☐ 4. Linus made his climb on either Monday or Tuesday.
- ☐ 5. Whoever went up to do the dusting climbed on either Tuesday or Thursday.
- ☐ 6. The climber in the cable scarf was not the one who went up about the bats.
- ☐ 7. Linus did not go up about the pigeons.
- ☐ 8. Hattie climbed the tower for either repairs or dusting.
- ☐ 9. The climber who went up for repairs was either Tova or Pablo.
- ☐ 10. Gideon made his climb on either Thursday or Friday.
- ☐ 11. Of the climber who went up for the view and the one who went up about the pigeons, one wore the plaid scarf and the other the argyle.
- ☐ 12. Of the climber who went up about the bats and the one who went up about the pigeons, one was Linus and the other was Gideon.

Your question: Who muffled the bell?

		Scarf	Reason					Day									
Climber		Tova	striped	plaid	argyle	red	cable	dusting	repairs	bats	the view	pigeons	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
		Linus															
		Hattie															
		Gideon															
		Pablo															
		Monday															
Day		Tuesday															
		Wednesday															
		Thursday															
		Friday															
		dusting															
Reason		repairs															
		bats															
		the view															
		pigeons															

86 The Case of the Muddy Bootprints

★★★★☆ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Wren stepped out for lunch on Tuesday and came back to a trail of mud across the library's freshly waxed floor, and a soggy book about whales on the returns cart. Five patrons came by that afternoon, each at a different time, in different boots, bound for a different section. The prints have the deep ridged tread of rubber boots. "Mud," Wren whispers, "on my wax." Who tracked in the mud?

- ☐ 1. Nico browsed either the maps section or the travel section.
- ☐ 2. The patron in hiking boots came in earlier than whoever browsed the history section.
- ☐ 3. The 2:30 p.m. patron was neither Greta nor Oscar.
- ☐ 4. Of Greta and the patron in rubber boots, one came by at 1:00 p.m. and the other at 2:30 p.m.
- ☐ 5. Of the patrons in the history and poetry sections, one came by at 1:30 p.m. and the other at 3:00 p.m.
- ☐ 6. Whoever wore snow boots came by at neither 1:30 p.m. nor 3:00 p.m.
- ☐ 7. The 3:00 p.m. patron, Oscar, the patron in hiking boots, Nico, and the one in the travel section were five different people.
- ☐ 8. Of the patron in work boots and the 3:00 p.m. patron, one was Pearl and the other was Greta.

Your question: Who tracked in the mud?

		Boots					Section					Time				
Patron		rubber	hiking	cowboy	snow	work	maps	history	cooking	travel	poetry	1:00 p.m.	1:30 p.m.	2:00 p.m.	2:30 p.m.	3:00 p.m.
	Pearl															
	Nico															
	Milo															
	Greta															
	Oscar															
Time	1:00 p.m.															
	1:30 p.m.															
	2:00 p.m.															
	2:30 p.m.															
	3:00 p.m.															
Section	maps															
	history															
	cooking															
	travel															
	poetry															

87 The Case of the Vanishing Cameo

★★★★★ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Thanksgiving afternoon at the Gull's Rest Inn: the turkey was resting, and so were the guests. Then Priya's heirloom cameo brooch vanished, velvet pouch and all, from the parlor mantel. Five guests had settled in the parlor, each at a different time, with a different drink and a different book from the shelf. The pouch turned up, empty, tucked inside the parlor's almanac. Who tucked the cameo away?

- ☐ 1. Basil was drinking either tea or cider.
- ☐ 2. Of the guest reading the sea stories and the guest reading the mystery, one was Basil and the other was Carmen.
- ☐ 3. Zeke sat down exactly an hour before the coffee drinker.
- ☐ 4. The eggnog drinker, Mabel, and the mystery reader were three different guests.
- ☐ 5. Whoever drank the eggnog was reading either the sea stories or the cookbook.
- ☐ 6. Of the sea stories reader and the mystery reader, one sat down at 3:00 p.m. and the other at 3:20 p.m.
- ☐ 7. The guest with the mystery was drinking either eggnog or tea.
- ☐ 8. The poems reader sat down later than the cookbook reader.
- ☐ 9. Of Basil and the cocoa drinker, one sat down at 2:00 p.m. and the other at 3:20 p.m.

Your question: Who tucked the cameo away?

		Drink					Book					Time				
Guest		cocoa	cider	tea	coffee	eggnog	almanac	sea stories	poems	cookbook	mystery	2:00 p.m.	2:20 p.m.	2:40 p.m.	3:00 p.m.	3:20 p.m.
	Mabel															
	Zeke															
	Carmen															
	Ivan															
	Basil															
Time	2:00 p.m.															
	2:20 p.m.															
	2:40 p.m.															
	3:00 p.m.															
	3:20 p.m.															
Book	almanac															
	sea stories															
	poems															
	cookbook															
	mystery															

88 The Case of the Fast Clock

★★★★★ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Jonah sets his watch by the big clock over the ferry dock, so when someone nudged it ten minutes fast, the ferry left early and stranded the town moderator on the dock, briefcase in hand. The clock hangs too high to reach without something to stand on. Five people came by the dock the evening before, each carrying something different and wearing a different hat. Who set the clock ahead?

- ☐ 1. One of Kit and Rosa wore the beret, and the other came by at 7:00 p.m.
- ☐ 2. Either Amara or Kit wore the beret.
- ☐ 3. The visitor in the cap came by earlier than the one carrying the basket.
- ☐ 4. Of Vito and the visitor with the lantern, one wore the bonnet and the other the beanie.
- ☐ 5. Of Otis and whoever brought the toolbox, one wore the cap and the other the bonnet.
- ☐ 6. Whoever carried the umbrella wore neither the beret nor the fedora.
- ☐ 7. Otis came by exactly two hours before the visitor with the umbrella.
- ☐ 8. The visitor in the beret came by earlier than the one in the fedora.

Your question: Who set the dock clock fast?

		Carried					Hat					Time				
		toolbox	umbrella	basket	lantern	step stool	beret	cap	beanie	fedora	bonnet	6:00 p.m.	6:30 p.m.	7:00 p.m.	7:30 p.m.	8:00 p.m.
Visitor	Amara															
	Rosa															
	Kit															
	Vito															
	Otis															
Time	6:00 p.m.															
	6:30 p.m.															
	7:00 p.m.															
	7:30 p.m.															
	8:00 p.m.															
Hat	beret															
	cap															
	beanie															
	fedora															
	bonnet															

89 The Case of the Short Cash Box

★★★★★ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

At the holiday craft fair on the Saturday after Thanksgiving, the cash box came up exactly twenty dollars short, and Hattie has added “find twenty dollars” to her list of lists. Nobody suspects a thief, only a slip of the fingers: the box sat on the cocoa table all day, and only the cocoa volunteer made change from it. Five volunteers each ran a different table for a different number of hours. Who made the wrong change?

- ☐ 1. Whoever wore the holly name tag worked a shorter shift than the volunteer who sold mittens.
- ☐ 2. The mittens seller wore either the pinecone or the reindeer name tag.
- ☐ 3. The volunteer at the candles table wore either the reindeer or the holly name tag.
- ☐ 4. Of Dev and the cocoa volunteer, one wore the star name tag and the other the reindeer.
- ☐ 5. Whoever worked 5 hours sold either wreaths or fudge.
- ☐ 6. Ruben put in fewer hours than the volunteer who sold wreaths.
- ☐ 7. The holly name tag’s wearer worked neither 2 hours nor 4 hours.
- ☐ 8. Of the fudge seller and the volunteer who worked 3 hours, one was Una and the other was Elsa.
- ☐ 9. Una, the volunteer with the star name tag, and the volunteers who worked 2 hours, 3 hours and 5 hours were five different people.

Your question: Who made the wrong change?

		Table	Name tag					Shift									
			cocoa	candles	wreaths	mittens	fudge	holly	star	snowman	reindeer	pinecone	1 hour	2 hours	3 hours	4 hours	5 hours
Volunteer	Una																
	Ruben																
	Hattie																
	Dev																
	Elsa																
Shift	1 hour																
	2 hours																
	3 hours																
	4 hours																
	5 hours																
Name tag	holly																
	star																
	snowman																
	reindeer																
	pinecone																

90 The Case of the Painted Buoys

★★★★★ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Nico woke to find his orange lobster buoys painted a bright, cheerful purple, and now nobody on the pier can tell whose traps are whose. He swears you can see them from Portugal. Gus remembers selling paint to five customers at Mahoney's this week, and exactly one can of purple, but his famous knee forecasts rain, not faces. Who turned Nico's buoys purple?

- ☐ 1. Of Yusuf and the buyer of the white paint, one took the sponge and the other the spray can.
- ☐ 2. Whoever took the rag spent less than the buyer of the purple paint.
- ☐ 3. One of Yusuf and Della bought the black paint, and the other spent \$14.
- ☐ 4. Enzo spent more than the customer who took the roller.
- ☐ 5. Marta, Yusuf, the customer who spent \$10 and the one who spent \$14 were four different people.
- ☐ 6. The customer with the spray can bought either the black or the yellow paint.
- ☐ 7. Of Yusuf and the customer with the wide brush, one bought the black paint and the other the purple.
- ☐ 8. The customer with the wide brush spent exactly two dollars more than Yusuf.
- ☐ 9. The buyer of the teal paint spent less than the customer with the roller.

Your question: Who painted the buoys?

		Paint					Brush					Cost				
Customer		purple	teal	white	black	yellow	roller	sponge	wide brush	spray can	rag	\$8	\$10	\$12	\$14	\$16
	Enzo															
	Della															
	Yusuf															
	Marta															
	Felix															
Cost	\$8															
	\$10															
	\$12															
	\$14															
	\$16															
Brush	roller															
	sponge															
	wide brush															
	spray can															
	rag															

91 The Case of the Lantern Room

★★★★★ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Lena has two puzzles. The old one: since early November, the Keeper's Lamp's brass has shone as if someone polished it, and none of her volunteers did. The new one: muddy footprints on the spiral stair on Wednesday morning, though it was spotless when the museum closed at a quarter to six on Tuesday. Five people climbed the tower on Tuesday, each stopping at a different landing with something different in hand. Who went back up after closing time?

- ☐ 1. Of Cass and the climber with the flashlight, one stopped at the 3rd landing and the other at the top.
- ☐ 2. Jonah and whoever carried the flashlight were two different climbers: one stopped at the 2nd landing, the other at the 3rd landing.
- ☐ 3. Wren climbed later than whoever carried the thermos.
- ☐ 4. Jonah climbed sometime before the climber with the thermos.
- ☐ 5. The thermos went up the tower at either 4:30 p.m. or 5:30 p.m.
- ☐ 6. Hugo did not climb at 5:30 p.m.
- ☐ 7. Cass went up the stairs earlier than Hugo.
- ☐ 8. One of Teddy and the thermos carrier stopped at the top, and the other at the 1st landing.
- ☐ 9. Jonah carried neither the sketchbook nor the thermos.
- ☐ 10. Whoever carried the notebook climbed exactly an hour after whoever stopped at the 1st landing.

Your question: Who climbed the tower after closing?

		Item	Landing					Time										
Climber	Time	Landing	sketchbook	thermos	field guide	flashlight	notebook	1st landing	2nd landing	3rd landing	4th landing	top	4:00 p.m.	4:30 p.m.	5:00 p.m.	5:30 p.m.	6:00 p.m.	
			Hugo															
			Jonah															
			Wren															
			Teddy															
	Cass																	
	4:00 p.m.																	
	4:30 p.m.																	
	5:00 p.m.																	
	5:30 p.m.																	
	6:00 p.m.																	
	1st landing																	
	2nd landing																	
	3rd landing																	
	4th landing																	
	top																	

92 The Case of the Jammed Press

★★★★★ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Press night at the Gazette was going beautifully until the old press groaned, clanked and stopped dead, and Ada pulled a single red mitten out of the rollers. The press room is drafty in November, so the five helpers, on five different jobs, all worked in mittens, each pair a different color. In forty-one years Ada has fished a necktie and half a sandwich out of that press, but never a mitten. Whose mitten stopped the press?

- ☐ 1. Of the helper in brown mittens and the one who came in at 9:20 p.m., one was Milo and the other Greta.
- ☐ 2. One of Imani and Greta wore the green mittens, and the other did the inking.
- ☐ 3. Whoever did the sweeping came in earlier than whoever did the proofing.
- ☐ 4. Whoever wore the red mittens did either the folding or the bundling.
- ☐ 5. Imani arrived exactly 40 minutes after Milo.
- ☐ 6. Selma arrived later than whoever wore the gray mittens.
- ☐ 7. Quinn came in at either 8:00 p.m. or 8:40 p.m.
- ☐ 8. Milo did either the inking or the folding.
- ☐ 9. The helper in green mittens arrived later than Imani.

Your question: Whose mitten jammed the press?

		Mittens					Job					Time				
Helper		red	gray	green	white	brown	folding	inking	bundling	sweeping	proofing	8:00 p.m.	8:20 p.m.	8:40 p.m.	9:00 p.m.	9:20 p.m.
	Selma															
	Quinn															
	Milo															
	Imani															
	Greta															
Time	8:00 p.m.															
	8:20 p.m.															
	8:40 p.m.															
	9:00 p.m.															
	9:20 p.m.															
Job	folding															
	inking															
	bundling															
	sweeping															
	proofing															

93 The Case of the Bottled Ship

★★★★★ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

On Monday morning the library's prized ship in a bottle, the *Constance*, was gone from its glass case. In its place sat a short length of rope tied in a neat bowline, borrowed from the knots display. Over the weekend, five volunteers each dusted one display with a different duster, and Wren whispers that she would like her ship back before story hour, please. Who moved the ship in a bottle?

- ☐ 1. The 45-year-old used either the brush or the wand.
- ☐ 2. Whoever used the cloth is younger than whoever dusted the lanterns.
- ☐ 3. Faye dusted either the maps or the anchors.
- ☐ 4. Of the volunteer who dusted the shells and the 35-year-old, one used the chamois and the other the mitt.
- ☐ 5. Otis is exactly ten years younger than whoever used the brush.
- ☐ 6. The volunteer who dusted the maps is older than the one who dusted the shells.
- ☐ 7. Jade and the 45-year-old are two different volunteers: one used the cloth, the other the brush.
- ☐ 8. One of Cyrus and whoever used the chamois dusted the shells, and the other dusted the lanterns.

Your question: Who moved the ship in a bottle?

		Display					Duster					Age				
Volunteer		maps	anchors	shells	lanterns	knots	chamois	cloth	brush	mitt	wand	35	45	55	65	75
	Faye															
	Otis															
	Cyrus															
	Bea															
	Jade															
Age	35															
	45															
	55															
	65															
	75															
Duster	chamois															
	cloth															
	brush															
	mitt															
	wand															

94 The Case of the Leaky Rowboat

★★★★★ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Someone pulled the drain plug on the boatyard's work rowboat, one of the last boats still in the water, and it sank gently into two feet of water at the slip. Felix is fuming, politely. The plug turned up at the bottom of a bailing bucket left on the dock, and five people were at the slips that afternoon, each hauling a different boat out for the winter. Who pulled the plug?

- ☐ 1. Nico got to the slips earlier than whoever hauled out the canoe.
- ☐ 2. Kenji turned up at either 1:15 p.m. or 1:45 p.m.
- ☐ 3. Between Nico and Hal, one brought the anchor and the other the net.
- ☐ 4. Whoever brought the bucket arrived sometime before Hal.
- ☐ 5. Of Priya and Hal, one carried the oars and the other carried the net.
- ☐ 6. The one with the net arrived at either 1:00 p.m. or 1:45 p.m.
- ☐ 7. The 2:00 p.m. arrival hauled out neither the canoe nor the dory.
- ☐ 8. The skiff's owner arrived earlier than whoever brought the cooler.
- ☐ 9. The dory's owner came at neither 1:30 p.m. nor 1:45 p.m.
- ☐ 10. The punt's owner got there exactly half an hour before the canoe's owner.
- ☐ 11. The person with the oars did not arrive at 1:30 p.m.

Your question: Who pulled the plug?

		Boat					Gear					Time				
Owner		skiff	kayak	canoe	dory	punt	oars	net	cooler	anchor	bucket	1:00 p.m.	1:15 p.m.	1:30 p.m.	1:45 p.m.	2:00 p.m.
	Kenji															
	Nico															
	Priya															
	Hal															
	Una															
Time	1:00 p.m.															
	1:15 p.m.															
	1:30 p.m.															
	1:45 p.m.															
	2:00 p.m.															
Gear	oars															
	net															
	cooler															
	anchor															
	bucket															

95 The Case of the Midnight Ovens

★★★★★ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Four a.m. is Rosa's hour, so she was startled to find her ovens already warm and a tray of gingerbread lighthouses cooling on the rack, each with a tiny icing lamp. Five friends know where she hides the bakery's spare key, and each has a different baking specialty. The icing, Rosa admits, is very nearly as good as hers. Who baked at midnight?

- ☐ 1. Whoever is known for rolls is exactly five years older than whoever is known for brownies.
- ☐ 2. Ruben is either 75 or 80 years old.
- ☐ 3. The baker known for brownies is younger than Emil.
- ☐ 4. Emil and the baker in the white apron are two different people: one is 70, the other 80.
- ☐ 5. Whoever bakes in the plaid apron is younger than Gus.
- ☐ 6. The baker whose specialty is gingerbread is neither 70 nor 75 years old.
- ☐ 7. The baker in the striped apron is exactly 20 years younger than the one known for fudge.
- ☐ 8. Gingerbread is the specialty of either Emil or Lou.
- ☐ 9. Either Lou or Mabel bakes in the blue apron.
- ☐ 10. One of the 70-year-old and the 80-year-old wears the flowered apron, and the other wears the white one.

Your question: Who baked at midnight?

		Apron					Treat					Age				
Baker	Emil Ruben Mabel Lou Gus	blue	flowered	plaid	white	striped	gingerbread	biscotti	brownies	rolls	fudge	60	65	70	75	80
Age	60															
	65															
	70															
	75															
	80															
Treat	gingerbread															
	biscotti															
	brownies															
	rolls															
	fudge															

Scratch Pad

For working things out, testing a “Suppose,” or making notes.

CHAPTER 7

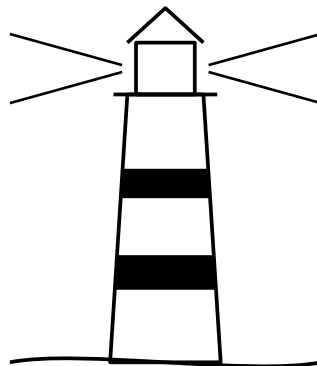
The Lighthouse Affair

You will learn: Everything at once: the five-part finale

Difficulty up to ★★★★★ Puzzles 96–100

December 20, the eve of the Lantern Festival. All week the Keeper's Lamp has been lit each evening for the Festival. At nine o'clock it blinks three times and goes dark. By morning, the town's beloved lamp is gone, and a note on the sill says only, "It will shine again."

Five puzzles, each one answering a single question. Solve them in order, then turn to "Putting It All Together" to name the person behind the Lighthouse Affair. No new lessons now. You have everything you need.



96 The Harbor Office Sign-Out

★★★★★ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

At dawn on Festival day, Lena found the Keeper's Lamp gone from Thimble Point Light and a note on the sill: "It will shine again." Ada starts where the spare key is kept, at the harbor office. On Festival Eve, Otis left for a harbormasters' meeting in Portland at ten, and five visitors in winter gloves signed things out on his honor-system slate. This morning, as always, he wiped it clean: "Fresh tide, fresh slate." Who took what, and when?

- ☐ 1. Walt and whoever took the binoculars are two different people: one signed the slate at noon, the other at 11:00 a.m.
- ☐ 2. Of the tide chart's borrower and the person who signed at noon, one wore ski gloves and the other wore fleece gloves.
- ☐ 3. Gus signed the slate exactly two hours after Amara did.
- ☐ 4. Whoever wore the leather gloves signed the slate later than Amara.
- ☐ 5. Between Selma and whoever took the spare key, one wore fingerless gloves and the other wore fleece.
- ☐ 6. The visitor who signed at 11:30 a.m. wore either fingerless or wool gloves.
- ☐ 7. Whoever borrowed the megaphone signed the slate earlier than Walt.

Your question: Who borrowed the spare lighthouse key?

		Item	Gloves					Time										
Gloves	Time	Visitor	spare key	binoculars	tide chart	megaphone	life ring	wool	leather	fleece	fingerless	ski	10:00 a.m.	10:30 a.m.	11:00 a.m.	11:30 a.m.	noon	
			Teddy															
			Walt															
			Amara															
			Selma															
			Gus															

97 The Afternoon Boats

★★★★★ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

On a cold, calm Festival Eve afternoon, five rowers in the lantern flotilla took the boatyard's rental rowboats out to rehearse, each to a different spot on the route. Felix keeps those boats in the water this late only for the flotilla. High tide had the causeway under water, so the only way to the Point was by boat. Felix rowed too, so he can vouch for his own trip and nobody else's. Who rowed which boat where, and when?

- ☐ 1. Of the rower bound for Gull Rock and the one who pushed off at 3:30 p.m., one took out the Puffin and the other the Minnow.
- ☐ 2. Between Nico and whoever pushed off at 3:30 p.m., one rowed the Teacup and the other rowed the Minnow.
- ☐ 3. Either Felix or Imani pushed off at 3:00 p.m.
- ☐ 4. Felix pushed off at neither 2:00 p.m. nor 2:30 p.m.
- ☐ 5. Oscar's boat was neither the Minnow nor the Puffin.
- ☐ 6. The 3:30 p.m. rower went to neither East Cove nor the Narrows.
- ☐ 7. The Skipjack's rower pushed off at neither 2:00 p.m. nor 3:30 p.m.
- ☐ 8. Neither Oscar nor Imani pushed off at 2:30 p.m.
- ☐ 9. Teddy pushed off sometime after Felix.
- ☐ 10. Either Oscar or Imani rowed to Seal Ledge.
- ☐ 11. The rower headed for the Narrows pushed off earlier than the one headed for East Cove.
- ☐ 12. One of Nico and Felix rowed to Gull Rock, and the other rowed to the Narrows.

Your question: Who rowed out to Thimble Point?

		Boat	Went to					Time								
Rower	Nico	Minnow	Pebble	Skipjack	Teacup	Puffin	the Point	Gull Rock	East Cove	the Narrows	Seal Ledge	1:30 p.m.	2:00 p.m.	2:30 p.m.	3:00 p.m.	3:30 p.m.
	Oscar															
	Felix															
	Imani															
	Teddy															
Time	1:30 p.m.															
	2:00 p.m.															
	2:30 p.m.															
	3:00 p.m.															
	3:30 p.m.															
Went to	the Point															
	Gull Rock															
	East Cove															
	the Narrows															
	Seal Ledge															

98 The Ferry Dock Hand-Offs

★★★★★ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Between five o'clock and twenty past six on Festival Eve, the ferry dock bustled with errands, and Pilot the beagle greeted everyone in his orange life vest. Five people were each handed something there, from a festival lantern to the spare lighthouse key, and each went on somewhere different. Teddy says he passed the key along on his way to the green. Ada would like the grid's word for it. Who got what, when, and where did each go next?

- ☐ 1. Whoever went on to the library was either Rosa or Pearl.
- ☐ 2. The person headed to the inn got their item earlier than the person headed to the church.
- ☐ 3. Whoever went on to the bakery was handed something exactly 20 minutes after whoever went on to the inn.
- ☐ 4. Of the mail sack's recipient and the person handed something at 5:40 p.m., one was Hattie and the other was Kenji.
- ☐ 5. One of Jonah and Rosa was handed the spare key, and the other was handed something at 6:00 p.m.
- ☐ 6. Neither Pearl nor Rosa was handed the lantern.
- ☐ 7. Kenji got his item earlier than the person headed to the inn.
- ☐ 8. The 6:20 p.m. hand-off went to either Jonah or Kenji.
- ☐ 9. Either Hattie or Pearl was handed the pie tin.
- ☐ 10. Hattie got her item exactly 20 minutes after the person headed to the store got theirs.

Your question: Who received the spare key at the ferry dock?

		Received					Headed to					Time				
Person		spare key	lantern	thermos	mail sack	pie tin	the inn	the bakery	the store	the church	the library	5:00 p.m.	5:20 p.m.	5:40 p.m.	6:00 p.m.	6:20 p.m.
	Hattie															
	Jonah															
	Pearl															
	Rosa															
	Kenji															
Time	5:00 p.m.															
	5:20 p.m.															
	5:40 p.m.															
	6:00 p.m.															
	6:20 p.m.															
Headed to	the inn															
	the bakery															
	the store															
	the church															
	the library															

99 The Moonlight Dinghy

★★★★★ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

After dark, under a thin December moon, Felix found his own dinghy gone from its slip. The tide was high and the causeway under water, so anyone who reached Thimble Point that evening got there by boat, and the dinghy was the only boat missing. Five people admit they were down by the water, each at a different spot, arriving at a different time, by a different light. Who went where, when, and by which light?

- ☐ 1. Linus carried either a headlamp or a bike light.
- ☐ 2. Of Jonah and whoever arrived at 7:40 p.m., one carried the headlamp and the other the penlight.
- ☐ 3. One of Mabel and the person who reached the Point arrived at 8:00 p.m., and the other at 7:20 p.m.
- ☐ 4. Zeke and the person on the beach are two different people: one arrived at 8:20 p.m., the other at 7:20 p.m.
- ☐ 5. Whoever went to the slipway got there at either 7:00 p.m. or 7:40 p.m.
- ☐ 6. Whoever wore the headlamp arrived exactly 20 minutes after whoever carried the penlight.
- ☐ 7. The person at the Point arrived exactly an hour after the person at the pier.
- ☐ 8. The person with the lantern arrived at either 7:00 p.m. or 7:20 p.m.

Your question: Who rowed out to Thimble Point after dark?

		Spot					Light					Time				
Person		the Point	the pier	the slipway	the beach	the seawall	flashlight	headlamp	lantern	bike light	penlight	7:00 p.m.	7:20 p.m.	7:40 p.m.	8:00 p.m.	8:20 p.m.
		Mabel														
		Priya														
		Zeke														
		Jonah														
		Linus														
Time		7:00 p.m.														
		7:20 p.m.														
		7:40 p.m.														
		8:00 p.m.														
		8:20 p.m.														
Light		flashlight														
		headlamp														
		lantern														
		bike light														
		penlight														

100 The Rehearsal on the Green

★★★★★ Solved ☐ Hints used ○○○○ Time _____

Down on the town green, half of Thimble Harbor spent Festival Eve in winter coats, rehearsing the Lantern Festival. Lena's own museum key never left her key ring. Five volunteers, each with a different job, took turns at the Gazette's camera: one photo each, every half hour from seven. The last one, at nine, shows the light at Thimble Point going dark. Who took which photo, and who caught that last one?

- ☐ 1. Whoever ran the choir took a photo later than whoever wore the red coat.
- ☐ 2. Between them, Gideon and Hattie took the 7:00 p.m. and 8:00 p.m. photos.
- ☐ 3. The volunteer in the navy coat ran either the choir or the lanterns.
- ☐ 4. Whoever handled the tickets wore either a gray or a camel coat.
- ☐ 5. Wren took her photo exactly half an hour after the volunteer in the green coat took theirs.
- ☐ 6. One of Lena and Gideon ran the tickets, and the other ran the choir.
- ☐ 7. Wren and the cocoa volunteer are two different people: one took the 9:00 p.m. photo, the other the 8:30 p.m. one.
- ☐ 8. Lena took her photo earlier than the volunteer in the camel coat.
- ☐ 9. Wren took either the 7:00 p.m. or the 8:30 p.m. photo.

Your question: Who snapped the 9 p.m. photo?

		Job					Coat					Time				
		lanterns	choir	cocoa	tickets	banners	red	navy	green	gray	camel	7:00 p.m.	7:30 p.m.	8:00 p.m.	8:30 p.m.	9:00 p.m.
Volunteer	Lena															
	Gideon															
	Wren															
	Hattie															
	Teddy															
Time	7:00 p.m.															
	7:30 p.m.															
	8:00 p.m.															
	8:30 p.m.															
	9:00 p.m.															
Coat	red															
	navy															
	green															
	gray															
	camel															

Putting It All Together

The Keeper's Lamp is gone, the Festival is tonight, and your five answers sit in a row on the puzzle desk. Ada taps them with her pencil. "No guessing now, partner. Three facts, and your answers do the rest."

Fact 1. The person behind the Affair let themselves into the locked lighthouse with the spare key. Only two people had that key in hand on December 20: the answer to Puzzle 96 and the answer to Puzzle 98.

Fact 2. The person behind the Affair carried the lamp away by rowboat. Only two people rowed out to Thimble Point that day: the answer to Puzzle 97 and the answer to Puzzle 99.

Fact 3. At 9 p.m., when the light blinked three times and went dark, the person behind the Affair was up in the lantern room, not down on the town green, where the answer to Puzzle 100 was snapping a photo.

Who was behind the Lighthouse Affair?

Write your answer here: _____

The solution is at the end of the Solutions section, after Puzzle 100.

Hints, Step 1: Where to Look

A gentle nudge toward the right clue or row. Try this first.

- 1** Look at Lena's row. How many teas does clue 2 leave her?
- 2** Clue 2 is the only clue that gives a dot. Place it, then look at Rosa's row.
- 3** Look at Felix's row. Which of the three lunches could still be his?
- 4** Look down the sou'wester column. Clue 1 names two possible donors. Who is left out?
- 5** Look down the coupons column. How many customers could have asked for them?
- 6** Look at Kit's row. After clues 2 and 3, how many umbrellas could still be Kit's?
- 7** Look at Faye's row. Which jobs do clues 1 and 3 leave open for her?
- 8** Look down the Bubbles column. Clue 1 names two possible students. Is one of them already spoken for?
- 9** Look down the green column. Which clues say something about who wore the green gloves?
- 10** Look down the bake sale column. Clue 1 offers two writers. Can another clue cross out one of them?
- 11** Who could have sailed the sloop? Look down the sloop column with clue 4 in hand.
- 12** Look at Ruben's row in the jars box. How many jars does clue 2 leave him?
- 13** Start with the postcard. Which readers does clue 4 cross out, and who does that leave?
- 14** Which ribbon could Jonah have chosen? Look at his row in the ribbons box and read clue 2.
- 15** Look at the bows column in the box that matches fliers with tails. Which fliers could have chosen bows?

- 16** Look at Imani's row where owners meet boats, and the navy column where owners meet colors. After clues 1 and 2, how many blanks does each have?
- 17** Look at the box that matches desserts with toppings. Which topping could go with the crumble?
- 18** Look at the box that matches buoys with spots. Where could the striped buoy's owner fish?
- 19** Look at Zeke's row in the float box. Which clues talk about Zeke's float, and what do they allow?
- 20** Look at the Boston row in the box where rooms meet hometowns. Which rooms does clue 3 allow the guest from Boston?
- 21** Clue 1 allows the osprey's spotter only two spots. Does another clue tell you what the birder at one of those spots saw?
- 22** Start in Jonah's row of the parts box. Which clues mention Jonah's part, and what do they leave him?
- 23** Look at Otis's row in the item box. Clue 1 gives him two possible items. Does clue 2 allow both?
- 24** Look at clue 3. It names the sundial and the gnome. What does it tell you about the irises and the lupines?
- 25** Look at the crab cake in clue 2. What could its diner have drunk?
- 26** Look at clue 2. The rhythm speller held the sea glass or the wishbone. Does clue 1 leave room for both?
- 27** Look at the carrot cake in the box where flavors meet toppers. Which toppers could it possibly have?
- 28** Start in the box where creatures meet pools. Which pools could the snail have come from?
- 29** Look at the trophy. Clue 1 gives it two possible owners. Can another clue rule one of them out?
- 30** Look at the Skipjack in the box where oars meet dinghies. Which oars could have gone out on it?

- 31** Look at clue 1. In a line of only four people, how much room does a gap of exactly three places need?
- 32** Look at Hattie's row, where clue 2 allows only two places. Do both of them work with clue 1?
- 33** Look at Lou's row, where clue 2 allows only first or last. Which one leaves room for clue 1?
- 34** Look at clue 3 with clue 1 beside it. Teddy built farther from the pier than Mabel, but how far out can Teddy go?
- 35** Look at Felix's row. Clue 4 puts someone ahead of him, and clue 1 puts someone behind him. Where can he stand?
- 36** Look at clue 2. In a row of only five blankets, which pairs of spots are exactly three apart?
- 37** Look at Oscar's row. Three clues name him, and clue 3 decides who can be fourth. Which spots are left for him?
- 38** Look at the first column. Who could possibly stand at the far left of the photo?
- 39** Look at clue 2. In a week that runs only from Monday to Thursday, how much room does a gap of exactly three days need?
- 40** Look at clue 5. It names two days. Does another clue already give one of those days to somebody?
- 41** Look at clue 2. It is about Jade and Mabel, but what does it tell you about Ruben and Vito?
- 42** Look at clue 2. Once Wren and Kenji have their two dates, who is left for July 22 and July 29?
- 43** Look at the wet paint note. Clue 5 allows it only two nights. Does another clue speak about one of them?
- 44** Look at the 9 a.m. row in the bottom box, where times meet boats. Which boats could possibly have gone out first?
- 45** Look at the baguettes column in the box where customers meet orders. Who could possibly have ordered them?

- 46** Look at Dev's row in the box where exhibitors meet times. Clues 3 and 4 both time him against an entry. Which hours could be his?
- 47** Look at Bea's and Gus's statements side by side. What does each one say about Teddy?
- 48** Look at Faye's statement. With only three suspects, what does "either Nico or I" tell you about Linus?
- 49** Look at each suspect's own statement. If that person had cut the pie, would their statement be true or false?
- 50** Look at Jade's and Vito's statements. With only three suspects, what does each one really say about Otis?
- 51** Look at Hattie's and Cyrus's statements. Can they both be true at once?
- 52** Look at Una's and Ruben's statements. What does each one say about Una?
- 53** Read Felix's and Teddy's statements side by side. Can both of them be true, or both of them false?
- 54** Look at Dot's and Enzo's statements. Each one clears a single person, so for which suspects are both of them true?
- 55** Look at Ivan's and Oscar's statements. Neither one is about the lights: each says that someone else is lying.
- 56** Look at Pablo's statement, which is about Yusuf rather than the lemonade. Could either of those two be the culprit?
- 57** Look at Imani's and Zeke's statements. Neither is about the gulls, so whose word is each one backing?
- 58** Look at the chain: Gideon vouches for Vera, and Vera vouches for Lou. What does that say about those three statements?
- 59** Look at Pablo's row in the box where pickers meet apples. Clues 1 and 3 both mention him. Which apple could he have picked?
- 60** Look at Dot's and Gus's rows in the box where sellers meet prices. Which prices does clue 3 leave for them?

- 61** Look at clues 1, 2 and 3. They all compare ages. Can you line the four students up from youngest to oldest?
- 62** Look at the bluefish in the box where fish meet lengths. Clue 2 gives it two choices. Does another clue rule one out?
- 63** Look at Ruben's row in the box where passengers meet ferries. Which runs could he possibly have taken?
- 64** Look at the 25 cents row in the box where books meet fines. Which book could have had the smallest fine?
- 65** Look at the Tubby column in the box where pumpkins meet weights. Which two clues say something about how much Tubby weighed?
- 66** Look at clue 2. Exactly 45 minutes is a wide gap when the arrivals run from 5:00 to 5:45. Where can it fit?
- 67** Look at 25 minutes in the box where times meet snacks. Which snack could the 25-minute friend have picked?
- 68** Look at Otis's row where buyers meet years. Clues 2 and 6 both measure his clock against another one. Which years can his be?
- 69** Look at clue 7. The pogies and squid skippers hauled 40 and 50 traps between them. Which clue tells you which way round?
- 70** Clue 7 fixes one pie's baking time outright. Which other clues measure time from that same pie?
- 71** Look at clue 6. Wren and Enzo hold 1,400 feet and 1,200 feet between them. Is there a clue that keeps one of them off the top?
- 72** Look at Olive's row where advertisers meet prices. Clues 2 and 6 both measure from her. What could she have paid?
- 73** Look at Tova's row where donors meet gifts. Clues 1 and 2 both limit her. What could she have given?
- 74** Look where the woods meet 1 cord. Which wood could possibly be the smallest order?
- 75** Look at clue 2. Of the fares \$3, \$5, \$7 and \$9, which two are exactly \$6 apart?

- 76** Look at the porch entrant's tickets. Clues 2 and 3 both lean on the nine patch quilt, so how few could the porch entrant have bought?
- 77** Look at the 5-gallon row in the box where labels meet gallons. Which label could possibly belong to the smallest batch?
- 78** Look at the 125-piece row in the box where costumes meet pieces. Which costume could possibly have handed out the most?
- 79** Clues 1 and 5 both tie a fixed gap to the stage helper's arrival. How early, and how late, could the stage helper have come?
- 80** Look at the 8:00 a.m. arrival in clue 5. Could the person who came for mail really have arrived last?
- 81** Look at the window seat and clue 9's two choices for it. Does another clue rule one of them out?
- 82** Look at the fishing excuse in the box where excuses meet ages. How old could that visitor possibly be?
- 83** Look at the grapes in the box where snacks meet times. Which times could the grapes possibly have?
- 84** Look at the permit in the box where errands meet times. Clue 4 gives it two hours. Does another clue rule one out?
- 85** Look at Hattie's row in the box where names meet reasons. Clue 8 gives her two choices: can another clue rule one out?
- 86** Look at Greta in clue 4. Which two times does it leave her, and does another clue rule one of them out?
- 87** Clue 9 gives Basil only two times, 2:00 or 3:20. Once the other clues run dry, that is the row to test.
- 88** Start with clue 7. How far apart were the first and last visits of the evening? Where does that put Otis and the umbrella?
- 89** Look at the 3 hours column. Clue 8 offers two volunteers for it. Does clue 9 allow both?
- 90** Start with the white paint. Clue 1 gives its buyer two possible brushes. Does clue 6 allow both?

- 91** Clues 1 and 2 both name the climber with the flashlight. Which landing do both clues allow?
- 92** Look at Imani's row in the time box. Clues 5 and 9 leave just two possible times. Which two?
- 93** Look at the 45-year-old in clues 1 and 7. Which duster appears in both?
- 94** Clues 3 and 5 both name Hal: which gear fits both? And which boat could possibly come at 2:00 p.m.?
- 95** Clue 7 pins two ages at once. Then look at clues 4 and 10: what do they say about the 70- and 80-year-olds?
- 96** Look at clue 3. Which two sign-out times are exactly two hours apart? Then see where clue 1 leaves Walt.
- 97** Look at the 3:30 p.m. rower in clues 1 and 2. Which boat fits both?
- 98** Look at the 6:20 p.m. column. Clue 8 offers two names; check each one against the other clues that mention them.
- 99** Look at the Point in clues 3 and 7. How late must it be, and which of clue 3's two times fits?
- 100** Look at Wren in clues 5 and 9. Which of her two times leaves room for someone in green half an hour earlier?

Hints, Step 2: What to Notice

What that clue or row is really telling you.

- 1** Neither-nor means two X's. Mark both in Lena's row, then look for the only choice left.
- 2** One dot brings its X's with it: Hugo's dot crosses out sweet pea for everyone else. Now read clue 1 for Rosa.
- 3** Clue 1 names the chowder first. It was Ivan's or Tova's, so mark an X where Felix meets chowder.
- 4** Clue 1 is an either-or clue told from the hat's side: put an X at Otis and the sou'wester. Then place Pearl's dot from clue 2.
- 5** A neither-nor clue gives two X's. Clue 2 crosses out Nico and Sam in the coupons column, leaving one blank square.
- 6** Clue 3 gives Kit two X's, and Mabel's dot from clue 2 crosses out plaid for everyone else. Look for the only choice left.
- 7** Clue 3 gives Faye two X's, and Imani's dot from clue 1 crosses out the ticket desk. That leaves Faye one blank square.
- 8** Clue 3 gives Quinn a dot for Barnacle, and that dot crosses out Bubbles in Quinn's row. Now clue 1 has only one name left.
- 9** Clue 3 crosses out Zeke and Cass for green. Clue 1 gives Olive only floral or striped, so she is out too.
- 10** Clue 2 gives Hal only the pothole or parking letter, so put an X at Hal and bake sale. Then read clue 1 again.
- 11** Use the only choice left: clue 4 leaves the sloop one sailor. Then carry the dot from clue 2, which joins gold to the dory.
- 12** Use the only choice left: clue 2 leaves Ruben a single jar. Once his is marked, clue 4 does the same for Hattie.
- 13** Use the only choice left: clue 4 leaves the postcard just one reader. Then read clue 3 with clue 1 beside it.

- 14** Use the only choice left: clue 2 leaves Jonah one ribbon, and clue 1 settles Bea's. Now look at the rose and clue 3.
- 15** Clue 1 crosses out two fliers for bows. Read clue 3 beside clue 1: which tail is left for Una?
- 16** Clues 1 and 2 each leave one blank, so each gives a dot. Now read clue 3 beside clue 2: could the navy go on Imani's boat?
- 17** Clues 3 and 5 both keep a topping off the crumble. Put them together: how many toppings are left for it?
- 18** Clue 1 crosses out two spots for the striped buoy's owner. Read clue 2 beside it: which buoy must the East Cove lobsterman own?
- 19** Clue 6 is an either-or clue that gives Zeke two floats, and clue 5 crosses one of them off. Read them together.
- 20** Clue 5 talks about one of those same rooms. Put clues 3 and 5 together: could the Heron guest be from Boston?
- 21** Read clues 1 and 2 together. Clue 2 says the birder at the dunes saw the loon or the oriole.
- 22** Clue 4 is an either-or clue for Jonah, and clue 7 crosses off one of its two parts. Put them together.
- 23** Put two clues together. Clue 1 and clue 2 both mention the sun hat: could Otis have left it?
- 24** Carry an X. Clues 5 and 6 settle Gideon's ornament, and clue 2 says he grows no irises. Can that ornament stand with the irises?
- 25** Read clue 5 next to clue 2. Both mention the lemonade. Could the crab cake's diner have had it?
- 26** Two clues together: clue 1 tells you which words went with the wishbone. Is rhythm one of them?
- 27** Clue 1 crosses off two toppers for the carrot cake, and clue 4 says the star went on chocolate or lemon. Put them together.
- 28** Clue 2 gives the snail two pools to choose from, and clue 1 crosses one of them off. Put the two clues together.

- 29** Clue 3 says Kenji took home either the ribbon or the pie. Read that beside clue 1.
- 30** Clue 3 crosses off two kinds of oars for the Skipjack, and clue 4 keeps the blue-tipped oars away from it. Put them together.
- 31** Clue 1 is an exact gap, so count. Try Kit in each place and see where Ivan would have to stand.
- 32** Put clues 1 and 2 together: clue 1 needs room behind Hattie for Arlo, two floats back. Which end of the parade has room behind it?
- 33** Clue 1 is an exact gap: Yusuf boarded two turns before Lou. If Lou had boarded first, where could Yusuf go?
- 34** Clue 1 keeps Teddy off the fourth castle, and clue 3 puts Mabel closer in than Teddy, so Mabel has only two choices. Try clue 2 on each.
- 35** Clue 4 is a comparison: Felix stood behind Hugo. If Hugo is third or fourth (clue 3), how close to the front can Felix be?
- 36** Count the exact gap in clue 2. Then use clue 1: which of Pablo's possible spots leaves room for Amara on his right?
- 37** Clue 4 puts someone ahead of Oscar and clue 6 puts someone behind him, so which ends are ruled out? Then add what clues 1 and 3 cross out.
- 38** Read down the columns too. Anyone who stood to the right of someone cannot be first: check each clue for who it keeps off the far left.
- 39** Clue 2 is an exact gap, so count. Try the Dover visitor on each day and see where Imani would land.
- 40** Clue 5 is a pair clue: Faye and the piano's sender split Thursday and Friday between them. Put it beside clue 1.
- 41** Clue 2 is a pair clue: the hilltop and Wednesday go to Jade and Mabel, one each. What does that leave for Ruben and Vito?
- 42** Clue 3 is a pair clue. Could Olive be the July 29 volunteer? Put your answer beside clue 2.

- 43** Put clues 1 and 5 together. Clue 1 names the only notes Sunday could have. Is the wet paint among them?
- 44** Comparisons rule out the ends. Which boats do clues 1 and 2 keep off 9 a.m.? Then see what clue 6 says.
- 45** Every comparison hides an X. Clues 3 and 4 compare Lou and Zeke with the baguettes' customer. Could either of them be that customer?
- 46** Comparisons rule out the ends. Clue 3 needs someone before Dev, and clue 4 needs two hours after him. Which hours fit?
- 47** Opposites: Bea and Gus contradict each other, so exactly one of them is lying. The rule allows only one liar, the culprit.
- 48** Faye's statement means Linus didn't do it, which is just what Nico says. So those two statements are true together or false together.
- 49** Test one suspect at a time. The culprit's own statement must be false, so anyone whose statement would be true if they did it is cleared.
- 50** Jade's statement means Otis didn't do it, and Vito's means Otis did. Those are opposites, so exactly one is true.
- 51** They accuse different people, so at least one is false. The rule allows only one false statement, so Wren's and Elsa's must be true.
- 52** Opposites: exactly one of those two is false. The rule allows only one liar, so Priya and Gideon both tell the truth.
- 53** That is the opposites shortcut: exactly one of Felix and Teddy is telling the truth. The rule needs three true statements in all.
- 54** Dot's statement is true unless Dot did it, and Enzo's is true unless Rosa did. So if Enzo or Quinn did it, both are true.
- 55** Ivan's statement is the opposite of Lena's, and Oscar's is the opposite of Ivan's. So Lena and Oscar are both truthful or both fibbing.
- 56** Pablo's statement is true exactly when Yusuf's is, so they fib together or not at all. The rule allows only one fibber.

- 57** Imani's statement stands or falls with Carmen's, and Zeke's with Basil's. Exactly four true means just one statement is false.
- 58** Gideon's statement is true exactly when Vera's is, and Vera's exactly when Lou's is. Now count them against the rule: only one statement is true.
- 59** Put clues 3 and 1 together: clue 3 crosses out Baldwin and Empire for Pablo. Could he be the Macoun picker that clue 1 compares him with?
- 60** Put two clues together. Clue 3 hands \$4 and \$8 to Vera and Linus, so Dot and Gus share \$2 and \$6. Now read clue 1.
- 61** Put three clues together. Una is younger than Jade, who is younger than Felix, who is younger than Hugo. Four students, four ages.
- 62** Put two clues together. Clue 5 says the 16-inch fish was the mackerel or the flounder, so it was not the bluefish.
- 63** Clue 2 is a pair clue that takes two ferries away from Ruben, and clue 1 takes two from Gull Island. Now hold both against clue 4.
- 64** Clue 5 allows only the atlas or the biography at 25 cents. Comparisons rule out the ends, and clue 2 is a comparison.
- 65** Clue 7 is a pair clue, so Tubby weighed 500 or 600 pounds. Put it together with clue 5, which also limits Tubby.
- 66** Comparisons rule out the ends, and a fixed gap of 45 minutes rules out even more. Which times can Lou have? Then add clue 4.
- 67** Two either-or clues meet here. Clue 7 allows the donut or the candy apple at 25 minutes. Clue 9 says where the candy apple can be.
- 68** Comparisons rule out the ends. Ask which end clue 2 rules out for Otis, and how much room clue 6 needs above his clock's year.
- 69** Comparisons rule out the ends, and clue 5 is a comparison. Which end can the squid skipper never reach? Put that with clue 7.
- 70** Put two clues together. Clue 5 measures the ginger pie from the lattice pie, and clue 7 tells you exactly where the lattice pie stands.

- 71** Two clues together. Clue 9 keeps Enzo off 1,400 feet, so put it beside clue 6. Then read clue 1 for Felix.
- 72** Comparisons rule out the ends. Clue 2 keeps Olive off \$30 and \$40. Clue 6 says someone paid less than she did.
- 73** Two clues at once. Clue 1 keeps Tova off \$25, and clue 2 keeps her off \$100. Now where can the thank-you be?
- 74** Comparisons rule out the ends. Clue 2 keeps the ash off 1 cord. What do clues 4 and 5 say about the maple and the birch?
- 75** An exact gap is a fixed gap. On this scale a \$6 gap has only one fit, so clue 2 settles two squares at once.
- 76** Two clues at once: clue 2 keeps the nine patch off 2 tickets. What does clue 3 then rule out for the porch entrant?
- 77** Comparisons rule out the ends: clue 1 keeps the owl off 5 gallons. What do clues 5 and 6 say about the star and the moon?
- 78** Comparisons rule out the ends: clue 5 keeps the scarecrow off 125 pieces. What do clues 7 and 8 say about the mermaid and the pirate?
- 79** Both gaps are fixed: clue 1 needs 45 minutes before the stage helper, and clue 5 needs 15 minutes after. Which time leaves room for both?
- 80** Comparisons rule out the ends: use clue 1 on clue 5's two choices. Then put clues 1 and 8 together.
- 81** Two clues at once: clue 2 compares Selma with the window customer. Could Selma come in later than herself?
- 82** Two clues together. Clue 4's 30-year gap and clue 7's pair each limit the fishing visitor's age. Which age do both allow?
- 83** Comparisons rule out the ends. Apply clues 3 and 8 to the grapes, then see which time clue 7 takes away.
- 84** Two clues together: clue 7 also speaks about noon and the permit. Once the permit's hour is settled, see which hours clues 6, 7 and 8 leave for the radio.

- 85** Two clues together: clues 8 and 9 both mention repairs. Then do the same for Linus with clues 12 and 7.
- 86** Two clues together: clues 3 and 4 both talk about 2:30, so read them side by side for Greta. Then see what clue 8 says about 3:00.
- 87** Use a Suppose. Pencil Basil in at 2:00, then follow clue 3 for Zeke and the coffee, and clue 9 for the cocoa.
- 88** Put clues 1 and 2 together to find who wore the beret. When the clues run dry, test Otis's hat: clue 5 allows only two.
- 89** Clue 8 settles the fudge seller too, and clues 2, 3, 5 and 9 leave the star tag only one table. Later, test Elsa's table with a Suppose.
- 90** Next, find which brush goes with \$16 and who spent \$14. When the clues run dry, test Yusuf's total with a Suppose: clues 5 and 8 leave him two.
- 91** Use two clues together: clues 1 and 2 settle the flashlight's landing, and clue 8 then finds the thermos. When the clues run dry, test Hugo's time with a Suppose.
- 92** Time for a Suppose: clue 5 ties Milo to Imani, 40 minutes apart, and clue 7 limits Quinn. Test Imani's earlier time.
- 93** Use two clues together: clues 1 and 7 settle the 45-year-old's duster, and then Jade's. When the clues run dry, test Jade's age with a Suppose: she has two left.
- 94** Clues 3 and 5 both mention Hal and the net: put them together, then use clues 6 and 4. Later, test one of Priya's two possible times with a Suppose.
- 95** Clue 4 makes Emil 70 or 80, and clue 10 puts those two ages in flowered and white. Clue 2 leaves Ruben two ages: test one of them with a Suppose.
- 96** Clue 5, a pair clue, leaves Selma just two glove choices. After clues 3 and 1, test one of them with a Suppose, then follow clue 2.
- 97** Put pair clues 1 and 2 together, then clue 12. When the clues stall, the Minnow has just two possible rowers left: test one with a Suppose.

- 98** Use two clues together: clues 7 and 8 settle 6:20 p.m., and clue 5 follows. Then Suppose: the 6:20 p.m. person has only two places left to go.
- 99** Use two clues together: clues 7 and 3 fix the Point's time, and then Mabel's. Then Suppose: clue 2 leaves Jonah only two lights to test.
- 100** Use two clues together: clues 5 and 9 place Wren, then clues 2 and 8 place Lena. When the clues stall, Suppose: Wren has only two jobs left.

Hints, Step 3: The Key Step

The turning point of the puzzle, spelled out. After this, the rest should flow.

- 1** So Lena drank Earl Grey. Her dot crosses out Earl Grey for Teddy, and clue 1 rules out mint, so Teddy drank chamomile.
- 2** Clue 1 gives Rosa two choices, and the sweet pea seeds are Hugo's. So Rosa brought the marigold seeds, and Della the zinnia seeds.
- 3** Felix did not pack the chowder (clue 1) or the egg salad (Tova's, clue 2). So Felix packed the meatloaf, and Ivan the chowder.
- 4** Otis gave neither the sou'wester (clue 1) nor the beret (Pearl's, clue 2). So Otis gave the straw hat, and Linus the sou'wester.
- 5** So Amara asked for the coupons. Clue 1 then rules out the tide table for Nico, so Nico wanted the puzzle book.
- 6** So Kit left the navy umbrella. Gus then has only yellow left, since clue 1 rules out polka-dot.
- 7** So Faye took the gift shop. Clue 2 then leaves Jonah only the tours, and Boris gets the cocoa stand.
- 8** So Enzo took home Bubbles. Then clue 2 leaves Wren only Admiral, and Dev took Pip.
- 9** So Priya wore the green gloves. Then clues 3, 2 and 4 rule Zeke out of green, floral and leather, so Zeke wore striped.
- 10** So Gus wrote the bake sale letter. The seagull letter is not Gus's, Tariq's (clue 4) or Hal's (clue 2), so Vera wrote it.
- 11** Felix sailed the sloop, not the dory, so by clue 2 he did not fly gold. Clue 3 rules out Arlo, so Selma flew gold.
- 12** Hattie used the mason jar, so Lou used the crock. Carry the dot: by clue 3, Lou made the plum jam.
- 13** Kenji returned the atlas, so by clue 3 Della returned the whodunit, with the postcard in it. That leaves the cookbook for Nico.

- 14** Clue 3 leaves the rose only lavender, which was Cyrus's. So Cyrus ordered the rose, and clue 4 leaves Jonah the peony.
- 15** Clue 1 gives Hugo the bows, so clue 3 gives Una the tassels, leaving Teddy the streamers. Carry the dot: clue 4 puts Teddy on the dragon kite.
- 16** Imani's boat is the Lucky Gull, and navy is not hers, so clue 3 puts navy on the Wavelet. Navy is Basil's, so Basil brought in the Wavelet.
- 17** Clues 3 and 5 leave the crumble only the custard. Clue 2 gives the custard to Walt, so carry the dot: Walt baked the crumble.
- 18** Clues 1 and 2 give East Cove the checkered buoy, and Oscar does not fish there (clue 5). So by clue 3, Oscar owns the striped buoy.
- 19** So Zeke built the whale float. Then Marta, kept off the tall ship by clue 3 and the lighthouse by clue 5, built the lobster.
- 20** Clue 5 keeps the Boston guest out of the Heron Room, so clue 3 leaves the Puffin Room. By clues 1 and 2, that guest is Vito.
- 21** So the osprey was not seen from the dunes. By clue 1, its spotter was at the old pier, and Dev was at the dunes.
- 22** So Jonah painted the shutters. Clue 5 keeps the wide brush off the shutters, so by clue 1 Faye used the wide brush.
- 23** No: clue 2 gives the sun hat to Yusuf or Carmen. So Otis left the novel, and by clue 1 Yusuf left the sun hat.
- 24** Gideon has the birdbath (clues 5 and 6) but no irises, and clue 3 keeps the irises from the sundial and the gnome. So the irises go with the trellis.
- 25** No: clue 5 puts the lemonade with the lobster roll or fish tacos. So the crab cake came with iced tea, and Felix drank lemonade.
- 26** No: by clue 1 the wishbone went with kayak or zucchini. So rhythm goes with the sea glass, and pharaoh with the lucky penny.
- 27** So the carrot cake had the diploma topper. Clue 2 keeps Jade off the carrot cake, so by clue 3 she ordered the lemon cake.

- 28** So the snail came from Mermaid Pool. Then clues 1 and 3 leave the crab only Bathtub Pool, and the urchin only Moon Pool.
- 29** So Kenji did not win the trophy, and by clue 1 Priya did. Then clues 2 and 3 leave the medal only for Della.
- 30** So the Skipjack's rower used the spruce oars. Clues 5 and 6 give Felix the spruce oars, so Felix rowed the Skipjack.
- 31** Only first and fourth are three places apart, so Kit was first and Ivan fourth. Clue 2 then gives third place to Rosa.
- 32** Nothing rolled behind the last float, so Hattie led the parade. Then by clue 1, Arlo rode on the third float.
- 33** Nobody boarded before the first passenger, so Lou boarded last. Then by clue 1, Yusuf boarded second.
- 34** If Mabel built the second castle, Teddy would build the third, right beside her, against clue 2. So Mabel built the first castle.
- 35** Hugo was third or fourth (clue 3), so Felix, behind him, was fourth or fifth. Clue 1 puts Vera behind Felix, so Felix was fourth and Hugo third.
- 36** Clue 1 keeps Pablo off the fifth blanket, so by clue 2 Pablo sat fourth and Lena first. Then Amara took the fifth blanket.
- 37** Clues 4 and 6 keep Oscar off both ends, and clues 1 and 3 rule out second and fourth. So Oscar held the third spot.
- 38** Clues 1 to 4 keep Jonah, Otis, Lena and Hattie off the far left. So Gus stood first, and by clue 2, Otis stood second.
- 39** So the Dover visitor went out on Monday and Imani on Thursday, the only days three apart. Clue 1 then leaves Tuesday for Hal.
- 40** Gus has Thursday, so Faye shipped on Friday, and the piano was Gus's. Clue 4 then puts Una on Tuesday and Tariq on Wednesday.
- 41** Clue 3 then leaves Vito only Saturday. Clues 2 and 5 keep Ruben off three patches, so Ruben worked the stone wall.
- 42** So Olive read on July 22 and Sam on July 29. By clue 3, those two read the pirate tale and the poems.

- 43** So the wet paint was Thursday's note. Then by clue 2, the odd flicker came on Friday and the stuck latch on Sunday.
- 44** So the Whelk went out at 9 a.m. Then clue 3 keeps the Bluebell off noon, so by clue 6 it went out at 10 a.m.
- 45** With clue 5 ruling out Nico, Milo ordered the baguettes. By clues 3 and 4, Lou came before him and Zeke after, and clue 1 keeps Zeke off 10 a.m.
- 46** So Dev arrived at 2 p.m., and by clue 4 the quilt came at 4 p.m. Then clue 3 puts the zucchini at 1 p.m.
- 47** So the culprit is Bea or Gus, and Teddy tells the truth. Teddy says Gus ate the scone, and Gus fits the rule.
- 48** Only one statement is false, and it can't come from that pair. So Linus's is false, and Nico left the pen open.
- 49** So neither Mabel nor Kit is the culprit, which leaves Hal. Check: Hal's statement is false, and Mabel's and Kit's are true.
- 50** That pair uses up the rule's one true statement, so Otis's is false. Neither Vito nor Otis sounded the horn, so Jade did.
- 51** Wren's true statement puts the swap on Hattie or Wren, so Hattie's accusation of Cyrus is false. Then Cyrus is right: Wren did it.
- 52** Priya says Una or Priya hid it, and Gideon rules out Priya. So Una hid the gavel, and hers is the only false statement.
- 53** So Marta's and Sam's statements must both be true. Sam's clears Sam, and Marta's clears Marta and Teddy, which leaves Felix.
- 54** Then a third comes true as well: Quinn's if it was Enzo, Rosa's if it was Quinn. That is one too many, so test Dot and Rosa.
- 55** If Lena and Oscar both fibbed, Nadia would need to be truthful, naming Oscar, and that makes Lena's statement true. So Lena and Oscar are truthful.
- 56** So Pablo and Yusuf both tell the truth, and neither is the culprit. Yusuf names Arlo or Pablo, which leaves Arlo.

- 57** A false statement from Carmen, Imani, Basil or Zeke would bring a second one with it. So the one false statement is Otis's.
- 58** All three true would be three true statements, one too many. So all three are false, and Lou's false statement means Gideon or Priya did it.
- 59** So Pablo picked the Cortland apples. A 15-pound gap fits only 10 and 25 pounds, so Pablo picked 10 and the Macoun picker 25.
- 60** So Dot made \$6 and Gus \$2. Clues 4 and 2 work the same way: the teapot sold for \$2, the records for \$8.
- 61** So Una is 40, Jade 45, Felix 50 and Hugo 55. Clue 4's 15-year gap then fits only 40 and 55.
- 62** So the bluefish was 18 inches, and clue 4 keeps Elsa off it. Then clues 3 and 6 put Cyrus at 12, Oscar 14, Elsa 16.
- 63** So Ruben, half an hour before Gull Island, sailed at 7:00 or 8:00 a.m. Clue 2 rules out 7:00, so Ruben took the 8:00 a.m. ferry.
- 64** So the atlas fine was 25 cents, since clue 2 puts the biography fine above it. Then clue 2 makes the biography fine 50 cents.
- 65** So Tubby weighed 500 pounds and the compost pumpkin 600. Clue 6 keeps Gus off 600, so Gus did not use compost.
- 66** So Lou came at 5:00 and the squash soup at 5:45. Clue 4 then fits only one way: Rosa at 5:15, the apple crisp at 5:30.
- 67** So the 25-minute friend picked the donut. Then clue 6 gives the kettle corn to the south gate friend, who is someone else.
- 68** So Otis's clock is from 1890 and the banjo clock from 1910. Clues 2, 3 and 6 then leave Otis only the ship's clock.
- 69** Squid cannot be 50, so by clue 7 squid hauled 40 and pogies 50. Arlo hauled more than squid's 40, so Arlo hauled 50 with pogies.
- 70** So the ginger pie baked 45 minutes. Then by clue 1, the 55-minute pie had nutmeg, and the crumble crust went with ginger.
- 71** So Wren topped out at 1,400 feet and Enzo at 1,200. Clue 1 leaves Felix only 800 feet, so Cass topped out at 1,000.

- 72** So Olive paid \$20. By clue 6 the recipes ad cost \$10, and by clue 2 the tides ad cost \$40.
- 73** Tova gave \$50 or \$75, so the thank-you came with \$75 or \$100. Then clue 6 gives the \$50 gift the riddle.
- 74** So the oak was the 1-cord order. By clue 1, the 1-cord and 3-cord loads were stacked by the garage and the porch.
- 75** So Teddy paid \$3 and the corn maze rider \$9. Clues 7 and 3 then give Teddy the cider jug.
- 76** Clue 6 puts Pablo above the porch entrant, so the porch had 6 tickets and Pablo 8. By clue 5, the den had 8: Pablo's.
- 77** So the anchor made 5 gallons. The moon made 10 or 15, so by clues 7 and 4, Felix made 15 and the moon 10.
- 78** So the robot handed out 125, with caramels or licorice (clue 1). By clue 6, the taffy was 50 and the licorice 125.
- 79** The stage helper came at 6:45, the only time with 45 minutes before it and 15 after. So the pumpkin pie's baker came at 7:00, and the mince pie's baker at 6:00.
- 80** Clue 8 gives mail the fleece or the parka, and clue 1 rules out the fleece. So mail had the parka, and 8:00 the fleece.
- 81** Clue 2 keeps Selma out of the window, so by clue 9 Lou sat there. Clues 1, 3, 8 and 11 then leave Lou only the muffin.
- 82** So the fishing excuse goes with 60. By clue 7, Cass is 20, and by clue 4 the sketching excuse is 30.
- 83** So the grapes came at 6:00 or 6:30, and Wren later (clue 8). Clue 1 gives 6:30 to Otis or Faye, so Wren came at 7:00.
- 84** Clues 4 and 7 put the permit at 1:00. The radio is not at 9:00 (clue 8), 10:00 (clue 6) or noon (clue 7), so it came at 11:00.
- 85** Clue 9 keeps Hattie off repairs, so clue 8 gives her dusting. Then clues 12, 7 and 2 give Linus the bats, Gideon the pigeons, Tova repairs and Pablo the view.

- 86** Clue 3 keeps Greta off 2:30, so clue 4 puts her at 1:00 and the rubber boots at 2:30. Then clue 8 gives Pearl 3:00 and Greta the work boots.
- 87** If Basil sat down at 2:00, clue 3 leaves Zeke 2:20 and the coffee 3:20, but clue 9 puts the cocoa at 3:20. So Basil sat down at 3:20.
- 88** Suppose Otis wore the cap. Clue 5 gives the toolbox the bonnet, clue 6 leaves the 8:00 umbrella the beanie, and clue 4 leaves the lantern no hat.
- 89** Suppose Elsa sold candles. Then candles had 3 hours and, by clue 3, the holly tag (Dev has the reindeer); 2 hours falls to mittens, and clue 1 breaks.
- 90** Suppose Yusuf spent \$8. Clue 8 puts the purple wide-brush buyer at \$10, so clue 2 needs the rag's buyer at \$8. But that is Yusuf, with the spray can.
- 91** Cass has the thermos, so clues 5, 6 and 7 leave Hugo 5:00 or 6:00 p.m. Suppose 5:00: then only Wren fits 6:00 and only Cass 5:30, after Hugo, against clue 7.
- 92** Suppose Imani came in at 8:40 p.m. Then clue 5 puts Milo at 8:00, and clue 7 leaves Quinn only 8:00 too, a clash. So Imani came at 9:00.
- 93** Suppose Jade is 55. Then the shells must be 65 and the maps 75 (clues 4 and 6), leaving the lanterns no age (clue 2), so Jade is 65.
- 94** Suppose Priya came at 2:00. Then the cooler came by 1:30 and the skiff earlier (clue 8), and clues 9 and 10 leave 1:45 no boat. So Priya came at 1:00.
- 95** Suppose Ruben is 80. Then Emil is 70 (clue 4), the two wear flowered and white (clue 10), and clues 9, 5 and 7 leave Gus no apron.
- 96** Suppose Selma wore fingerless. Then the spare key's borrower wore fleece (clue 5), Gus wore ski (clue 2), and the tide chart's borrower has no gloves left.

- 97** Suppose Imani took the Minnow, at 3:30 p.m. Clue 3 then puts Felix at 3:00 p.m., and clue 9 leaves Teddy no later time.
- 98** Jonah went on to the bakery or the church. Suppose the bakery: clue 3 puts the inn at 6:00 p.m., and clue 2 leaves the church no later time.
- 99** Suppose Jonah had the penlight. Then clue 2 gives the 7:40 p.m. person the headlamp, and clue 6 puts the penlight at 7:20 p.m.: Mabel's time, not his.
- 100** Suppose Wren ran the banners. Then Hattie ran the lanterns in red, clue 3 puts navy on the choir, and the 8:00 p.m. green coat has no job.

Stuck Halfway?

For the four- and five-star puzzles: a push through the middle of the solve.

- 65** Gus used neither seaweed (clue 6) nor fish meal (clue 8), so he used coffee. Then clues 1, 6 and 8 give the 600-pound pumpkin to Kenji.
- 66** Clue 3 keeps the basket away from Lou, so it did not come at 5:00. By clue 6, the basket came at 5:15 and the box at 5:45.
- 67** Clues 1 and 3 put the barn door at 30 minutes. The 25-minute donut was not the south gate or the north gate (clue 5), so it was the scarecrow.
- 68** Clue 4 spans all 30 years, so oak is 1910 and walnut 1880. By clue 2 the mantel clock is older than Otis's, so it is the 1880 walnut.
- 69** With Arlo on pogies, clue 6 gives Yusuf the 30 traps. Clue 2 leaves Nico only 20, so Greta hauled 40 with the squid.
- 70** Clue 6: the 40-minute pie is not the crumble crust, which baked 45. So it was braided, Vito made the crumble, and clue 3 puts Imani at 40.
- 71** Clue 3 puts the jerky above Cass's 1,000 feet, and clue 5 needs the trail mix 200 feet higher still. So Enzo packed jerky and Wren trail mix.
- 72** Clue 1 puts the wavy border in puzzles or tides, but clue 5 gives the tides ad a plain or dotted border. So wavy ran in puzzles.
- 73** The \$25 gift had no poem (clue 1), thank-you or riddle, so it came with the drawing. That leaves Tova only the riddle.
- 74** The shed and barn must hold 2 and 4 cords. Clue 6 keeps the shed off 4, so the shed had 2 and the maple 3.
- 75** Clues 5, 3 and 6 send the pumpkin to the cider stand, so Teddy rode to the farm stand. Now clue 1 sets Basil's fare.
- 76** Clues 2 and 3 keep the nine patch off 2, 8 and the porch's 6, so it had 4. By clue 5, Emil had 4 too.

- 77** The star made 15 or 20, so by clue 5 the spicy mix made 10 or 15. Clue 2 rules out 10.
- 78** Clue 7 keeps Otis off 50, so by clue 3 Mabel had the 50-piece taffy. Then clues 7 and 2 leave Otis only 125: the robot.
- 79** Clues 2 and 3 put Della at the bake table, which clue 7 keeps off 7:00, the pumpkin's time. Clue 8 then leaves Della the cherry pie.
- 80** By clue 1, mail came at 7:30. Clue 2 keeps Hal off 7:30, so by clue 4 Walt came for mail and Hal wore the peacoat.
- 81** Clues 5 and 4 put Priya at 7:30 and the bagel at 8:00. Clues 7 and 2 then leave Lou only 7:00.
- 82** Cass is not 50, so by clue 9 Arlo is 50 and Cass gave the jogging excuse. Clues 6 and 8 then leave only Milo for fishing.
- 83** By clue 2, the 5:30 visitor brought pretzels or almonds, so clue 6 puts the popcorn at 6:30. The grapes came at 6:00.
- 84** By clue 6, the 10:00 visitor asked about the lost cap. So by clue 5 the desk was at 9:00, and by clue 8 the stove at 10:00.
- 85** Only Tova can take Wednesday: clues 4, 5 and 10 keep Linus, Hattie and Gideon off it, and clue 1 keeps Pablo's view off it.
- 86** By clues 4, 6, 7 and 8, Pearl's 3:00 boots were cowboy. Oscar's were not hiking (clue 7) or the 2:30 rubber (clue 3), so snow.
- 87** Clue 1 keeps Basil from coffee, so by clue 3 the coffee came at 3:00 and Zeke at 2:00, with the cocoa (clue 9).
- 88** Otis wore the bonnet, so clue 4 gives Vito the beanie and Otis the lantern. Clue 3 keeps the cap off 7:30: the basket cannot come at 8:00.
- 89** With Elsa at mittens for 3 hours, clues 1 and 7 put the holly tag at 1 hour. Clue 9 puts the star at 4 hours.
- 90** With Yusuf at \$12, the wide-brush buyer spent \$14: Della. Clue 9 keeps the roller off \$8, so clue 4 puts Enzo at \$16.
- 91** With Hugo at 6:00, clue 3 keeps the thermos off 5:30, since Wren must come later. So Cass climbed at 4:30 p.m.

- 92** Greta came in at 9:20, Imani at 9:00 and Milo at 8:20. Clue 6 keeps Selma off 8:00, so Selma came at 8:40.
- 93** With Jade at 65, the shells are 55 and the lanterns 75. By clue 6, the maps are 65: Jade dusted them.
- 94** With Priya at 1:00, clue 1 puts Nico at 1:30 and Una at 2:00, with the kayak. Clue 1 again gives Hal the canoe.
- 95** With Ruben at 75, clues 9 and 10 make blue 65, so Ruben wears plaid. Emil wears flowered, Gus white, and clue 5 makes Gus 80.
- 96** So Selma wore fleece and took the tide chart (clue 2). Clue 6 keeps fleece off 11:30 a.m., so Selma signed at 10:30 a.m.
- 97** With Teddy at 3:30 p.m., clues 4 and 8 give 2:30 p.m. to Nico. Then clues 11 and 6 put East Cove at 3:00 p.m.
- 98** With the church at 6:20 p.m., clue 3 keeps the inn before 6:00 p.m. So clue 7 keeps Kenji off 5:40 p.m., and clue 4 gives that slot to Hattie.
- 99** With the headlamp Jonah's, clue 2 gives the penlight to 7:40 p.m., and clue 6 puts the headlamp 20 minutes later. Which spot goes with that time?
- 100** With Wren on the lanterns, Hattie ran the banners and wore red. Red came before the choir (clue 1), so Hattie took the 7:00 p.m. photo.

Solutions

Each solution starts with the finished answer, so you can check your grid at a glance. Below it, the key idea and the reasoning, step by step.

1 · Ada's Welcome Tea

Teddy: chamomile

Una: mint

Lena: Earl Grey

Key idea: Clue 2 crosses out two of Lena's three teas, so she drank Earl Grey, and the rest follows.

Clue 2 puts X's on mint and chamomile in Lena's row, so Lena drank Earl Grey. Clue 1 crosses out mint for Teddy, and Earl Grey is Lena's, so Teddy drank chamomile. That leaves the mint tea for Una.

Teddy drank chamomile, Una mint, and Lena Earl Grey, with her gloves on in case the cup was older than she was. Ada wrote it all down for next time.

2 · The Seed Swap Envelopes

Rosa: marigold

Della: zinnia

Hugo: sweet pea

Key idea: Clue 2 gives Hugo the sweet pea seeds, which leaves Rosa only the marigold seeds from clue 1.

Clue 2 puts a dot at Hugo and sweet pea, with X's on the rest of that row and column. Clue 1 crosses out zinnia for Rosa. Sweet pea is Hugo's, so Rosa brought the marigold seeds. Della, with one blank square left, brought the zinnia seeds.

Wren thanked Della for the zinnias, Rosa for the marigolds and Hugo for the sweet peas, in her tidiest hand. Hugo's note also mentioned, in very small letters, an overdue cookbook.

3 · The Lunch Pail Mix-Up

Felix: meatloaf
Ivan: chowder

Tova: egg salad

Key idea: Clue 1 keeps the chowder away from Felix, and clue 2 gives the egg salad to Tova, so Felix packed the meatloaf.

Clue 2 puts a dot at Tova and egg salad, with X's across her row and down the egg salad column. Clue 1 says the chowder was Ivan's or Tova's, so Felix did not pack it. That leaves Felix only one choice: the meatloaf. The chowder goes to Ivan.

Felix ate his own meatloaf at last, Tova her egg salad and Ivan his chowder. By the next morning every pail wore a name label, in Felix's best pencil.

4 · The Rummage Sale Hats

Otis: straw hat
Pearl: beret

Linus: sou'wester

Key idea: With the sou'wester ruled out by clue 1 and the beret taken by Pearl, Otis's only hat is the straw hat.

Clue 2 gives Pearl the beret: one dot, and X's on the rest of her row and the beret column. Clue 1 says the sou'wester came from Pearl or Linus, so not from Otis. So Otis gave the straw hat, his only choice left. Linus gave the sou'wester.

Otis gave the straw hat, Linus the sou'wester, and Pearl the beret. Hattie wrote three thank-you cards and ticked one more item off one more list.

5 · The New Paper Route

Nico: puzzle book
Sam: tide table

Amara: coupons

Key idea: Clue 2 crosses out two of the three customers for the coupons, so Amara asked for them.

Clue 2 puts X's at Nico and Sam in the coupons column, so Amara asked for the coupons. Clue 1 says the tide table went to Sam or Amara, so Nico

did not ask for it. Nico did not ask for the coupons either, so Nico wanted the puzzle book. Sam, with one square left, wanted the tide table.

The next morning Nico got his puzzle book, Amara her coupons and Sam his tide table. Teddy spent part of his first week's pay on a small notebook.

6 · The Muddled Umbrellas

Mabel: plaid

Gus: yellow

Kit: navy

Oscar: polka-dot

Key idea: Clue 3 and Mabel's plaid umbrella cross out three of Kit's four squares, so Kit's umbrella was navy.

Clue 2 gives Mabel the plaid umbrella, so no one else left the plaid one. Clue 3 rules out yellow and polka-dot for Kit, so Kit left the navy umbrella. Clue 1 rules out polka-dot for Gus. Plaid and navy are taken, so Gus left the yellow one. Oscar left the polka-dot umbrella.

All four umbrellas went home before the noon ferry: plaid to Mabel, yellow to Gus, navy to Kit and polka-dot to Oscar. Priya's lost-and-found stayed at forty-one.

7 · Opening Day at the Light

Jonah: tours

Imani: ticket desk

Boris: cocoa stand

Faye: gift shop

Key idea: Clue 3 and Imani's ticket desk leave Faye just one job, the gift shop.

Clue 1 puts Imani at the ticket desk, so no one else had it. Clue 3 rules out the tours and the cocoa stand for Faye, so Faye took the gift shop. Clue 2 gives Jonah the gift shop or the tours. The gift shop is Faye's, so Jonah led the tours. Boris ran the cocoa stand.

Imani sold tickets, Faye ran the gift shop, Boris poured cocoa, and Jonah led the tours, finishing each one exactly on the minute.

8 · The Sourdough Adoption

Wren: Admiral

Dev: Pip

Quinn: Barnacle

Enzo: Bubbles

Key idea: Clue 1 offers Bubbles to Enzo or Quinn, and Quinn already has Barnacle, so Bubbles went home with Enzo.

Clue 3 gives Quinn Barnacle, so Quinn has no other starter and nobody else has Barnacle. Clue 1 says Bubbles went to Enzo or Quinn. Quinn already has Barnacle, so Enzo took Bubbles. Clue 2 gives Wren Admiral or Barnacle. Barnacle is Quinn's, so Wren took Admiral. Dev took Pip.

Wren took home Admiral, Dev took Pip, Quinn took Barnacle, and Enzo took Bubbles. Rosa mailed each of them a card with their starter's birthday on it.

9 · The Tulip Planting Gloves

Priya: green

Zeke: striped

Olive: floral

Cass: leather

Key idea: Clues 1 and 3 together cross out three gardeners for the green gloves, so Priya wore them.

Clue 3 rules out Zeke and Cass for the green gloves, and clue 1 rules out Olive. So Priya wore green. Clue 2 rules out floral for Zeke, and clue 4 rules out leather. Green is Priya's, so Zeke wore striped. Clue 1 now leaves Olive only the floral gloves. Cass wore the leather gloves.

Priya's green, Zeke's striped, Olive's floral and Cass's leather gloves all went home with Mabel's polite notes tucked inside. Every note was grammatically perfect.

10 · The Unsigned Letters

Gus: bake sale

Hal: parking

Tariq: pothole

Vera: seagull

Key idea: Clue 2 keeps Hal off the bake sale letter, so clue 1 leaves only Gus to write it.

Clue 1 says Gus or Hal wrote the bake sale letter. Clue 2 rules out Hal, so Gus wrote it. The seagull letter was not Tariq's (clue 4) or Hal's (clue 2), and Gus is taken, so Vera wrote it. Clue 3 rules out the parking letter for Tariq, and clue 4 rules out two more, so Tariq wrote the pothole letter. Hal wrote the parking letter.

Gus had written about the bake sale, Tariq about a pothole, Hal about parking and Vera about a seagull. All four signed, and the Gazette printed them on Thursday, with only one paw print.

11 · The Regatta Pennants

Felix: blue, sloop

Arlo: red, catboat

Selma: gold, dory

Key idea: Only Felix could have sailed the sloop (clue 4), so the gold pennant on the dory (clue 2) was Selma's (clue 3).

Clue 4 says neither Selma nor Arlo sailed the sloop, so Felix sailed it. By clue 2, gold flew on the dory, and Felix sailed the sloop, so gold was not Felix's. Clue 3 rules out Arlo, so it was Selma's. Carry the dot: Selma sailed the dory, which leaves Arlo the catboat. By clue 1, the red pennant was not on the sloop, and the dory already had gold, so red flew on Arlo's catboat. That leaves the blue pennant for Felix on the sloop.

Otis fixed the start sheet with a minute to spare: Felix's sloop under blue, Selma's dory under gold, Arlo's catboat under red. The horn went off at ten sharp.

12 · The Swapped Jam Labels

Hattie: quince, mason jar

Ruben: fig, tin

Lou: plum, crock

Key idea: Clues 2 and 4 settle every jar, and then clue 3 carries the plum jam to Lou's crock.

Clue 2 leaves Ruben only one jar: the tin. Clue 4 says Hattie did not use the crock, and the tin is Ruben's, so Hattie used the mason jar and Lou the crock. Clue 3 puts the plum jam in the crock, so Lou made the plum jam. By clue 1 the fig jam was not in the mason jar, and the crock held plum, so fig was in Ruben's tin. That leaves the quince jam for Hattie, in the mason jar.

The ribbons went out on time, and every jam went back to its cook: Hattie's quince, Ruben's fig and Lou's plum. That evening Hattie began a new list, titled "Labels."

13 · The Book Drop Surprise

Nico: cookbook, receipt

Della: whodunit, postcard

Kenji: atlas, ribbon

Key idea: Clue 4 hands Della the postcard, and with the atlas already Kenji's, clue 3 leaves her the whodunit.

Clue 1 gives Kenji the atlas, and clue 4 leaves only Della for the postcard. Clue 3 says Della returned the whodunit or the atlas; the atlas is Kenji's, so Della returned the whodunit. That leaves the cookbook for Nico. By clue 2 the ribbon was not in the cookbook, and the postcard was in Della's whodunit, so the cookbook held the receipt. So Nico used the receipt, and the ribbon was in Kenji's atlas.

Wren cleared all three accounts and returned each bookmark: Della's postcard, Nico's receipt and Kenji's ribbon. She would remember all three by these books for twenty years.

14 · The Mother's Day Corsages

Jonah: peony, white

Bea: carnation, peach

Cyrus: rose, lavender

Key idea: Clues 1 and 2 give Jonah the white ribbon and Cyrus the lavender; clue 3 then carries the rose to Cyrus.

Clue 2 leaves Jonah only the white ribbon, and clue 1 gives Bea the peach, so Cyrus chose lavender. By clue 3, the rose was tied with neither white nor peach, so its ribbon was lavender. Carry the dot: the lavender ribbon was Cyrus's, so Cyrus ordered the rose. Clue 4 says Jonah ordered the rose or the peony; the rose is Cyrus's, so Jonah ordered the peony. That leaves Bea the carnation, tied with her peach ribbon, and Jonah's peony wore white.

Mabel handed over every corsage before noon: Jonah's peony with white ribbon, Bea's carnation with peach, and Cyrus's rose with lavender. Then she corrected the spelling on all three slips.

15 · Kite Day Tangle

Teddy: dragon, streamers

Una: box, tassels

Hugo: diamond, bows

Key idea: Clue 1 leaves only Hugo for the bows, so clue 3 gives Una the tassels, and Teddy's streamers put him on the dragon kite.

Clue 1 rules out Teddy and Una for the bows, so Hugo chose bows. Clue 3 gives Una tassels or bows. The bows are Hugo's, so Una chose tassels, and Teddy chose streamers. Clue 4 says the dragon kite had the streamers. Teddy chose streamers, so Teddy flew the dragon kite. Clue 2 gives Una the dragon or the box kite. The dragon is Teddy's, so Una flew the box kite. Hugo flew the diamond kite. So the box kite had the tassels, and the diamond kite had the bows.

Teddy reeled in his dragon kite with its streamers, Una her box kite with tassels, and Hugo his diamond kite with bows. Teddy photographed the untangling too, all fourteen minutes of it.

16 · The Boatyard Paint Cans

Gus: cream, Sea Pea

Imani: sea green, Lucky Gull

Basil: navy, Wavelet

Key idea: Navy is Basil's (clue 2) and cannot go on Imani's Lucky Gull, so clue 3 puts it on the Wavelet, Basil's boat.

Clue 1 leaves Imani only the Lucky Gull. Clue 2 leaves only Basil for navy. Clue 3 puts the navy on the Lucky Gull or the Wavelet. Imani did not choose navy, so it is not on her Lucky Gull. So the navy goes on the Wavelet. Basil chose navy, so Basil brought in the Wavelet, and Gus the Sea Pea. Clue 4 gives Imani navy or sea green. Navy is Basil's, so Imani chose sea green, and Gus chose cream. So the Lucky Gull gets sea green, and the Sea Pea gets cream.

Gus painted the Sea Pea cream, Imani gave the Lucky Gull a coat of sea green, and Basil's Wavelet went navy. Felix called all three shipshape. Mostly shipshape.

17 · The Rhubarb Social

Rosa: shortcake, ice cream

Walt: crumble, custard

Elsa: pie, honey

Key idea: Clues 3 and 5 leave the crumble only the custard, which is Walt's, so Walt baked the crumble.

Clue 2 rules out Rosa and Elsa for the custard, so Walt brought it. Clue 3 rules out the ice cream for the crumble, and clue 5 rules out the honey. So the crumble came with the custard. Walt brought the custard, so Walt baked the crumble. Clue 1 rules out the pie for Rosa, so Rosa baked the shortcake, and Elsa baked the pie. Clue 4 gives Rosa the ice cream or the custard. The custard is Walt's, so Rosa brought the ice cream, and Elsa the honey.

Rosa's shortcake wore the ice cream, Walt's crumble came with custard, and Elsa's pie got the honey. Hattie moved every place card and crossed one more item off her list.

18 · The Buoys After the Storm

Oscar: striped, the Narrows

Nico: checkered, East Cove

Pablo: orange, Gull Rock

Key idea: Clues 1 and 2 put the checkered buoy at East Cove; Oscar does not fish there (clue 5), so clue 3 gives him striped.

Clue 1 leaves the striped buoy's owner only the Narrows. By clue 2, the East Cove lobsterman owns the checkered or striped buoy. Striped goes with the Narrows, so East Cove goes with checkered. That leaves Gull Rock for the orange buoy. Oscar does not fish at East Cove (clue 5), so he does not own the checkered buoy. By clue 3, Oscar owns the striped buoy, so he fishes at the Narrows. By clue 4, the checkered buoy is Nico's, so Nico fishes at East Cove. Pablo owns the orange buoy and fishes at Gull Rock.

Oscar got his striped buoy back for the Narrows, Nico his checkered one for East Cove, and Pablo his orange one for Gull Rock. Nico claimed his had drifted halfway to Pine Key.

19 · The Memorial Day Floats

Lena: tall ship, banjo

Gus: lighthouse, tuba

Zeke: whale, fiddle

Marta: lobster, accordion

Key idea: Clue 6 gives Zeke two floats and clue 5 takes the lighthouse away, so Zeke built the whale.

Clue 6 gives Zeke the lighthouse or the whale, and clue 5 rules out the lighthouse, so Zeke built the whale float. Clues 3 and 5 keep Marta off the tall ship and the lighthouse, and the whale is Zeke's, so Marta built the lobster. Clue 2 keeps the banjo off the whale, so by clue 4 Zeke played the fiddle and Lena the banjo. By clue 2, Lena's banjo went with the tall ship or the lobster. The lobster is Marta's, so Lena built the tall ship and Gus the lighthouse. By clue 1, Gus played the fiddle or the tuba; the fiddle is Zeke's, so Gus played the tuba and Marta the accordion.

The caption ran right the first time. Lena played the banjo on the tall ship, Gus the tuba on the lighthouse, Zeke the fiddle on the whale, and Marta the accordion on the lobster.

20 · The Swapped Room Keys

Vito: Puffin, Boston

Amara: Gull, Hartford

Kit: Tern, Albany

Hal: Heron, Portland

Key idea: Clues 3 and 5 together put the guest from Boston in the Puffin Room.

Clue 3 allows the Boston guest the Puffin or Heron Room; clue 5 rules out Heron, so that guest has the Puffin Room. Amara is not from Boston (clue 1), so by clue 2 she has the Gull Room, and Vito, from Boston, has the Puffin Room. Clue 4 then makes Kit the guest from Albany, and clue 1 leaves Amara only Hartford, so Hal is from Portland. By clue 5, the Heron guest is from Hartford or Portland. Amara, from Hartford, is in the Gull Room, so Hal has the Heron Room. That leaves Kit in the Tern Room.

Priya had every key in the right hand by suppertime. Vito from Boston took the Puffin Room, Amara from Hartford the Gull, Kit from Albany the Tern, and Hal from Portland the Heron.

21 · The Spring Bird Count

Mabel: oriole, orchard

Dev: loon, dunes

Tova: osprey, old pier

Ivan: heron, salt marsh

Key idea: Clue 2 keeps the osprey away from the dunes, so clue 1 puts the osprey at the old pier and Dev at the dunes.

By clue 2, the birder at the dunes saw the loon or the oriole, so the osprey was not seen from the dunes. Clue 1 then puts the osprey's spotter at the old pier and Dev at the dunes. In clue 3, Ivan cannot be at the dunes, which are Dev's, so Ivan was at the salt marsh and Dev saw the loon. Clue 2 then gives Mabel the oriole, so she was not at the osprey's old pier; she was in the orchard. Tova kept watch at the old pier and saw the osprey, and Ivan saw the heron at the salt marsh.

Mabel mailed a spotless report a day early. Her oriole was in the orchard, Dev's loon at the dunes, Tova's osprey at the old pier, and Ivan's heron in the salt marsh.

22 · The Lighthouse Paint Crew

Teddy: door, small brush

Jonah: shutters, sponge

Faye: railing, wide brush

Ruben: stairs, roller

Key idea: Clues 4 and 7 leave Jonah only the shutters, and that hands the wide brush to Faye.

Clue 4 gives Jonah the shutters or the railing, and clue 7 rules out the railing, so Jonah painted the shutters. The shutters did not get the wide brush (clue 5), so by clue 1 Faye used the wide brush. Clue 6 keeps the roller off the door, so by clue 3 the roller went on the stairs and the small brush on the door. Clue 5 leaves the shutters only the sponge, so Jonah used the sponge, and Faye's wide brush went on the railing. Faye had the railing, so by clue 2 Ruben painted the stairs with the roller, and Teddy the door with the small brush.

By sundown the lighthouse looked the part, and Lena's log was exact. Teddy's small brush did the door, Jonah's sponge the shutters, Faye's wide brush the railing, and Ruben's roller the stairs.

23 · The Ferry Lost-and-Found

Otis: novel, aft deck

Carmen: scarf, upper deck

Yusuf: sun hat, foredeck

Linus: thermos, lower deck

Key idea: Clue 2 gives the sun hat to Yusuf or Carmen, so Otis's two choices in clue 1 shrink to the novel.

Clue 1 gives Otis the novel or the sun hat, but clue 2 gives the sun hat to Yusuf or Carmen. So Otis left the novel. Then Yusuf left the sun hat (clue 1), so by clue 2 Carmen left the scarf, and Linus left the thermos. Otis left the novel, so clue 5 puts him on the lower deck or the aft deck; clue 4 leaves only the aft deck. So Carmen rode on the upper deck (clue 4), and Linus, kept off the foredeck by clue 3, rode on the lower deck. That leaves the foredeck for Yusuf and his sun hat.

Every item was tagged by the next run. Otis came back first for his novel, found on the aft deck, and Pilot, very pleased with himself, led him to the shelf.

24 · The Garden Tour Signs

Hattie: roses, gnome

Pearl: peonies, sundial

Gideon: lupines, birdbath

Enzo: irises, trellis

Key idea: Gideon has the birdbath and no irises, so by clue 3 the irises must go with the trellis.

Clue 4 rules out Gideon and Pearl for the roses, and clue 1 rules out Enzo, so Hattie grows the roses. Clue 5 gives Gideon the birdbath or the gnome, and clue 6 rules out the gnome, so Gideon has the birdbath. Clue 3 keeps the irises from the sundial and the gnome, and clue 2 from Gideon's birdbath, so the irises go with the trellis. Clue 3 also leaves the lupines only the birdbath, so Gideon grows lupines; then clue 1 gives Enzo the irises, and with them the trellis. Pearl grows the peonies, and clue 6 keeps the gnome from her, so she has the sundial; Hattie's roses go with the gnome.

The signs were back up with four minutes to spare: Hattie's roses and gnome, Gideon's lupines and birdbath, Pearl's peonies and sundial, Enzo's irises and trellis. Mabel corrected two of them anyway.

25 · Supper at the Clam Shack

Nico: crab cake, iced tea

Felix: fish tacos, lemonade

Bea: lobster roll, cider

Sam: fried clams, root beer

Key idea: The lemonade belongs with the lobster roll or the fish tacos (clue 5), so clue 2 pairs the crab cake with iced tea.

By clue 2, the crab cake's diner drank iced tea or lemonade; clue 5 rules out lemonade, so the crab cake came with iced tea. Then Felix drank the lemonade (clue 2), and Sam, who drank neither iced tea nor cider (clue 3), had the root beer. Clue 4 keeps Bea from the crab cake, and so from the iced tea. So Bea drank cider, and Nico had iced tea and the crab cake. The fried clams were not Bea's (clue 4), nor lemonade-drinking Felix's (clue 5), so Sam ordered them. Clue 1 puts the cider with the lobster roll or the fried clams, so Bea had the lobster roll, and Felix the fish tacos.

The cook got every plate to the right diner, from Nico's crab cake to Sam's fried clams. By dessert, the lobster in Nico's story had grown to the size of a fishing boat.

26 · The Grown-Up Spelling Bee

Wren: zucchini, acorn

Imani: kayak, wishbone

Oscar: rhythm, sea glass

Cyrus: pharaoh, lucky penny

Key idea: Clue 1 keeps rhythm away from the wishbone, so by clue 2 the rhythm speller clutched the sea glass.

By clue 1, the wishbone went with kayak or zucchini, so by clue 2 the rhythm speller clutched the sea glass. Clue 1 gives the acorn and the wishbone to kayak and zucchini, so pharaoh went with the last charm, the lucky penny. Clue 3 keeps the sea glass, and so rhythm, away from Wren, so by clue 4 Wren spelled zucchini. Clues 3 and 5 keep Wren from the sea glass and the wishbone, and the lucky penny went with pharaoh, so Wren had the acorn. By clues 3 and 5, Imani had the wishbone and Oscar the sea glass, leaving Cyrus the lucky penny. So Oscar spelled rhythm, Imani kayak, Cyrus pharaoh.

With the sheet rebuilt, Mabel found that all four had spelled their words perfectly, pharaoh included. She declared a four-way tie, and Wren whispered that her acorn deserved the credit.

27 · The Graduation Cakes

Tariq: chocolate, owl

Gus: carrot, diploma

Jade: lemon, star

Elsa: coconut, mortarboard

Key idea: Clues 1 and 4 together leave the carrot cake only the diploma topper.

Clue 1 rules out the mortarboard and owl for the carrot cake, and clue 4 the star, so the carrot cake had the diploma. By clue 2, the carrot and coconut cakes went to Elsa and Gus, so by clue 3 Jade ordered lemon, which leaves Tariq the chocolate. Clues 5 and 6 rule out the mortarboard and star for Tariq, and the diploma was on the carrot cake, so Tariq chose the owl. Tariq's chocolate cake had the owl, so by clue 4 the star went on Jade's lemon cake. Clue 5 keeps the mortarboard from Gus, so Gus chose the diploma and the carrot cake, and Elsa the mortarboard and coconut.

Rosa wrote the names on the boxes this time. Tariq took chocolate with an owl, Gus carrot with a diploma, Jade lemon with a star, and Elsa coconut with a mortarboard.

28 · The Tide Pool Walk

Lena: urchin, Moon Pool

Marta: snail, Mermaid Pool

Hugo: sea star, Kettle Pool

Zeke: crab, Bathtub Pool

Key idea: Clues 1 and 2 put the snail in Mermaid Pool, and the rest of the creatures and pools follow.

Clue 2 puts the snail in Mermaid Pool or Moon Pool, and clue 1 rules out Moon Pool, so the snail came from Mermaid Pool. Clues 1 and 3 then send the crab to Bathtub Pool, the urchin to Moon Pool, and the sea star to Kettle Pool. Clue 4 keeps Lena and Hugo out of Bathtub Pool and clue 5 keeps Marta from the crab, so the crab was Zeke's. Zeke had Bathtub Pool, so by clue 6 Hugo explored Kettle Pool and found the sea star. So by clue 5 Marta found the snail in Mermaid Pool, leaving Lena the urchin in Moon Pool.

Before the tide turned, every creature was home again. Zeke's crab went back to Bathtub Pool, Hugo's sea star to Kettle Pool, Marta's snail to Mermaid Pool, and Lena's urchin to Moon Pool.

29 · The Water Day Photos

Priya: swim, trophy

Vera: rowing, pie

Kenji: kayak, ribbon

Della: sailboard, medal

Key idea: Clue 3 keeps Kenji from the trophy, so clue 1 hands it to Priya. By clue 3, Kenji took home the ribbon or the pie, so by clue 1 Priya won the trophy. Clue 2 keeps Vera from the medal and clue 3 keeps Kenji from it, so the medal went to Della. Clue 2 gives Della the sailboard or rowing race. Clue 3 gives the rowing winner the ribbon or pie, so Della won the sailboard race. Clue 2 gives Vera the rowing race. Clue 4 keeps Kenji from the swim race, so Kenji won the kayak race and Priya the swim. By clue 3, Kenji took the ribbon or pie, and clue 4 rules out the pie, so Kenji took the ribbon and Vera the pie.

The Gazette went to press on time, captions and all: Priya's swim trophy, Kenji's kayak ribbon, Della's sailboard medal, and Vera's rowing-race pie, which she shared with the newsroom.

30 · The Borrowed Oars

Felix: spruce, Skipjack

Otis: ash, Minnow

Walt: blue-tipped, Pebble

Amara: varnished, Teacup

Key idea: Clues 3 and 4 leave the Skipjack only the spruce oars, and clues 5 and 6 make those Felix's.

Clue 3 rules out the varnished and ash oars for the Skipjack, and clue 4 the blue-tipped, so the Skipjack's rower used the spruce oars. Clue 2 keeps Otis and Walt off the Skipjack and Teacup, so by clue 1 Otis rowed the Minnow, and Walt the Pebble. The Minnow's oars were not blue-tipped (clue 4), varnished (clue 5) or spruce (the Skipjack's), so Otis used the ash oars. By clues 5 and 6, Felix used the spruce oars and Amara the varnished, so Felix rowed the Skipjack. By clue 2, Amara rowed the Teacup, and Walt used the blue-tipped oars on the Pebble.

Felix rowed the Skipjack with spruce, Otis the Minnow with ash, Walt the Pebble with blue-tipped oars, and Amara the Teacup with varnished. Who moved Felix's own dinghy stayed a puzzle.

31 · The Creamery Line

Rosa: third

Ivan: fourth

Faye: second

Kit: first

Answer: Faye dropped the five-dollar bill. Key idea: In a line of four, only first and fourth are three places apart, so clue 1 puts Kit first and Ivan fourth.

Clue 2 says the third customer was Ivan or Rosa, so neither Faye nor Kit stood third. By clue 1, Kit stood exactly three places ahead of Ivan. In a line of four, only first and fourth are three places apart. So Kit was first in line and Ivan was fourth. By clue 2, the third customer was Ivan or Rosa. Ivan was fourth, so Rosa was third. Faye was left with second place, right where the bill was found. The five dollars were Faye's.

The five had slipped from Faye's pocket while she dug out coins for a double scoop. Ada returned it the next morning, and Faye bought the scooper a lemonade in thanks.

32 · The Fourth of July Parade

Hattie: first
Selma: second

Nico: fourth
Arlo: third

Key idea: Clue 1 needs room behind Hattie, so of clue 2's two ends she took the front, and Arlo rode third.

By clue 2, Hattie rode on the first float or the fourth. By clue 1, Arlo rode two floats behind Hattie, and no float came behind the fourth, so Hattie rode on the first float. Then by clue 1, Arlo rode on the third float. By clue 3, Selma rode right in front of Arlo, so Selma rode on the second float. That leaves the fourth float, at the very back, for Nico and his lobster.

The correction box ran on Monday: Hattie first, then Selma, Arlo and Nico. Nico's lobster brought up the rear, and by Tuesday it was the size of two canoes.

33 · The Twice-Punched Ticket

Otis: third
Yusuf: second

Lou: fourth
Greta: first

Answer: Otis's ticket was punched twice. Key idea: Yusuf needs two turns before Lou, so clue 2 leaves Lou only the last turn, and Yusuf boarded second.

By clue 2, Lou boarded either first or last. By clue 1, Yusuf boarded two turns before Lou. Nobody boarded before the first passenger, so Lou boarded fourth. Then by clue 1, Yusuf boarded second. By clue 3, Otis boarded after Yusuf. Third is the only later turn still open, so Otis boarded third. Greta boarded first, and the twice-punched third ticket belonged to Otis.

Jonah apologized to Otis at the gangway on the way home. Otis said two holes just meant twice the ride, and whistled a shanty about it, slightly off-key.

34 · The Sandcastle Row

Teddy: third

Enzo: fourth

Mabel: first

Carmen: second

Key idea: Clues 1 and 3 leave Mabel the first or second castle, and clue 2 rules out the second, so Mabel built the first.

Clue 1 keeps Teddy off the fourth castle, so by clue 3 Mabel, closer to the pier, built the first or second. If Mabel built the second, Teddy would have to build the third, right beside her. Clue 2 forbids that, so Mabel built the first. Clue 2 keeps Teddy off the second castle, beside Mabel's, and clue 1 keeps him off the fourth, so Teddy built the third. By clue 4, Enzo built the third or fourth castle. The third is Teddy's, so Enzo built the fourth and Carmen the second.

From the pier outward, the castles were Mabel's, Carmen's, Teddy's and Enzo's. The tide took all four by supper, but Teddy had his photos, and Mabel's sign floated off with its commas intact.

35 · The Last Ear of Corn

Priya: second

Dot: first

Vera: fifth

Felix: fourth

Hugo: third

Answer: Vera got the last ear of corn. Key idea: Felix stood behind Hugo, who was third or fourth (clues 3 and 4), yet ahead of Vera (clue 1), so Felix was fourth.

By clue 3, Hugo was third or fourth. By clue 4, Felix stood somewhere behind him, so Felix was fourth or fifth. By clue 1, Vera stood behind Felix, so Felix was not fifth. Felix was fourth. Hugo stood ahead of Felix (clue 4), so Hugo was third. By clue 2, Priya was second or third. Third is Hugo's, so Priya was second. Vera, behind Felix, was fifth and got the last ear of corn. That leaves Dot first.

Vera, at the back of the line, got the last ear of corn and declared it the sweetest of the batch. Felix called the whole arrangement shipshape and went looking for more butter.

36 · The Fireworks Blankets

Lena: first

Tova: second

Pablo: fourth

Gus: third

Amara: fifth

Key idea: Clue 2 leaves Pablo the fourth or fifth blanket, and clue 1 needs room for Amara on his right, so Pablo sat fourth.

By clue 2, Pablo sat exactly three blankets right of Lena, so Pablo was fourth or fifth. By clue 1, Amara sat somewhere to Pablo's right, so Pablo was not fifth. He sat fourth, and Lena sat first. Amara, to the right of Pablo, sat on the fifth blanket. By clue 3, Tova sat three blankets left of Amara, on the second blanket. Gus took the third blanket, right in the middle.

The caption ran Lena, Tova, Gus, Pablo and Amara, left to right. Gus, in the middle, told anyone who would listen that his knee had called the clear sky.

37 · The Book Sale Early Birds

Oscar: third

Jonah: second

Milo: fifth

Nadia: fourth

Elsa: first

Answer: Elsa gets first pick of the rare books. Key idea: Clues 4 and 6 keep Oscar off both ends, and clues 1 and 3 rule out second and fourth, so Oscar was third.

Clue 4 puts Elsa ahead of Oscar and clue 6 puts Nadia behind him, so Oscar was neither first nor fifth. Clue 1 rules out second for Oscar, and clue 3 rules out fourth, so Oscar held the third spot. By clue 4, Elsa held first or second. Milo cannot hold either one: one is Elsa's, the other is next to her (clue 5). Clue 3 keeps Milo off fourth, so Milo was fifth, and Nadia, behind Oscar by clue 6, was fourth. Jonah was not first (clue 2), so he was second, and Elsa was first in line.

Elsa had been on the steps since seven, so first pick of the rare books was hers: a 1902 tide almanac. The other four agreed, after some firm whispering from Wren.

38 · The Committee Photo

Otis: second

Jonah: third

Gus: first

Hattie: fourth

Lena: fifth

Key idea: Clues 1 to 4 keep everyone but Gus off the far left, so Gus was first, and Otis, by clue 2, second.

Clue 4 keeps Hattie off the first spot. Otis, Jonah and Lena each stood right of someone (clues 2, 1 and 3), so none was first. So Gus stood first, at the far left. By clue 2, Otis stood directly right of Gus, so Otis was second, and Hattie was fourth (clue 4). By clue 3, Lena stood to the right of Hattie, so Lena was fifth. That leaves the third spot for Jonah, right of Otis, just as clue 1 requires.

The caption read Gus, Otis, Jonah, Hattie and Lena, left to right. Teddy blamed the glance at the lantern room on a passing gull, and Ada tucked a print in her drawer.

39 · The Canoe-Sized Lobster

Cass: Dover, Monday

Hal: Tulsa, Tuesday

Imani: Reno, Thursday

Boris: Buffalo, Wednesday

Answer: Boris hauled up the canoe-sized lobster. Key idea: Only Monday and Thursday are three days apart, so clue 2 puts the Dover visitor on Monday and Imani on Thursday.

By clue 2, Imani went out exactly three days after the Dover visitor. Only Monday and Thursday are three days apart. So the Dover visitor went out on Monday, and Imani on Thursday. By clue 1, Cass and Boris took Monday and Wednesday, which leaves Tuesday for Hal. Clue 4 puts Boris on Tuesday or Wednesday, and clue 1 on Monday or Wednesday. So Boris went out on Wednesday, and Cass on Monday. Cass went out on Monday, so Cass is from Dover. By clue 4, the Tulsa visitor went out on Tuesday, so Hal is from Tulsa. By clue 3, Boris is not from Reno, so he is from Buffalo and Imani is from Reno. Boris, Wednesday's guest, hauled up the lobster.

Boris from Buffalo hauled up Wednesday's lobster, and by the time Nico told the tale at the bakery, the lobster was the size of a canoe. Boris's photo showed something nearer a loaf of bread.

40 · A Piano on the Ferry

Gus: piano, Thursday

Faye: beehive, Friday

Tariq: canoe, Wednesday

Una: armchair, Tuesday

Key idea: Clue 5 gives Thursday and Friday to Faye and the piano's sender, and clue 1 gives Thursday to Gus, so Gus sent the piano.

Clue 1 puts Gus on Thursday. By clue 5, Faye and the piano's sender shipped on Thursday and Friday. Gus has Thursday, so Faye shipped Friday and Gus sent the piano. That leaves Tuesday and Wednesday for Una and Tariq. By clue 4, Una shipped earlier, so Una shipped Tuesday and Tariq Wednesday. Friday's cargo was not the canoe (clue 6), the armchair (clue 3) or the piano, so Faye sent the beehive. By clue 2, Tariq sent the canoe or the beehive. The beehive is Faye's, so Tariq sent the canoe and Una the armchair.

Una's armchair crossed on Tuesday, Tariq's canoe on Wednesday, Gus's piano on Thursday and Faye's beehive on Friday. Jonah fixed his log, and Pilot greeted the bees from a polite distance.

41 · The Blueberry Picking Map

Mabel: hilltop, Thursday

Ruben: stone wall, Friday

Jade: north field, Wednesday

Vito: creekside, Saturday

Key idea: Clue 2 gives the hilltop and Wednesday to Jade and Mabel, so Ruben and Vito have neither, and the rest falls into place.

By clue 2, the hilltop and Wednesday belong to Jade and Mabel. So neither Ruben nor Vito worked the hilltop or picked on Wednesday. Clue 3 rules out Thursday and Friday for Vito, so Vito picked on Saturday. Clue 5 leaves Ruben only the stone wall. By clue 4, Mabel did not pick on Wednesday or Friday. Saturday is Vito's, so Mabel picked on Thursday. Ruben could not pick on Wednesday, so Ruben picked on Friday, and Jade on Wednesday. Jade was the Wednesday picker, so by clue 2, Mabel worked the hilltop. By clue 1, the north field was not picked on Saturday, so Vito worked the creekside and Jade the north field.

On Mabel's map, Jade's north field ripened first, on Wednesday, then Mabel's own hilltop, Ruben's stone wall and Vito's creekside. She checked the spelling on every label twice.

42 · Once Upon a Story Hour

Wren: fables, July 8

Kenji: fairy tale, July 15

Sam: pirate tale, July 29

Olive: poems, July 22

Key idea: Clue 2 leaves the last two dates to Olive and Sam, and clue 3 keeps Olive off July 29, so Olive read on July 22.

By clue 2, Wren and Kenji read on July 8 and July 15, so Olive and Sam read on July 22 and July 29. Clue 3 is a pair clue, so Olive is not the July 29 volunteer. Olive read on July 22, and Sam on July 29. By clue 3, Olive and Sam read the pirate tale and the poems. That leaves the fairy tale and the fables for Wren and Kenji. Kenji's book is the fairy tale or the fables, so by clue 1, Olive read the poems, and Sam the pirate tale. By clue 4, Wren did not read the fairy tale, so Wren read the fables and Kenji the fairy tale. By clue 4, Kenji read later than Wren, so Wren read on July 8 and Kenji on July 15.

Wren whispered fables on July 8, Kenji read a fairy tale on July 15, Olive recited poems on July 22, and Sam ended the month with a pirate tale.

43 · A Flicker After Closing

Teddy: odd flicker, Friday
Priya: wet paint, Thursday

Della: stuck latch, Sunday
Arlo: gull nest, Saturday

Answer: Teddy noticed the odd flicker on Friday night. **Key idea:**

Clues 1 and 5 put the wet paint on Thursday, and then clue 2's two-night gap fixes the odd flicker on Friday.

Clue 1 keeps the wet paint off Sunday, so by clue 5 the wet paint note was written on Thursday. The odd flicker was not Thursday's note, and clue 1 keeps it off Sunday, so it was Friday's or Saturday's. Clue 2 puts the latch two nights after the flicker, and a Saturday flicker would need Monday. So the flicker was Friday, the latch Sunday, the gull nest Saturday. By clue 7, neither Teddy nor Arlo locked up Sunday, and by clue 3 Priya did not note the latch. So Della locked up Sunday. By clue 6, Priya locked up on Thursday, so the wet paint note was hers. By clue 4, Arlo did not note the flicker, so he noted the gull nest on Saturday. Teddy saw the odd flicker on Friday.

Teddy had locked up on Friday and seen the flicker from the causeway, too quick for his camera. Lena underlined his note twice and kept the log in her desk.

44 · Mostly Shipshape

Walt: Tern, 11 a.m.
Emil: Ripple, noon

Carmen: Bluebell, 10 a.m.
Pearl: Whelk, 9 a.m.

Key idea: Clues 1, 2 and 6 leave 9 a.m. to the Whelk, and clue 3 then pins the Bluebell to 10 a.m.

Clue 1 keeps the Ripple off 9 a.m., clue 2 the Tern, and clue 6 the Bluebell. So the Whelk went out at 9 a.m. By clue 3, Emil sailed after the Bluebell, so the Bluebell was not out at noon. By clue 6, it went out at 10 a.m. Clue 1 keeps the Tern off noon, so the Tern went out at 11 a.m. and the Ripple at noon. Neither Emil nor Pearl sailed the Bluebell (clue 5), and Walt's lesson

was not at 10 a.m. (clue 4). So Carmen sailed the Bluebell. By clue 2, Pearl sailed before the 11 a.m. Tern, and 10 a.m. was Carmen's. So Pearl took the Whelk at 9 a.m. By clue 4, Walt sailed the Tern at 11 a.m., which leaves Emil the Ripple at noon.

Felix wrote the certificates at last. Pearl had the Whelk at 9 a.m., Carmen the Bluebell at 10, Walt the Tern at 11, and Emil the Ripple at noon.

45 · Four Orders on the Back Shelf

Nico: rye loaf, 10 a.m.

Zeke: cinnamon bun, 9 a.m.

Lou: layer cake, 7 a.m.

Milo: baguettes, 8 a.m.

Key idea: Clues 3, 4 and 5 each rule out one customer for the baguettes, so they were Milo's, and he came between Lou and Zeke.

Clue 3 rules out Lou for the baguettes, clue 4 rules out Zeke, and clue 5 rules out Nico. So Milo ordered the baguettes. By clues 3 and 4, Lou came in before Milo, and Milo before Zeke. Clue 1 keeps Zeke off 10 a.m., so Zeke came at 9 a.m., Milo at 8 a.m. and Lou at 7 a.m. Nico came at 10 a.m. By clue 1, Zeke and Nico had the rye loaf and the cinnamon bun between them, so Lou had the layer cake. Lou had the layer cake at 7 a.m., so by clue 2 the 10 a.m. customer, Nico, took the rye loaf. Zeke took the cinnamon bun.

Rosa's book read Lou, Milo, Zeke and Nico, from 7 to 10 a.m. Zeke carried the plate-sized cinnamon bun out with both hands, and Nico swore it was bigger than his boat.

46 · Last Call for Pickles

Hugo: quilt, 4 p.m.

Selma: honey, 3 p.m.

Dev: pickles, 2 p.m.

Otis: zucchini, 1 p.m.

Key idea: Clue 4's two-hour gap and clue 3 leave Dev only 2 p.m., so the quilt came in at 4 p.m.

By clue 4, the quilt came two hours after Dev, so Dev arrived at 1 p.m. or 2 p.m. Clue 3 rules out 1 p.m. So Dev arrived at 2 p.m. and the quilt at 4 p.m. By clue 3, the zucchini came earlier than Dev, at 1 p.m. Clue 1 gives the 4 p.m. quilt to Otis or Hugo, so Selma came at 1 p.m. or 3 p.m. Clue 5

rules out 1 p.m. So Selma came at 3 p.m. By clue 5, the pickles came earlier, so they were Dev's at 2 p.m., and Selma brought the honey. Clue 2 keeps Hugo off the 1 p.m. zucchini, so Hugo brought the quilt at 4 p.m., and Otis the zucchini at 1 p.m.

The clerk wrote out a dry new sheet: Otis's zucchini at 1 p.m., Dev's pickles at 2, Selma's honey at 3, and Hugo's quilt at 4. The lemonade was not entered.

47 · Who Ate the Last Scone?

Suspect tested	T.	B.	G.	True	Fits?
If Teddy did it	F	F	T	1	no
If Bea did it	F	T	F	1	no
If Gus did it	T	T	F	2	yes

Answer: Gus ate the last scone. Key idea: Bea and Gus contradict each other, so one of them is the lone liar, and truthful Teddy names Gus. The rule says only the culprit lies. So exactly one statement is false, and it is the culprit's. Bea says Teddy didn't eat the scone, and Gus says he did. They are opposites, so exactly one of them is false. So the lone liar, the culprit, is Bea or Gus. Teddy is telling the truth, and Teddy says Gus ate the scone. Check Gus: Teddy's statement is true, Bea's is true because Teddy is innocent, and Gus's own is false. Only the culprit lies. The others fail: if Bea did it, her own statement would be true; if Teddy did it, both Teddy and Bea would be lying.

Gus had popped in with his store's ad, decided an unattended scone was fair game, and ate it in three bites. He brought Ada two from Rosa's the next morning and apologized to Teddy.

48 · Who Let the Goat Out?

Suspect tested	N.	F.	L.	True	Fits?
If Nico did it	T	T	F	2	yes
If Faye did it	T	T	T	3	no
If Linus did it	F	F	T	1	no

Answer: Nico left the goat pen open. Key idea: Faye's statement says the same as Nico's, that Linus didn't do it, so the one false statement must be Linus's.

Exactly two of the three statements are true, so exactly one is false. Faye says Nico or Faye did it. With only three suspects, that means Linus didn't, which is exactly what Nico says. So Nico's and Faye's statements are true together or false together. Both false would make two false statements, so both are true. That leaves Linus's statement as the false one. Linus says Nico didn't leave the pen open, so Nico did. Check Nico: two true statements and one false, as the rule says. Testing Faye gives three true, and testing Linus only one.

Nico, in the middle of a long story, had let himself into the pen to scratch Clementine's ears and left the latch undone. He paid for both pies, though he still swore it was twelve.

49 · Who Tasted the Pie Early?

Suspect tested	H.	M.	K.	True	Fits?
If Hal did it	F	T	T	2	yes
If Mabel did it	T	T	F	2	no
If Kit did it	T	F	T	2	no

Answer: Hal cut the contest pie. Key idea: The culprit must be the liar, but Mabel's and Kit's statements would each be true if they had cut the pie.

The rule says the culprit lies and everyone else tells the truth. So the culprit's own statement must be false. Test Mabel. Her statement, that Kit didn't cut the pie, would be true. A truthful culprit breaks the rule, so it wasn't Mabel. Test Kit. Kit's statement, that Hal or Kit cut the pie, would be true. So it wasn't Kit either. Test Hal. Hal's statement, that Mabel or Kit cut the pie, would be false. Mabel's and Kit's statements would both be true. Only the culprit lies, exactly as the rule says. So Hal cut the contest pie.

Hal had mistaken the contest pie for the helpers' sampler pie and cut himself a neat slice. He confessed, pink to the ears, and the baker took it as a compliment.

50 · Who Sounded the Ferry Horn?

Suspect tested	O.	J.	V.	True	Fits?
If Otis did it	T	F	T	2	no
If Jade did it	F	T	F	1	yes
If Vito did it	T	T	F	2	no

Answer: Jade sounded the ferry horn. Key idea: Jade's and Vito's statements are opposites about Otis, so they use up the one true statement, and Otis's must be false.

With three suspects, Jade's "Vito or I" means Otis didn't sound the horn, and Vito's "neither Jade nor I" means Otis did. So Jade and Vito say opposite things, and exactly one of them is telling the truth. The rule allows exactly one true statement, and that pair uses it up. So Otis's statement is false. Otis says Vito or Otis sounded the horn. That is false, so neither did, and Jade sounded the horn. Check Jade: only Jade's own statement is true, so Jade fits. Testing Otis or Vito gives two true statements each.

Jade, the ferry's relief deckhand, had come aboard for her forgotten thermos and leaned on the horn button in the dark. She apologized to Jonah, and to Pilot, before the 7:30 sailing.

51 · Who Swapped the Quilt Ribbons?

Suspect tested	H.	W.	C.	E.	True	Fits?
If Hattie did it	F	T	F	T	2	no
If Wren did it	F	T	T	T	3	yes
If Cyrus did it	T	F	F	T	2	no
If Elsa did it	F	F	F	F	0	no

Answer: Wren swapped the quilt ribbons. Key idea: Hattie and Cyrus accuse different people, so the only false statement is one of theirs, and Wren's must be true.

Exactly three of the four statements are true, so exactly one is false. Hattie accuses Cyrus, and Cyrus accuses Wren. Only one person did it, so these two cannot both be true. So the one false statement is Hattie's or Cyrus's, and Wren's and Elsa's statements are both true. Wren's true statement says Hattie or Wren swapped the ribbons. So Cyrus didn't, and Hattie's statement is the false one. That makes Cyrus's statement true, so Wren swapped the ribbons. Check: only Hattie's statement is false, leaving exactly three true. The others fail: testing Hattie or Cyrus gives two true statements, and testing Elsa gives none.

A draft from the door had blown both ribbons to the floor, and Wren pinned them back on the wrong quilts. Hattie added "check ribbon pins" to a fresh list.

52 · Who Hid the Gavel?

Suspect tested	P.	G.	U.	R.	True	Fits?
If Priya did it	T	F	T	F	2	no
If Gideon did it	F	T	T	F	2	no
If Una did it	T	T	F	T	3	yes
If Ruben did it	F	F	T	F	1	no

Answer: Una hid the gavel. Key idea: Una and Ruben say opposite things about Una, so one of them is the lone liar, and Priya and Gideon tell the truth.

The rule says only the culprit lies, so exactly one statement is false, and it is the culprit's. Una says she didn't hide the gavel, and Ruben says she did. These are opposites, so exactly one of them is false. So the liar is Una or Ruben, and Priya's and Gideon's statements are both true. Priya's true statement says Una or Priya hid the gavel. Gideon's true statement rules out Priya. So Una hid it. Check Una: her own statement is false, and Priya's, Gideon's and Ruben's are true. Only the culprit lies, so Una fits.

Una had hidden the gavel under the agendas as a joke on the moderator, who bangs it rather hard. She handed it back, and the meeting started twenty minutes late.

53 · Who Took the Postcards?

Suspect tested	F.	T.	M.	S.	True	Fits?
If Felix did it	T	F	T	T	3	yes
If Teddy did it	T	F	F	T	2	no
If Marta did it	F	T	F	T	2	no
If Sam did it	T	F	T	F	2	no

Answer: Felix took the postcards. Key idea: Felix and Teddy contradict each other, so only one of them is truthful, and the other two true statements must be Marta's and Sam's.

Felix says Marta didn't take the postcards, and Teddy says she did. They are opposites, so exactly one of them is telling the truth. The rule needs three true statements, so the other two, Marta's and Sam's, must both be true. Sam's statement clears Sam. Marta's statement clears Marta and Teddy. That leaves Felix. Check Felix: Felix's, Marta's and Sam's statements are true, and only Teddy's is false. That is exactly three, so Felix fits. Test Teddy, Marta or Sam instead, and each one gives only two true statements.

Felix had scooped up the whole stack, sure they were free, to hand out with every rowboat rental. He brought the stack back, bought fifty for his rental customers, and called the deal shipshape.

54 · Who Borrowed the Berry Rake?

Suspect tested	D.	R.	E.	Q.	True	Fits?
If Dot did it	F	F	T	F	1	no
If Rosa did it	T	T	F	F	2	yes
If Enzo did it	T	F	T	T	3	no
If Quinn did it	T	T	T	F	3	no

Answer: Rosa borrowed the berry rake. Key idea: If Enzo or Quinn did it, three statements come true, so only Dot and Rosa are left to test, and Rosa gives exactly two.

Dot's statement is true unless Dot did it, and Enzo's is true unless Rosa did it. If Enzo did it, Dot's, Enzo's and Quinn's statements are true. That is three, so it was not Enzo. If Quinn did it, Dot's, Rosa's and Enzo's statements are true. Three again, so it was not Quinn. If Dot did it, only Enzo's statement is true. One is too few. If Rosa did it, Dot's and Rosa's statements are true, and Enzo's and Quinn's are false. Exactly two, so Rosa borrowed the rake.

Rosa had borrowed the rake at dawn to pick berries for her festival muffins, meaning to hang it back before anyone noticed. She returned it at a quarter to ten, with a dozen muffins.

55 · Who Unplugged the Ferris Wheel?

Suspect tested	N.	L.	I.	O.	True	Fits?
If Nadia did it	F	F	T	F	1	no
If Lena did it	F	F	T	F	1	no
If Ivan did it	F	T	F	T	2	yes
If Oscar did it	T	T	F	T	3	no

Answer: Ivan unplugged the lights. Key idea: Ivan contradicts Lena and Oscar contradicts Ivan, so Lena and Oscar stand or fall together, and they must be the two truthful ones.

Ivan says Lena is lying, so Ivan's and Lena's statements are opposites. Oscar says Ivan is lying, so Oscar's statement matches Lena's. If Lena and Oscar both fibbed, Ivan's would be the only true one of the three, so Nadia's would have to be true. Then Oscar did it, so neither Nadia nor Lena did, and Lena's statement would be true after all. That cannot be. So Lena and Oscar tell the truth, and Ivan fibs. That makes two true statements, so Nadia fibs too. Lena's statement clears Nadia and Lena, and Nadia's fib clears Oscar. So Ivan unplugged the lights.

Ivan had pulled the plug to run his cotton candy machine, sure that plug belonged to the pony ride, which had closed. Gus came down with a sunny forecast and a free pink cone.

56 · Who Salted the Lemonade?

Suspect tested	A.	H.	D.	P.	Y.	True	Fits?
If Arlo did it	F	T	T	T	T	4	yes
If Hattie did it	F	F	T	F	F	1	no
If Della did it	T	T	T	F	F	3	no
If Pablo did it	F	T	T	T	T	4	no
If Yusuf did it	F	T	F	F	F	1	no

Answer: Arlo salted the lemonade. Key idea: Pablo vouches for Yusuf, so they stand or fall together; with only one fibber allowed, both are truthful, and Yusuf's statement points to Arlo.

The rule says only the culprit fibs, so exactly one statement is false, and it belongs to the culprit. Pablo says Yusuf is telling the truth, so Pablo's and Yusuf's statements are both true or both false. Both false would mean two fibbers. So both are true, and neither Pablo nor Yusuf is the culprit. Yusuf says Arlo or Pablo salted the lemonade. It was not Pablo, so it was Arlo. Check Arlo: his statement blaming Della is false, and the other four are true. Only the culprit fibs, so Arlo fits.

Arlo had reached for the left-hand tin, where the sugar sits in his own kitchen. Hattie mixed a fresh pitcher and added one line to her clipboard: label the tins.

57 · Who Fed the Gulls?

Suspect tested	C.	O.	I.	B.	Z.	True	Fits?
If Carmen did it	T	F	T	T	T	4	yes
If Otis did it	T	F	T	F	F	2	no
If Imani did it	T	T	T	F	F	3	no
If Basil did it	F	F	F	T	T	2	no
If Zeke did it	T	T	T	T	T	5	no

Answer: Carmen fed the gulls. Key idea: Imani backs Carmen and Zeke backs Basil, so a false statement among those four would come in a pair; the single false one is Otis's.

Exactly four true statements means exactly one is false. Imani says Carmen is truthful, so their statements are both true or both false. Zeke and Basil are tied the same way. A false statement from any of those four would bring a second with it. So Otis's statement is the only false one. Otis is wrong, so neither Imani nor Zeke fed the gulls. Basil is right, so neither Otis nor Imani did. Carmen is right, so Basil did not. That leaves

Carmen herself. Check Carmen: every statement but Otis's is true, which makes exactly four. So Carmen fits.

Carmen had tossed her stale popcorn off the pier for the fish, she said. The gulls got there first, and she spent the rest of the cook-off shooing them from the tasting tables.

58 · Who Gave the Trophy a Mustache?

Suspect tested	V.	G.	F.	P.	L.	True	Fits?
If Vera did it	T	T	F	T	T	4	no
If Gideon did it	F	F	T	F	F	1	yes
If Felix did it	T	T	F	T	T	4	no
If Priya did it	F	F	T	T	F	2	no
If Lou did it	T	T	T	T	T	5	no

Answer: Gideon drew the mustache on the trophy. Key idea: Gideon backs Vera and Vera backs Lou, so those three stand or fall together; with only one true statement allowed, all three are false.

Vera says Lou is truthful, and Gideon says Vera is truthful. So Gideon's, Vera's and Lou's statements are all true or all false. All true would give three true statements, but the rule allows only one. So all three are false. Lou's statement is false, so Gideon or Priya drew the mustache. Either way, neither Vera nor Felix did it, so Felix's statement is true. It must be the only true one. So Priya's statement is false, and Gideon drew the mustache. Check Gideon: only Felix's statement is true, which is exactly one. So Gideon fits.

Gideon had been testing a grease pencil for the prize labels and could not resist. He offered to wipe it off, but the committee voted to keep the mustache through the awards.

59 · Apples by the Pound

Pablo: Cortland, 10 pounds

Mabel: Macoun, 25 pounds

Kit: Baldwin, 15 pounds

Sam: Empire, 20 pounds

Key idea: Clues 1 and 3 together leave Pablo only the Cortland apples, and clue 1's 15-pound gap puts him at 10 pounds.

Clue 3 rules out Baldwin and Empire for Pablo, and clue 1 keeps him off Macoun. So Pablo picked the Cortland apples. Clue 1's 15-pound gap fits only 10 and 25 pounds. So Pablo's Cortland apples weighed 10 pounds, and the Macoun apples 25. Clue 4 keeps the Baldwin apples off 20 and 25 pounds, and 10 is taken, so they weighed 15. The Empire apples weighed 20. Pablo picked 10 pounds, so by clue 2 Sam picked 20. Clue 5 then leaves Mabel only 25 pounds, and Kit picked 15. Match the weights: Mabel picked the Macoun apples, Kit the Baldwin apples, and Sam the Empire apples.

The stand rang up Pablo's 10 pounds of Cortland, Kit's 15 of Baldwin, Sam's 20 of Empire and Mabel's 25 of Macoun. Mabel paid once the sign read "Fresh Apples."

60 · The Elm Street Yard Sale

Linus: records, \$8

Vera: lamp, \$4

Gus: teapot, \$2

Dot: birdcage, \$6

Key idea: Clue 3 leaves Dot and Gus with \$2 and \$6, and clue 1 says Dot made more, so Dot made \$6.

Clue 3 gives \$4 and \$8 to Vera and Linus. So Dot and Gus made \$2 and \$6, and by clue 1, Dot made \$6. So Gus made \$2. Clue 4 gives \$8 and \$2 to the teapot and the records, and clue 2 keeps the teapot off \$8. So the teapot sold for \$2 and was Gus's, and the records sold for \$8. The lamp and the birdcage sold for \$4 and \$6. Dot made \$6, and clue 5 keeps her off the lamp. So Dot sold the birdcage for \$6, and the lamp went for \$4. Clue 3 makes the \$4 lamp Vera's or Linus's, and clue 5 rules out Linus. So Vera sold the lamp, and Linus the \$8 records.

The cash box held \$20: Linus's records brought \$8, Dot's birdcage \$6, Vera's lamp \$4 and Gus's teapot \$2. The rain arrived on time, just as Gus's knee had said.

61 · The Smudged Class Roll

Felix: Spanish, 50

Jade: pottery, 45

Hugo: guitar, 55

Una: watercolor, 40

Key idea: Clues 1, 2 and 3 chain into one line, Una, Jade, Felix, Hugo, which fixes every age at once.

By clue 3, Una is younger than Jade. By clue 1, Jade is younger than Felix, and by clue 2, Felix is younger than Hugo. That is a chain of four, so Una is 40, Jade 45, Felix 50 and Hugo 55. Clue 4 needs a 15-year gap, which fits only 40 and 55. So the watercolor student is 40, and the guitar student is 55. So Una takes watercolor, and Hugo takes guitar. By clue 5, Jade is not taking Spanish, so Jade takes pottery, and Felix takes Spanish.

Mabel recopied the roll in ink: Una, 40, watercolor; Jade, 45, pottery; Felix, 50, Spanish; Hugo, 55, guitar. Felix offered her a pencil. She declined.

62 · The Fishing Derby Trophy

Elsa: flounder, 16 inches

Nico: bluefish, 18 inches

Oscar: scup, 14 inches

Cyrus: mackerel, 12 inches

Answer: Nico won the derby trophy with his 18-inch bluefish. **Key**

idea: Clues 2 and 5 together leave the bluefish only 18 inches, the longest fish in the derby.

Clue 2 gives the bluefish 16 or 18 inches, and clue 5 rules out 16. So the bluefish was 18 inches. By clue 4, Elsa did not land the bluefish, so her fish was shorter than 18 inches. By clues 3 and 6, Cyrus's fish was shorter than Oscar's, and Oscar's than Elsa's. So Cyrus had 12 inches, Oscar 14, Elsa 16. That leaves 18 inches for Nico, so Nico landed the bluefish and wins the trophy. Clue 1 keeps Oscar off the mackerel, and clue 4 keeps Elsa off it. So Cyrus landed the mackerel. By clue 5, the 16-inch fish was the mackerel or the flounder, so Elsa's was the flounder. Oscar landed the scup.

Otis handed Nico the trophy for his 18-inch bluefish, ahead of Elsa's flounder, Oscar's scup and Cyrus's mackerel. By supper, in Nico's telling, the bluefish was three feet long.

63 · The Ferry Schedule Shuffle

Ruben: the mainland, 8:00 a.m. **Priya:** Cobb Point, 7:30 a.m.

Amara: Gull Island, 8:30 a.m. **Tova:** Pine Key, 7:00 a.m.

Key idea: Clue 1 leaves Gull Island 7:30 or 8:30 a.m., so Ruben sailed at 7:00 or 8:00 (clue 4), and clue 2 rules out 7:00.

By clue 2, Amara and Tova took the 7:00 and 8:30 a.m. ferries, so Ruben and Priya took 7:30 and 8:00 a.m. By clue 1, the Pine Key and mainland passengers took 7:00 and 8:00 a.m. So the Gull Island passenger sailed at 7:30 or 8:30 a.m. Clue 4 puts Ruben half an hour before Gull Island, at 7:00 or 8:00 a.m. So Ruben sailed at 8:00, and Priya at 7:30. Then the Gull Island passenger sailed at 8:30 a.m. (clue 4). By clue 1, the 7:30 passenger rode to Cobb Point, so Priya did. By clue 1, Ruben, at 8:00, rode to Pine Key or the mainland. Clue 3 leaves Tova only Pine Key, so Ruben's

was the mainland. Amara rode to Gull Island at 8:30 a.m. By clue 1, the Pine Key passenger sailed at 7:00 a.m., so Tova took the 7:00 a.m. ferry. *Jonah's log read Tova, Priya, Ruben and Amara, from 7:00 to 8:30 a.m., bound for Pine Key, Cobb Point, the mainland and Gull Island. The blinking light went into Ada's notebook, unexplained.*

64 · The Whispered Fines

Teddy: thriller, \$1.00

Basil: poetry, 75 cents

Marta: biography, 50 cents

Ivan: atlas, 25 cents

Key idea: Clue 2 keeps the biography fine off 25 cents, so by clue 5 the atlas fine was 25 cents and the biography fine 50.

By clue 2, the biography fine was a quarter more than the atlas fine, so it was not 25 cents. So by clue 5, the atlas fine was 25 cents, and by clue 2 the biography fine was 50 cents. By clue 4, the poetry fine was 75 cents, which leaves \$1.00 for the thriller. By clue 1, Marta paid 50 or 75 cents: the biography or the poetry. By clue 3, she paid for the atlas or the biography. So Marta paid 50 cents for the biography. By clue 3, Ivan paid 25 cents for the atlas. By clue 1, Basil paid 75 cents for the poetry, and Teddy paid \$1.00 for the thriller.

Ivan's atlas fine was a quarter, Marta's biography fine 50 cents, Basil's poetry 75 cents, and Teddy's thriller a full dollar. Wren whispered her thanks, then turned back to the logbook's puzzling checkout card.

65 · The Pumpkin Weigh-Off

Zeke: Duchess, fish meal, 300 pounds

Gus: Sunny, coffee, 400 pounds

Kenji: Big Mo, compost, 600 pounds

Mabel: Tubby, seaweed, 500 pounds

Key idea: Clue 7 gives Tubby and compost 500 and 600 pounds, and clue 5 keeps Tubby off 600, so compost weighed 600.

Clue 7 gives Tubby and the compost pumpkin 500 and 600 pounds. Clue 5 keeps Tubby off 600, so Tubby weighed 500 and compost 600. By clue 6, seaweed was not 300 pounds, and 600 is compost's. So seaweed

weighed 400 or 500, and Gus's lighter pumpkin 300 or 400. Gus could not use seaweed (clue 6), fish meal (clue 8) or the 600-pound compost. So Gus used coffee. The 600-pound grower was not Gus (clue 6), not Mabel (clue 8), and not Zeke, who used no compost (clue 1). So it was Kenji. Kenji used compost, so by clue 8 Zeke used fish meal, and Mabel used seaweed. Clue 9 keeps Gus off Big Mo, so by clue 2 his coffee pumpkin was Sunny. By clue 4, Mabel's seaweed pumpkin was Tubby. By clue 3, the 400-pound pumpkin was fed seaweed or coffee. Mabel's Tubby weighed 500, so Gus's Sunny weighed 400, and Zeke's 300. By clue 9, Big Mo was Kenji's, since Mabel grew Tubby. So Zeke grew Duchess.

Kenji's Big Mo took the blue ribbon at 600 pounds, fed on plain compost. Mabel's seaweed-fed Tubby came second, and she announced a rematch for next October.

66 · The Harvest Supper Arrivals

Rosa: cornbread, basket, 5:15 p.m.

Lou: baked beans, wagon, 5:00 p.m.

Selma: squash soup, box, 5:45 p.m.

Dev: apple crisp, tote bag, 5:30 p.m.

Key idea: Clue 2's 45-minute gap spans all the arrival times, so Lou came at 5:00 and the squash soup at 5:45.

Clue 2 puts exactly 45 minutes between Lou and the squash soup, from the first arrival to the last. So Lou came at 5:00 and the squash soup at 5:45. By clue 4, Rosa came before the apple crisp. Lou holds 5:00 and the soup holds 5:45, so Rosa came at 5:15 and the crisp at 5:30. Rosa did not bring the baked beans (clue 5), the apple crisp or the squash soup, so she brought the cornbread. That leaves the baked beans for Lou. Clue 3 keeps the basket from Lou, so not at 5:00. By clue 6, the basket came at 5:15, with Rosa, and the box at 5:45. By clue 1, the wagon came at 5:00 or 5:15. The basket has 5:15, so Lou had the wagon, and Dev came at 5:30. So Dev brought the apple crisp in the tote bag. Selma came last, at 5:45, with the squash soup in the box.

Lou's wagon of baked beans rolled in at five sharp, and Selma's squash soup came last, still hot in its box. Hattie's table plan was on her clipboard before the doors opened.

67 · The Corn Maze Chalkboard

Jonah: barn door, candy apple, 30 minutes

Faye: south gate, kettle corn, 35 minutes

Quinn: north gate, cider, 20 minutes

Hal: scarecrow, donut, 25 minutes

Key idea: Clues 7 and 9 put the donut at 25 minutes, and clue 6 then hands the kettle corn to the south gate.

By clue 7, the 25-minute friend picked the donut or the candy apple. Clue 9 rules out the candy apple, so 25 minutes went with the donut. By clue 6, the south gate friend did not take 25 minutes, so that friend picked the other snack of the pair: the kettle corn. By clue 3, the barn door took 20 or 30 minutes. Clue 1 says the scarecrow was faster, so not 20. The barn door took 30 minutes. The 25-minute donut friend did not use the barn door, the south gate, or the north gate (clue 5). So the scarecrow took 25 minutes. By clue 10, Quinn and Faye took 20 and 35 minutes. Clue 4 keeps Quinn off 35, so Quinn took 20 and Faye 35. By clue 8, Jonah took 30 minutes, so Hal took 25. So Jonah used the barn door, and Hal the scarecrow, with the donut. Quinn did not pick the kettle corn (clue 2), so Quinn did not use the south gate. Quinn used the north gate, and Faye the south gate. By clue 9, the candy apple took 30 or 35 minutes, and Faye's 35 had the kettle corn. So Jonah picked the candy apple, and Quinn the cider.

Quinn, in by the north gate, won in 20 minutes and toasted with cider, while Faye, last at 35, cheered up with kettle corn. Jonah, without his watch, guessed his 30 minutes exactly.

68 · The Sticky Auction Receipts

Otis: ship's clock, cherry, 1890

Della: mantel clock, walnut, 1880

Carmen: cuckoo clock, maple, 1900

Pablo: banjo clock, oak, 1910

Key idea: Clue 2 keeps Otis off 1880 and clue 6 keeps him off 1900 and 1910, so his clock is from 1890.

Clue 4's 30-year gap spans the whole range, so the oak clock is from 1910 and the walnut clock from 1880. Clue 2 keeps Otis off 1880, and clue 6 keeps him off 1900 and 1910. So Otis's clock is from 1890, and the banjo clock from 1910. Otis did not buy the mantel clock (clue 2), the cuckoo clock (clue 3) or the banjo clock (clue 6). So his is the ship's clock. The 1910 banjo clock is oak. By clue 2, the mantel clock is older than Otis's, so it is the 1880 walnut. The cuckoo clock is from 1900. By clue 7, maple is 10 years newer than cherry. Only 1890 and 1900 are left, so Otis's ship's clock is cherry and the cuckoo clock maple. By clue 1, Della's clock is from 1880: the walnut mantel clock. By clue 5, Carmen's clock is maple: the 1900 cuckoo clock. Pablo bought the 1910 oak banjo clock.

Pablo carried off the 1910 oak banjo clock, and Della the oldest, an 1880 walnut mantel clock. Otis hung his cherry ship's clock in the harbor office, where it ran two minutes fast.

69 · The Lobster Trap Tally

Arlo: pogies, purple, 50

Yusuf: herring, lime, 30

Greta: squid, orange, 40

Nico: redfish, white, 20

Key idea: Clue 5 keeps squid off 50 traps, so by clue 7 squid hauled 40 and pogies 50, and those 50 traps are Arlo's.

By clue 5, Arlo hauled more than the squid skipper, so squid was not 50 traps. Clue 7 then gives squid 40 and pogies 50. Arlo hauled more than squid's 40, so Arlo hauled 50 traps and baited with pogies. Clue 8 rules out white for pogies, clue 3 rules out orange at 50 traps, and clue 4 gives lime to herring. So Arlo had purple buoys. Clue 6 then gives Yusuf the 30

traps. By clue 2, Nico hauled fewer than Yusuf, so Nico hauled 20 and Greta 40. Squid hauled 40, so Greta baited with squid. Clue 1 rules out herring for Nico, so Nico used redfish and Yusuf herring. By clue 4, Yusuf had lime buoys. Clue 3 keeps orange off Nico's 20 traps, so Greta had orange and Nico white.

The co-op's tally sheet read Arlo 50, Greta 40, Yusuf 30 and Nico 20. Nico's count was the smallest, he admitted, but his lobster had reached the size of a rowboat.

70 · The Apple Pie Bake-Off

Priya: lattice, cardamom, 50 minutes

Vito: crumble, ginger, 45 minutes

Imani: braided, cinnamon, 40 minutes

Boris: plain, nutmeg, 55 minutes

Key idea: Clue 7 puts the lattice pie at 50 minutes, so clue 5's exact gap puts the ginger pie at 45.

Clue 7 puts the lattice pie at 50 minutes. By clue 5, the ginger pie baked 5 minutes less, so 45 minutes. By clue 1, the 55-minute pie had nutmeg or ginger. Ginger baked 45, so the 55-minute pie had nutmeg, and the crumble crust went with ginger. By clue 2, cardamom baked longer than ginger's 45, and 55 minutes was nutmeg's. So cardamom was the 50-minute lattice pie, and cinnamon baked 40. The crumble pie baked 45, so by clue 6 the 40-minute pie was braided, and Vito made the crumble. The plain crust baked 55 minutes. By clue 3, Imani baked under 50 minutes, and 45 was Vito's. So Imani made the braided cinnamon pie at 40 minutes. Clue 4 keeps Priya off the plain crust, so Priya made the lattice with cardamom, and Boris the plain crust with nutmeg.

Rosa copied all four secrets into her recipe box: Imani's braided cinnamon, Vito's crumble with ginger, Priya's lattice with cardamom, and Boris's plain nutmeg. The starters were not told.

71 · The Hiking Club Summits

Felix: Bramble Hill, cheese, 800 feet

Wren: Fiddler Hill, trail mix, 1,400 feet

Enzo: Thimble Knob, jerky, 1,200 feet

Cass: Crow's Nest, figs, 1,000 feet

Key idea: Clue 9 keeps Enzo off 1,400 feet, so clue 6 puts Wren at the top and Enzo at 1,200.

By clue 6, Wren and Enzo hold 1,400 and 1,200 feet. Clue 9 keeps Enzo off 1,400, so Enzo topped out at 1,200 and Wren at 1,400. Clue 1 rules out 1,000 and 1,200 feet for Felix, so Felix topped out at 800 feet and Cass at 1,000. Clue 3 puts the jerky above Cass's 1,000 feet, and clue 5 puts the trail mix 200 feet higher. So Enzo packed jerky and Wren trail mix. Clue 4 says neither Felix nor Enzo packed the figs, so Cass did, and Felix packed the cheese. By clue 7, the Fiddler Hill hiker topped out 400 feet above Cass's 1,000, at 1,400 feet. So Wren climbed Fiddler Hill. Clue 8 keeps Felix and Enzo off Crow's Nest, and Wren is on Fiddler Hill, so Cass climbed Crow's Nest. Clue 2 keeps Bramble Hill off 1,200 feet, so Felix climbed Bramble Hill and Enzo climbed Thimble Knob.

That evening the logbook got its names: Felix on Bramble Hill, Cass on Crow's Nest, Enzo on Thimble Knob and Wren on Fiddler Hill. Felix called it shipshape.

72 · The Gazette Ad Rates

Gus: rope, recipes, \$10

Lena: wavy, puzzles, \$30

Tariq: plain, tides, \$40

Olive: dotted, sports, \$20

Key idea: Clues 2 and 6 pin Olive at \$20 from both sides, which puts the recipes ad at \$10 and the tides ad at \$40.

By clue 2, Olive paid \$10 or \$20, and the tides ad cost \$30 or \$40. Clue 6 rules out \$10 for Olive. So Olive paid \$20, the recipes ad cost \$10 (clue 6), and the tides ad cost \$40 (clue 2). Clue 5 gives the tides ad a plain or dotted border, so by clue 1 the wavy border ran in puzzles, the plain in tides. The tides ad had the plain border, so by clue 5 the \$20 ad had the dotted one. That is Olive's. By clue 3, Tariq paid \$40, so he ran the plain-bordered ad in tides. At \$20 with a dotted border, Olive was not in recipes, tides or puzzles. So she took sports, and the puzzles ad cost \$30. Clue 4 keeps Gus off the wavy \$30 puzzles ad, so Lena placed it. Gus paid \$10 for a rope border in recipes.

Ada sent out corrected invoices: \$10 for Gus's rubber boots in recipes, \$20 for Olive in sports, \$30 for Lena's lamp notice in puzzles, and \$40 for Tariq in tides. Nobody paid twice.

73 · The Lamp Fund Jar

Lena: check, drawing, \$25

Jonah: cash, poem, \$100

Tova: money order, riddle, \$50

Gus: coin, thank-you, \$75

Key idea: Clues 1 and 2 keep Tova off \$25 and \$100, so the thank-you came with \$75 or \$100, and clue 6 gives \$50 the riddle.

Clue 1 gives the poem and the \$25 gift to Jonah and Lena. So Tova and Gus left no poem and did not give \$25. Clue 2 keeps Tova off \$100, so she gave \$50 or \$75. The thank-you, \$25 above her, came with \$75 or \$100. By clue 6, the \$50 gift came with the riddle. The \$25 gift, with no poem (clue 1), thank-you or riddle, came with the drawing. Tova left no poem, no thank-you (clue 2) and no drawing, so she left the riddle and gave \$50. The thank-you came with \$75. Gus left no poem and no \$25 drawing, so he left the thank-you and gave \$75. The poem came with

\$100. By clue 3, Lena did not give \$100, so by clue 1 she gave \$25 with the drawing. Jonah gave \$100 with the poem. By clue 3, Lena and Jonah paid by check and cash. Clue 5 keeps the check from the poem: Lena paid by check, Jonah cash. Clue 4 keeps Tova off coin, so she used the money order, and Gus paid in coin.

The Gazette thanked Lena for her \$25 check and drawing, Tova for \$50 and a riddle, Jonah for \$100 and a poem, and Gus for \$75 in coin and a thank-you.

74 · The Firewood Orders

Kit: maple, porch, 3 cords

Hattie: ash, barn, 4 cords

Ruben: oak, garage, 1 cord

Amara: birch, shed, 2 cords

Key idea: Clues 2, 4 and 5 keep the ash, maple and birch off 1 cord, so the oak was the smallest order.

Clue 2 keeps the ash off 1 cord, clue 4 the maple, and clue 5 the birch. So the oak was the 1-cord order. By clue 1, the 1-cord and 3-cord loads went by the garage and porch, so the shed and barn held 2 and 4 cords. Clue 6 keeps the shed off 4 cords, so the shed had 2 and the barn 4. By clue 6, the maple was 3 cords. Clue 2 keeps the ash off 2 cords, so the ash was 4, by the barn. The birch was 2, by the shed. Clues 2, 3 and 4 keep Amara, Hattie and Ruben off the 3-cord maple, so Kit chose the maple. By clue 2, Amara ordered 2 cords, two fewer than the 4-cord ash. So she had the birch, by the shed. Clue 4 keeps Ruben below Kit's 3 cords, so Ruben had the 1-cord oak, and Hattie the 4-cord ash by the barn. By clue 5, the garage load was smaller than the 2-cord birch, so Ruben stacked by the garage and Kit by the porch.

The bill for ten cords was right: Ruben's oak by the garage, Amara's birch by the shed, Kit's maple by the porch, Hattie's ash by the barn. The list turned up, clipped to another.

75 · The Harvest Shuttle Fares

Teddy: farm stand, cider jug, \$3

Basil: cider stand, pumpkin, \$5

Nadia: corn maze, mums, \$9

Zeke: orchard gate, apple crate, \$7

Key idea: Fares run from \$3 to \$9, so clue 2's exact \$6 gap means Teddy paid \$3 and the corn maze rider paid \$9.

Only \$3 and \$9 are exactly \$6 apart, so by clue 2 Teddy paid \$3 and the corn maze rider paid \$9. Clue 7 keeps the apple crate from Teddy, so by clue 3 Teddy carried the cider jug and the orchard gate rider the apple crate. Clues 5, 3 and 6 keep the pumpkin from the corn maze, orchard gate and farm stand, so it went to the cider stand. Teddy's \$3 and cider jug rule out the corn maze and the cider stand. Clue 3 rules out the orchard gate, so he rode to the farm stand. By clue 1, Basil paid \$5, two dollars more than Teddy's \$3. Clue 4 then gives Nadia \$9 and Zeke \$7. So Nadia rode to the corn maze. The apple crate, at the orchard gate, is off Basil's \$5 (clue 8), so Zeke had it. That leaves Basil at the cider stand with the pumpkin, and Nadia at the corn maze with the mums.

The fares came to \$24: Teddy \$3, Basil \$5, Zeke \$7 and Nadia \$9. The missing dollar turned up under a hay bale, and the can balanced before the next run.

76 · The Quilt Raffle

Emil: nine patch, guest room, 4 **Wren:** star, bedroom, 2
Jade: wedding ring, porch, 6 **Pablo:** log cabin, den, 8

Key idea: Clues 2 and 3 put the porch entrant at 6 or 8 tickets, and clue 6 puts Pablo higher, so the porch had 6.

Clue 2 keeps the nine patch quilt off 2 tickets. So by clue 3, the porch entrant bought 6 or 8 tickets. Clue 6 puts Pablo above the porch entrant, so the porch had 6 tickets and Pablo 8. By clue 5, the den entrant bought at least 6 tickets. The porch had 6, so the den had 8: Pablo's. The nine patch is off 2 (clue 2) and below the porch's 6 (clue 3), so it had 4. By clue 2, the bedroom had 2. That leaves the guest room with 4. By clue 5, Emil bought 4, so he entered for the nine patch, for his guest room. By clue 4, Jade entered for the wedding ring. By clue 1, the 2-ticket entrant took the star, so Jade bought 6, for the porch. Wren bought 2 tickets for the star quilt, for her bedroom, and Pablo took the log cabin, for his den.

Every stub matched Hattie's list. Wren, with just 2 tickets, won the star quilt, and it fit her bed exactly; she had measured twice.

77 · The Cider Press Batches

Marta: tart, anchor, 5 gallons

Priya: wild, moon, 10 gallons

Cyrus: sweet, star, 20 gallons

Felix: spicy, owl, 15 gallons

Key idea: Clues 1, 5 and 6 keep the owl, star and moon labels off 5 gallons, so the anchor went on the smallest batch.

Clue 1 keeps the owl off 5 gallons, clue 5 the star, and clue 6 the moon. So the anchor label made 5 gallons. The moon made neither 5 (clue 6) nor 20 (clue 1). By clue 7, Felix made 5 more than the moon, so 15 or 20. Clue 4 keeps Felix off 20, so Felix made 15 and the moon 10. Cyrus, above Felix, made 20. By clue 6, Marta made less than 10, so 5 gallons, with the anchor. Priya made 10, with the moon. The star made 15 or 20, so by clue 5 the spicy mix made 10 or 15. Clue 2 rules out 10, leaving Felix's 15. So by clue 5 the star made 20: Cyrus drew it. Felix, with 15, drew the owl. By clue 3, the tart made 5 gallons: Marta's. By clue 2, Priya's 10 gallons were wild, and Cyrus pressed the sweet.

Fifty gallons in all: Cyrus's sweet under a star, Felix's spicy under an owl, Priya's wild under a moon and Marta's tart under an anchor. Felix took his fair share.

78 · The Costume Parade

Mabel: scarecrow, taffy, 50 pieces

Otis: robot, licorice, 125 pieces

Hugo: mermaid, caramels, 100 pieces

Dot: pirate, gumdrops, 75 pieces

Key idea: Clues 5, 7 and 8 keep the scarecrow, mermaid and pirate off 125 pieces, so the robot handed out the most.

Clue 5 keeps the scarecrow off 125 pieces, clue 7 the mermaid, and clue 8 the pirate. So the robot handed out 125. By clue 1, the robot had caramels or licorice, not taffy. So by clue 6, the taffy was 50 and the licorice 125, the robot's. By clue 1, the mermaid had the caramels. Clue 7 keeps Otis off 50, so by clue 3 Mabel had the taffy, at 50. The mermaid's caramels came to 75 or 100 pieces. By clues 7 and 2, Otis handed out 125: he was the robot, with licorice. Clues 4 and 5 keep Hugo from the

pirate and the scarecrow, so Hugo was the mermaid with the caramels. Dot had the gumdrops. Hugo handed out 75 or 100. The scarecrow (clue 5) and the pirate (clue 8) both handed out fewer, so neither had 100. So Hugo handed out 100, and Dot 75. By clue 8, the pirate handed out 75: Dot. Mabel was the scarecrow.

The Gazette printed it straight: Otis the robot, 125 licorice; Hugo the mermaid, 100 caramels; Dot the pirate, 75 gumdrops; Mabel the scarecrow, 50 taffy. Mabel checked the commas.

79 · The Case of the Pie Server

Rosa: pecan, stage, 6:45 p.m.

Gus: pumpkin, cloakroom, 7:00 p.m.

Della: cherry, bake table, 6:15 p.m.

Vito: mince, kitchen, 6:00 p.m.

Imani: apple, porch, 6:30 p.m.

Answer: Gus slipped the pie server into a coat pocket. Key idea:

Clue 5 needs a time after the stage helper's, so clue 1 puts the stage at 6:45, pumpkin at 7:00 and mince at 6:00.

Clue 1 puts the stage helper at 6:45 or 7:00. Clue 5 needs a time 15 minutes after the stage, so the stage was 6:45. So the pumpkin pie's baker arrived at 7:00, and by clue 1 the mince pie's baker arrived at 6:00. Clue 2 keeps Della off the pecan pie, so by clue 3 Rosa baked the pecan pie and Della worked the bake table. Clue 8 keeps Della off the mince pie, so by clue 4 the mince pie's baker worked the kitchen. Clue 7 keeps the bake table off 7:00, so Della did not bake the pumpkin pie. By clue 8, she baked the cherry. Clue 8 keeps Gus off apple and mince, so he baked the pumpkin pie at 7:00. Clues 5 and 6 leave him the cloakroom. With 6:00, 6:45 and 7:00 taken, the bake table and porch share 6:15 and 6:30. By clue 7, Della came at 6:15. By clue 6, Imani worked the porch at 6:30, with the apple pie. Vito baked mince in the kitchen, and Rosa worked the stage.

Gus found the server on the cloakroom floor and tucked it into the nearest coat pocket to keep it safe for Hattie. Then the bidding on his pumpkin pie began, and he forgot.

80 · The Case of the Loose Mooring

Walt: parka, mail, 7:30 a.m.

Quinn: fleece, diesel, 8:00 a.m.

Bea: barn coat, coffee, 7:00 a.m.

Nico: slicker, ice, 6:00 a.m.

Hal: peacoat, bait, 6:30 a.m.

Answer: Nico untied the Ripple. Key idea: Clue 1 keeps the fleece off the mail errand, so by clue 8 mail went with the parka and 8:00 with the fleece.

Clue 1 keeps the mail errand off 8:00, so by clue 5 the 8:00 arrival came for diesel. By clue 8, mail went with the fleece or the parka. Clue 1 rules out the fleece, so mail went with the parka. By clue 8, the 8:00 arrival wore the fleece, so diesel went with the fleece. By clue 1, mail came at 7:30. Clue 2 puts Hal at 6:30 or 7:00, not mail's 7:30. So by clue 4, Walt came for mail in the parka, and Hal wore the peacoat. By clue 9, Bea came for coffee. With mail and diesel taken, clue 6 leaves the slicker only ice. The slicker was not Quinn's (clue 7), Walt's, Hal's or Bea's, since Bea came for coffee. So Nico wore the slicker and came for ice. Hal, at 6:30 or 7:00, came for bait, not diesel. Quinn came for diesel at 8:00 in the fleece; Bea wore the barn coat. By clue 2, Hal and Bea took 6:30 and 7:00, leaving Nico 6:00. Clue 3 keeps bait off 7:00: Hal 6:30, Bea 7:00.

Nico untied the Ripple at 6:00 to replace her frayed line, then went for ice and forgot to tie her back. He helped Felix patch the keel; the scrape grew with every telling.

81 · The Case of the Recipe Card

Selma: scone, patio, 9:00 a.m.

Priya: croissant, corner, 7:30 a.m.

Kenji: bagel, counter, 8:00 a.m.

Lou: muffin, window, 7:00 a.m.

Mabel: danish, booth, 8:30 a.m.

Answer: Lou pocketed the recipe card. Key idea: Clue 2 keeps Selma out of the window seat, so clue 9 puts Lou there, right beside the corkboard.

Clues 8, 1 and 3 rule out the muffin, bagel, scone and croissant for Mabel, so she ordered the danish. Clue 2 keeps Selma out of the window seat, so by clue 9 Lou sat there. Clue 11 keeps the bagel from the window. Lou had no scone (clue 1), croissant (clue 3), bagel or danish, so Lou had the muffin. By clue 5, Priya came at 7:30 or 8:00, and clue 4 makes it 7:30. So by clue 5, the bagel came at 8:00. Clue 7 keeps the muffin off 8:30, clue 2 the window off 9:00. With 7:30 and 8:00 taken, Lou came at 7:00. By clue 4, Kenji had the 8:00 bagel. By clue 3, Priya had the croissant, Selma the scone. Clue 7 keeps the scone off 8:30: Selma came at 9:00, Mabel at 8:30. By clue 10, the corner customer came in at 7:30: Priya. By clue 11, Kenji's bagel went to the counter. Clue 6 keeps Mabel, at 8:30, off the patio, so she sat in the booth and Selma on the patio.

Lou had pocketed the card to have it framed behind glass, safe from flour and fingers, as a surprise for Rosa. It came back the next week, and Gloria looked much relieved.

82 · The Case of the Copper Whale

Jade: rope, lost dog, 40

Arlo: wrench, stargazing, 50

Boris: ladder, sketching, 30

Cass: lantern, jogging, 20

Milo: crowbar, fishing, 60

Answer: Boris took down the copper whale, using the ladder. Key idea: Clue 4 allows the fishing excuse only 50 or 60, and clue 7 only 20 or 60, so the fishing excuse is 60.

By clue 4, the fishing excuse is 50 or 60; by clue 7, it is 20 or 60. So it is 60. By clue 7, Cass is 20. By clue 4, the sketching excuse is 30. Cass is not 50, so by clue 9 Arlo is 50 and Cass gave the jogging excuse. By clue 6, Boris was sketching, at 30. Arlo is 50, and clue 8 keeps Jade off fishing, so Milo was fishing, at 60. Jade, at 40, gave the lost dog excuse (clue 8); Arlo was stargazing. Milo is 60, so by clue 3 the rope is 40: Jade carried it. The ladder is younger than Jade's rope (clue 2) but older than the lantern (clue 1). So the ladder is 30 and the lantern 20. So Boris carried the ladder and Cass the lantern. Clue 5 keeps the wrench off 60, so Arlo had it and Milo the crowbar.

Boris had climbed up to sketch the whale and found its tail hanging by one rivet, so he carried it home to mend. He brought it back on Friday, and Felix pronounced it shipshape.

83 · The Case of the Crossword

Otis: red, popcorn, 6:30 p.m.

Faye: purple, almonds, 5:00 p.m.

Emil: black, pretzels, 5:30 p.m.

Tariq: green, grapes, 6:00 p.m.

Wren: blue, fudge, 7:00 p.m.

Answer: Tariq scrambled the crossword with the green pen. Key

idea: Clues 3, 7 and 8 leave the grapes only 6:00 or 6:30, so Wren came at 7:00: clue 1 gives 6:30 to Otis or Faye.

Clue 3 keeps the grapes off 5:00, clue 7 off 5:30, and clue 8 off 7:00. So the grapes came at 6:00 or 6:30. By clue 8, Wren came after 6:00. Clue 1 gives 6:30 to Otis or Faye, so Wren came at 7:00. By clue 2, the 5:30 visitor brought pretzels or almonds, so clue 6 puts the popcorn at 6:30. The grapes came at 6:00. Clues 7 and 3 put the almonds at 5:00. By clue 2, the 5:30 snack was pretzels, so Wren's 7:00 snack was fudge. By clue 5, the 6:00 visitor had blue or green; clue 7 keeps blue from the grapes. So the visitor with the grapes had green. Clue 7 keeps Otis from the 5:00 almonds, so by clue 1 Otis came at 6:30 with popcorn, and Faye at 5:00 with almonds. By clue 2, the visitor with the purple pen brought pretzels or almonds, but did not come at 5:30. So Faye had purple, and clue 7 leaves blue for Wren. Green went with the grapes, so by clue 4 Tariq had both, and the black pen's owner brought pretzels. Otis had popcorn, so Emil had black, Otis red.

Tariq mistook the proof for a spare copy and corrected three answers he was sure were wrong, in green ink. Ada changed them back and gave him a crossword of his own.

84 · The Case of the Wandering Key

Lena: lost cap, stove, 10:00 a.m.

Gus: permit, window, 1:00 p.m.

Nadia: mooring fee, desk, 9:00 a.m.

Sam: radio, map table, 11:00 a.m.

Teddy: tide chart, key wall, noon

Answer: Teddy borrowed the spare key. Key idea: Clues 4 and 7 put the permit at 1:00, and then clues 6, 7 and 8 leave the radio only 11:00.

Clues 1 and 3 put Sam at the map table. Clue 4 gives the permit noon or 1:00, and clue 7 rules out noon. The radio is not at 9:00 (clue 8), 10:00 (clue 6), noon (clue 7) or 1:00. So the radio came at 11:00. By clue 6, the 10:00 visitor asked about the lost cap, and the window visitor about the permit, at 1:00. By clue 5, the desk was at 9:00. By clue 8, the stove came before 11:00, so at 10:00, with the lost cap. Clue 2 keeps Teddy off the 1:00 permit, so by clue 9 Sam came before noon. Sam's map table was at 11:00, with the radio. So by clue 9 Teddy came at noon, and the only spot left at noon was the key wall. By clue 2, he asked about the tide chart. That leaves the mooring fee for the 9:00 visitor at the desk. By clue 10, Lena came at 10:00, by the stove. Clue 1 keeps Nadia off the window, so Nadia had the desk, Gus the window.

Teddy had borrowed the key to photograph the lantern room at sunset for his "150 Years of Light" series. He slipped it back early Friday, while Otis was out on the dock.

85 · The Case of the Silent Bell

Tova: cable, repairs, Wednesday

Linus: red, bats, Tuesday

Hattie: striped, dusting, Thursday

Gideon: plaid, pigeons, Friday

Pablo: argyle, the view, Monday

Answer: Tova muffled the bell with her cable-knit scarf. Key idea: Clues 2, 7, 8, 9 and 12 settle every climber's reason; then only Tova, the repairs climber, is free for Wednesday.

Clue 9 keeps Hattie from repairs, so by clue 8 she went up for dusting. By clue 12, Linus and Gideon had the bats and the pigeons. Clue 7 gives Linus the bats, so Gideon had the pigeons. That leaves repairs and the view for Tova and Pablo. Clue 2 gives Tova repairs, so Pablo went up for the view. Clue 1 puts the view on Monday or Tuesday. With clues 4, 5 and 10, only Tova is free for Wednesday. Linus and Pablo fill Monday and

Tuesday, so Hattie went up on Thursday and Gideon on Friday. Clues 3 and 11 give the pigeons the plaid scarf and the view the argyle. So Gideon wore plaid, and Pablo argyle. By clue 1, the striped scarf went up on Thursday or Friday. Friday was Gideon's plaid, so Hattie wore the striped scarf. By clue 1, Pablo went up on Monday, so Linus went on Tuesday. Clue 6 keeps the cable scarf off Linus: Tova wore cable, Linus red.

Tova had muffled the clapper on Wednesday so the bell would not clang while she mended the louvers, and then forgot her scarf. Hattie added "check the clapper" to her list.

86 · The Case of the Muddy Bootprints

Pearl: cowboy, history, 3:00 p.m.

Nico: rubber, maps, 2:30 p.m.

Milo: hiking, poetry, 1:30 p.m.

Greta: work, travel, 1:00 p.m.

Oscar: snow, cooking, 2:00 p.m.

Answer: Nico tracked in the mud with his rubber boots. Key idea:

Clues 3 and 4 put Greta at 1:00, so clue 8 gives 3:00 to Pearl and the work boots to Greta.

Clue 1 gives Nico the maps or travel, and clue 7 keeps him from travel. So Nico browsed the maps. Clue 3 keeps Greta off 2:30, so by clue 4 Greta came at 1:00 and the rubber boots at 2:30. By clue 8, the 3:00 patron was Pearl or Greta, so Pearl. Clue 8 then gives Greta the work boots. Pearl's 3:00 boots were not rubber, hiking (clue 7), snow (clue 6) or work. So Pearl wore cowboy boots. Oscar wore snow boots: clue 3 keeps him off the 2:30 rubber, clue 7 rules out hiking, and cowboy and work are taken. Clue 7 keeps Nico out of the hiking boots, so Nico wore rubber, at 2:30, and Milo wore hiking. By clue 6, Oscar's snow boots came at 2:00, the only time left for them. So Milo came at 1:30. Clue 2 puts history later than Milo's hiking boots, so by clue 5 Pearl had history and Milo poetry. Clue 7 gives Greta travel; Oscar, cooking.

Nico came straight off the boat, mud and all, to check a chart in the maps section and return an overdue whale book. He waxed Wren's floor again himself the next morning.

87 · The Case of the Vanishing Cameo

Mabel: cider, poems, 2:40 p.m.

Zeke: cocoa, almanac, 2:00 p.m.

Carmen: coffee, sea stories, 3:00 p.m.

Ivan: eggnog, cookbook, 2:20 p.m.

Basil: tea, mystery, 3:20 p.m.

Answer: Zeke tucked the cameo away. Key idea: If Basil sat down at 2:00, clues 3 and 9 would put both the coffee and the cocoa at 3:20, so Basil came at 3:20.

Clue 7 gives the mystery reader eggnog or tea, and clue 4 rules out eggnog. So the mystery went with the tea. By clue 3, Zeke sat down at 2:00 or 2:20, and the coffee at 3:00 or 3:20. Suppose Basil sat down at 2:00. Then Zeke took 2:20 (clue 3) and the coffee 3:20. But clue 9 puts the cocoa there, and one guest cannot drink both. So Basil did not sit down at 2:00. By clue 9, Basil came at 3:20 and the cocoa at 2:00. Clue 1 keeps Basil from coffee, so the coffee came at 3:00, and by clue 3 Zeke at 2:00, with the cocoa. The mystery's tea cannot be the 3:00 coffee, so by clue 6 the mystery took 3:20, Basil's time. By clue 2, Carmen read the sea stories at 3:00, with coffee. Clue 5 now puts the eggnog with the cookbook, and clue 8 keeps the poems off 2:00. So Zeke's 2:00 book was the almanac. By clue 8, the cookbook came at 2:20 and the poems at 2:40. Clue 4 keeps Mabel from eggnog, so Mabel had the poems and cider; Ivan, the cookbook.

Zeke had noticed the cameo's clasp was loose and took it to his room to mend, as a thank-you to Priya. He had marked his place in the almanac with the pouch.

88 · The Case of the Fast Clock

Amara: basket, fedora, 7:30 p.m.

Rosa: toolbox, cap, 7:00 p.m.

Kit: step stool, beret, 6:30 p.m.

Vito: umbrella, beanie, 8:00 p.m.

Otis: lantern, bonnet, 6:00 p.m.

Answer: Kit set the dock clock fast. Key idea: Clue 5 leaves Otis the cap or the bonnet, and supposing the cap leaves the lantern with no hat, so Otis wore the bonnet.

Clue 7 spans two hours, the whole evening, so Otis came at 6:00 p.m. and the umbrella at 8:00 p.m. Clues 1 and 2 give Kit the beret. Kit did not come at 7:00 (clue 1), 6:00 (Otis's) or 8:00 (the umbrella's, clue 6). The fedora came after the beret (clue 8) but not at 8:00 (clue 6), so Kit came at 6:30 and Rosa at 7:00 (clue 1). Suppose Otis wore the cap. The toolbox had the bonnet (clue 5), the 8:00 umbrella the beanie (clue 6), and the lantern no hat (clue 4). So by clue 5 Otis wore the bonnet and the toolbox the cap. By clue 4, Vito wore the beanie and Otis carried the lantern. The basket cannot come at 8:00 (the umbrella), so by clue 3 the cap came at 7:00 or earlier. Otis and Kit had other hats, so it was Rosa's. The fedora came after 6:30 (clue 8), not with the 7:00 cap or the 8:00 umbrella (clue 6), so at 7:30. Vito's beanie took 8:00. So Amara wore the fedora at 7:30, and by clue 3 she carried the basket. Rosa had the toolbox, and Kit carried the step stool.

Kit, tired of missing the ferry by a minute, climbed the step stool at 6:30 and set the clock ahead as a private hurry-up, never guessing Jonah set his watch by it.

89 · The Case of the Short Cash Box

Una: fudge, holly, 1 hour

Ruben: cocoa, star, 4 hours

Hattie: wreaths, snowman, 5 hours

Dev: candles, reindeer, 2 hours

Elsa: mittens, pinecone, 3 hours

Answer: Ruben made the wrong change at the cocoa table. Key

idea: Elsa worked 3 hours at candles or mittens; supposing candles gives the holly tag 3 hours and mittens only 2, which breaks clue 1.

Clue 9 keeps Una off 3 hours, so by clue 8 Elsa worked 3 hours and Una sold fudge. Una did not work 5 hours (clue 9), so by clue 5 the 5-hour volunteer sold wreaths. Clues 2, 3 and 9 keep the star off mittens, candles, wreaths and Una's fudge. So cocoa had it, and Dev the reindeer (clue 4). Clue 9 keeps Una and the star, and so cocoa, off 2 and 3 hours. So Elsa, with 3 hours, sold candles or mittens. Suppose Elsa sold candles. Then candles had 3 hours and, since Dev had the reindeer, the holly tag (clue 3). Only mittens was left for 2 hours, breaking clue 1. So Elsa sold mittens, with the pinecone tag (clue 2), and candles took 2 hours. Clues 1 and 7 give the holly tag 1 hour. By clue 9 the star worked 4 hours, so cocoa ran 4 hours. Una's fudge took 1 hour, with the holly tag. Candles then had Dev's reindeer (clue 3), and wreaths the snowman. Clue 6 keeps Ruben off wreaths, so Ruben ran cocoa and Hattie the wreaths.

Late in his four-hour cocoa shift, Ruben handed out change with two twenties stuck together by a drip of cocoa. The customer returned one on Monday, and Hattie happily crossed off that item.

90 · The Case of the Painted Buoys

Enzo: white, sponge, \$16

Della: purple, wide brush, \$14

Yusuf: black, spray can, \$12

Marta: teal, rag, \$8

Felix: yellow, roller, \$10

Answer: Della painted Nico's buoys purple. Key idea: If Yusuf spent \$8, the wide-brush buyer spent \$10 and the rag's buyer had nothing cheaper left, so Yusuf spent \$12.

Clue 5 keeps Yusuf off \$10 and \$14, and clue 8 off \$16. So the wide-brush buyer (clue 8) spent \$10 or \$14. Clue 6 keeps the white paint off the spray can, so by clue 1 white went with the sponge, and Yusuf took the spray can. The sponge's buyer spent \$16: clue 4 rules out the roller, clue 2 the rag; the wide brush and Yusuf's spray can are already out. Clue 3 puts Yusuf or Della at \$14, and clue 5 rules out Yusuf. So Della spent \$14, and Yusuf bought the black paint. By clue 7 the wide brush had the purple. Clue 9 keeps teal off the roller, so teal had the rag and yellow the roller. Suppose Yusuf spent \$8. Then the purple wide-brush buyer spent \$10 (clue 8), so the rag's buyer spent \$8 (clue 2). But that was Yusuf, with the spray can. So Yusuf spent \$12, and by clue 8 the wide-brush buyer spent \$14. That was Della, so Della bought the purple paint. With \$8 and \$10 left for the roller and rag, the roller's buyer spent \$10 (clue 9). Enzo spent \$16 (clue 4); clue 5 leaves Marta \$8, Felix \$10.

Della had offered to brighten the pier's spare buoys for the holidays and painted the wrong pile after dark. She bought Nico orange paint and helped him redo every one.

91 · The Case of the Lantern Room

Hugo: notebook, 4th landing, 6:00 p.m.

Jonah: field guide, 2nd landing, 4:00 p.m.

Wren: flashlight, 3rd landing, 5:30 p.m.

Teddy: sketchbook, 1st landing, 5:00 p.m.

Cass: thermos, top, 4:30 p.m.

Answer: Hugo climbed the tower after closing. **Key idea:** Clues 1, 2 and 8 give Cass the thermos; then testing Hugo at 5:00 p.m. breaks clue 7, so Hugo climbed at 6:00.

Clue 1 allows the flashlight the 3rd landing or the top; clue 2, the 2nd or 3rd. So the flashlight stopped at the 3rd. Clue 2 gives Jonah the 2nd landing, clue 1 gives Cass the top. By clue 8, Teddy took the 1st, and Cass the thermos. Clue 5 puts Cass at 4:30 or 5:30 p.m. Hugo came after Cass (clue 7), but not at 5:30 (clue 6), so 5:00 or 6:00. Clue 4 keeps Jonah, before the thermos, off 5:30 and 6:00. Clue 10 keeps the 1st landing, Teddy's, off them too. Suppose Hugo climbed at 5:00. Then Wren and Cass must take 5:30 and 6:00, so Cass climbed after Hugo, against clue 7. So Hugo climbed at 6:00 p.m. Wren came after the thermos (clue 3) but before 6:00, so Cass and the thermos came at 4:30. Only Wren is left for 5:30. Jonah came before the thermos, so at 4:00, and Teddy at 5:00. By clue 10, Hugo had the notebook. Jonah's 2nd landing rules out the flashlight, so clue 9 leaves him the field guide. Teddy had the sketchbook; Wren, the flashlight and 3rd landing; Hugo, the 4th landing.

Hugo, the newest volunteer, had left his glasses on the 4th landing on Monday and slipped back in at six on Tuesday in muddy boots, too embarrassed to say so. He never touched the lamp.

92 · The Case of the Jammed Press

Selma: red, bundling, 8:40 p.m.

Quinn: gray, sweeping, 8:00 p.m.

Milo: brown, folding, 8:20 p.m.

Imani: white, inking, 9:00 p.m.

Greta: green, proofing, 9:20 p.m.

Answer: The red mitten was Selma's. Key idea: Testing Imani at 8:40 p.m. puts Milo and Quinn both at 8:00, so Imani came at 9:00 and the times fall into place.

By clue 1, Milo or Greta came in at 9:20. Clue 5 puts Milo before Imani, so it was Greta, and Milo wore brown. Clue 9 keeps Imani out of the green mittens, so by clue 2 Greta wore green and Imani did the inking. So by clue 8 Milo did the folding, and by clue 4 whoever wore red did the bundling. Greta, in green, did not bundle, and clue 3 keeps the sweeping off 9:20. So Greta did the proofing. Clue 5 puts Imani at 8:40 or later, and clue 9 before Greta's 9:20, so at 8:40 or 9:00. Suppose Imani came in at 8:40. Then clue 5 puts Milo at 8:00, but clue 7 leaves Quinn only 8:00 as well. That cannot be. So Imani came in at 9:00 and Milo at 8:20. Clue 6 keeps Selma off 8:00, so Selma came at 8:40 and Quinn at 8:00. Clue 6 puts the gray mittens before Selma: Quinn's. Imani did the inking, so Selma wore red and did the bundling. Quinn swept; Imani wore white.

Selma had slipped off a red mitten to knot the twine on a bundle and set it on the press, where the rollers swallowed it. She had been hunting for it ever since.

93 · The Case of the Bottled Ship

Faye: anchors, brush, 45

Otis: knots, mitt, 35

Cyrus: lanterns, wand, 75

Bea: shells, chamois, 55

Jade: maps, cloth, 65

Answer: Otis moved the ship in a bottle. Key idea: Clues 1 and 7 give the 45-year-old the brush; then testing Jade at 55 leaves the lanterns no age, so Jade is 65.

Clue 1 gives the 45-year-old the brush or wand; clue 7, the cloth or brush. So it was the brush, and Jade had the cloth. By clue 5, Otis is 35. Clues 4 and 2 keep Jade's cloth off 35 and 75, and the brush has 45, so Jade is 55 or 65. By clue 4, the shells volunteer is not 35 and had the chamois or mitt, so is not 45 either. Clue 6 rules out 75. Suppose Jade is 55. Then the shells, which lack the cloth, are 65, and the maps 75 (clue 6). The lanterns, older than the cloth, have no age left. So Jade is 65, the shells

55, and the lanterns 75 (clue 2). By clue 6, the maps are 65: Jade's. Clue 3 gives Faye the anchors. The maps, shells and lanterns are not 35, so Otis dusted the knots. Faye is 45, with the brush. Together, clues 4 and 8 leave the chamois only the shells. So Otis had the mitt, and Cyrus dusted the lanterns (clue 8). So Bea dusted the shells with the chamois, at 55, and Cyrus, at 75, had the wand.

Otis had carried the Constance to the harbor office to count her tiny sails against an old chart, leaving a bowline in her place as a sailor's IOU. The ship was back before story hour.

94 · The Case of the Leaky Rowboat

Kenji: punt, bucket, 1:15 p.m.

Nico: skiff, anchor, 1:30 p.m.

Priya: dory, oars, 1:00 p.m.

Hal: canoe, net, 1:45 p.m.

Una: kayak, cooler, 2:00 p.m.

Answer: Kenji pulled the plug. Key idea: Priya came at 1:00 or 2:00; supposing 2:00 pushes the cooler and skiff early and leaves 1:45 no boat, so Priya came at 1:00.

Clue 3 gives the net to Nico or Hal, and clue 5 to Priya or Hal, so Hal brought it. Then Nico brought the anchor and Priya the oars. Clue 6 puts Hal's net at 1:00 or 1:45, and clue 4 keeps Hal off 1:00. So Hal came at 1:45, Kenji at 1:15 (clue 2). Clues 7, 8 and 10 leave 2:00 p.m. only the kayak. Clue 11 keeps Priya's oars off 1:30, so she came at 1:00 or 2:00. Suppose Priya came at 2:00. Her oars take 2:00 and Hal's net 1:45, so the cooler came by 1:30, and the skiff before it (clue 8). Clues 9 and 10 then leave 1:30 only the canoe, and 1:45 no boat at all. So Priya came at 1:00, not 2:00. Clue 1 keeps Nico off 2:00, so Nico came at 1:30 and Una at 2:00, with the kayak. Clue 1 then gives Hal the canoe. Clue 10 puts the punt at 1:15, Kenji's. Clue 9 keeps the dory off 1:30, so Priya hauled out the dory and Nico the skiff. Kenji and Una had the bucket and cooler. Clue 4 puts the bucket before Hal, so it was Kenji's, and Una brought the cooler. *Kenji pulled the drain plug on his hauled-out punt, then pulled the work rowboat's plug too, out of habit, not noticing she was still afloat. He helped Felix bail her out by dusk.*

95 · The Case of the Midnight Ovens

Emil: flowered, rolls, 70

Ruben: plaid, biscotti, 75

Mabel: blue, brownies, 65

Lou: striped, gingerbread, 60

Gus: white, fudge, 80

Answer: Lou baked the gingerbread at midnight. **Key idea:**

Supposing Ruben is 80 hands Emil and Ruben the flowered and white aprons, leaving Gus none; so Ruben is 75.

Clue 7 puts the striped apron at 60 and fudge at 80. Clue 5 keeps Gus off 60, so Gus's apron is not striped. Clue 2 makes Ruben 75 or 80; clue 4 makes Emil 70 or 80. Clue 10 gives the 70- and 80-year-olds the flowered and white aprons. Suppose Ruben is 80. Then Emil is 70 (clue 4), so between them they wear the flowered and white aprons (clue 10). But then Gus has no apron left: not blue (clue 9), not plaid (clue 5), not striped. So Ruben is 75. Clue 10 keeps blue and plaid off 70 and 80, and clue 9 keeps blue off Ruben. So blue is 65, and Ruben wears plaid. Emil, not in white (clue 4), wears flowered, so Gus wears white. Clue 5 makes Gus 80, with the fudge; Emil is 70. Clue 6 keeps gingerbread off Emil, at 70, so clue 8 gives it to Lou. Clues 3 and 1 keep brownies off Emil and Ruben. Mabel has the brownies; the rolls, Emil's or Ruben's, are 70 or 75. So clue 1 makes Mabel 65, in blue, and gives Emil the rolls. Lou is 60.

Lou's own oven had died mid-batch, so Lou used Rosa's spare key at midnight to finish gingerbread lighthouses for Hattie's holiday supper. Rosa forgave everything and asked for the icing recipe.

96 · The Harbor Office Sign-Out

Teddy: spare key, fingerless, 11:30 a.m.

Walt: life ring, leather, 11:00 a.m.

Amara: megaphone, wool, 10:00 a.m.

Selma: tide chart, fleece, 10:30 a.m.

Gus: binoculars, ski, noon

Answer: Teddy borrowed the spare lighthouse key. Key idea: Selma wore fingerless or fleece gloves; supposing fingerless leaves the tide chart's borrower no gloves at all, so she wore fleece.

Clue 3 puts Amara at 10:00 a.m. and Gus at noon. Clue 1 then puts Walt at 11:00 a.m., and the binoculars with Gus. By clue 2, Gus and the tide chart's borrower wore the ski and fleece gloves. By clue 5, Selma wore fingerless or fleece. Suppose Selma wore fingerless. Then the spare key's borrower wore fleece (clue 5), so Gus (binoculars) wore ski, leaving the tide chart's borrower no gloves. So Selma wore fleece, not fingerless. Gus wore ski, Selma took the tide chart (clue 2), and the spare key went with fingerless (clue 5). Clue 6 keeps Selma's fleece off 11:30 a.m., so she signed at 10:30 a.m., and Teddy at 11:30 a.m. Clue 4 keeps the leather gloves off Amara, and clue 6 keeps them off Teddy, so Walt wore leather. Clue 7 puts the megaphone before Walt's 11:00 a.m. Selma's 10:30 a.m. went with the tide chart, so the megaphone was Amara's. Walt's leather rules him out for the spare key, so Teddy took it, in fingerless gloves. Walt took the life ring; Amara wore wool.

Teddy signed out the spare key at 11:30 a.m., in fingerless gloves that left his fingers free for the camera. He wanted to photograph the Keeper's Lamp in the low winter light for his series.

97 · The Afternoon Boats

Nico: Teacup, the Narrows, 2:30 p.m.

Oscar: Pebble, Seal Ledge, 2:00 p.m.

Felix: Puffin, Gull Rock, 1:30 p.m.

Imani: Skipjack, East Cove, 3:00 p.m.

Teddy: Minnow, the Point, 3:30 p.m.

Answer: Teddy rowed out to Thimble Point. Key idea: Supposing Imani took the Minnow puts her at 3:30 p.m. and Felix at 3:00 p.m., leaving Teddy no later time; so Teddy took it.

Clue 1 gives the 3:30 p.m. rower the Puffin or Minnow; clue 2, the Teacup or Minnow. So the Minnow went at 3:30 p.m. So Nico took the Teacup (clue 2), and the Puffin went to Gull Rock (clue 1). Nico's Teacup did not go to Gull Rock, so clue 12 sends Nico to the Narrows and Felix to Gull Rock, in the Puffin. Clue 5 rules out Oscar for the Minnow, and Nico and Felix have other boats. Suppose Imani took it, at 3:30 p.m. Then clue 3 puts Felix at 3:00 p.m. But clue 9 needs Teddy after Felix, and 3:30 p.m. is taken. So Imani did not take the Minnow; Teddy did, at 3:30 p.m. Clues 4 and 8 give Nico 2:30 p.m. Clues 6 and 10 keep Teddy from East Cove and Seal Ledge: he went to the Point. East Cove came after Nico's Narrows (clue 11), so at 3:00 p.m. By clue 3 that was Imani, since Felix went to Gull Rock. Clue 4 puts Felix at 1:30 p.m. and Oscar at 2:00 p.m., bound for Seal Ledge. Clue 7 gives Oscar the Pebble, Imani the Skipjack.

Teddy pushed off last, at 3:30 p.m., and rowed the Minnow to Thimble Point, camera in his lap and the spare key in his pocket. He was back at the boatyard by half past four.

98 · The Ferry Dock Hand-Offs

Hattie: lantern, the inn, 5:40 p.m.

Jonah: spare key, the church, 6:20 p.m.

Pearl: pie tin, the library, 5:00 p.m.

Rosa: thermos, the bakery, 6:00 p.m.

Kenji: mail sack, the store, 5:20 p.m.

Answer: Jonah received the spare key at the ferry dock. Key idea:

Clues 7, 8 and 5 hand Jonah the key at 6:20 p.m.; then supposing he went to the bakery leaves the church no later time.

Clue 7 keeps Kenji off 6:20 p.m., so clue 8 puts Jonah there; clue 5 then gives Rosa 6:00 p.m. and Jonah the spare key. By clues 6, 4 and 9, Rosa had the thermos and Pearl the pie tin. Hattie and Kenji had the lantern and the mail sack. At 6:20 p.m., Jonah did not go on to the library (clue 1), the inn (clue 2) or the store (clue 10). Suppose Jonah went on to the bakery. Then clue 3 puts the inn at 6:00 p.m., and clue 2 leaves the church no later time. So Jonah went to the church. Clue 3 now keeps the inn before 6:00 p.m., so clue 7 keeps Kenji off 5:40 p.m. So clue 4 puts Hattie at 5:40 p.m., and keeps the mail sack off that time: Hattie had the lantern, Kenji the mail sack. Clue 10 puts the store at 5:20 p.m. The inn follows Kenji (clue 7), so it is Hattie's, at 5:40 p.m.; clue 3 puts the bakery, Rosa's, at 6:00 p.m. Clue 1 sends Pearl to the library, which leaves Kenji the store. So Kenji came at 5:20 p.m., and Pearl at 5:00 p.m.

Teddy, hurrying to the green, handed Jonah the spare key at 6:20 p.m. Jonah tucked it in his coat and promised to drop it at the harbor office after his stop at the church.

99 · The Moonlight Dinghy

Mabel: the beach, lantern, 7:20 p.m.

Priya: the slipway, penlight, 7:40 p.m.

Zeke: the seawall, flashlight, 8:20 p.m.

Jonah: the Point, headlamp, 8:00 p.m.

Linus: the pier, bike light, 7:00 p.m.

Answer: Jonah rowed out to Thimble Point after dark. Key idea:

Supposing Jonah had the penlight puts the headlamp at 7:40 p.m. and the penlight at Mabel's 7:20 p.m.; so Jonah had the headlamp.

Clue 7 puts the Point at 8:00 p.m. or later, so clue 3 puts it at 8:00 p.m. and Mabel at 7:20 p.m. Clue 7 then puts the pier at 7:00 p.m., and clue 5 puts the slipway at 7:40 p.m. By clue 4, Zeke came at 8:20 p.m., and Mabel, at 7:20 p.m., was on the beach. So Zeke was on the seawall. Clue 2 gives Jonah the headlamp or the penlight, and the 7:40 p.m. person the other. Suppose Jonah had the penlight. Then the headlamp came at 7:40 p.m., so the penlight came at 7:20 p.m. (clue 6): Mabel's time, not his. So Jonah had the headlamp, and the 7:40 p.m. person the penlight. By clue 6, Jonah came at 8:00 p.m.: he reached the Point. Clue 1 gives Linus the bike light, so he did not come at 7:40 p.m. He reached the pier at 7:00 p.m. Priya reached the slipway at 7:40 p.m. with the penlight. Clue 8 gives Mabel the lantern, and Zeke had the flashlight.

Jonah took Felix's dinghy from its slip and rowed out to Thimble Point by headlamp, landing at 8:00 p.m. The other four stayed on the shore, on foot, with their own lights.

100 · The Rehearsal on the Green

Lena: tickets, gray, 7:30 p.m. **Gideon:** choir, green, 8:00 p.m.

Wren: lanterns, navy, 8:30 p.m. **Hattie:** banners, red, 7:00 p.m.

Teddy: cocoa, camel, 9:00 p.m.

Answer: Teddy snapped the 9:00 p.m. photo. Key idea: Supposing Wren ran the banners puts Hattie on the lanterns in red and navy on the choir, leaving the green coat no job.

Clue 5 keeps Wren off 7:00 p.m., so clue 9 puts her at 8:30 p.m., and the green coat at 8:00 p.m. Clue 2 gives 7:00 and 8:00 p.m. to Gideon and Hattie, and clue 8 keeps Lena off 9:00 p.m. So Lena took 7:30 p.m. So Teddy took the 9:00 p.m. photo, and by clue 7 he ran the cocoa. Clues 6 and 1 put the choir at 7:30 or 8:00 p.m. So red, earlier than the choir (clue 1), was neither Wren's nor Teddy's. Suppose Wren ran the banners. Then Hattie ran the lanterns (clue 6), and red, barred from the choir and tickets (clues 1, 4), was hers. Then navy must be the choir's (clue 3), and clue 4 keeps green off the tickets, so the 8:00 p.m. green coat has no job. So Wren ran the lanterns, Hattie the banners. Clues 1, 4 and 6 make red Hattie's; it came before the choir, so she took 7:00 p.m. Gideon took 8:00 p.m., in green, so by clue 4 he ran the choir, Lena the tickets. Clue 3 puts Wren in navy; clue 8, Teddy in camel.

Teddy, in his camel coat and fresh from the cocoa table, snapped the 9:00 p.m. photo on the green, just as the light at Thimble Point went dark.

Putting It All Together

Answer: Jonah Bell.

Key idea. Facts 1 and 2 name the same two people. Fact 3 rules one of them out.

1. Fact 1: the person behind the Affair is the answer to Puzzle 96 (Teddy) or Puzzle 98 (Jonah).
2. Fact 2: the same person rowed to the Point, which again means Teddy (Puzzle 97) or Jonah (Puzzle 99). Both are still possible.
3. Fact 3 settles it. Teddy snapped the 9 p.m. photo on the green (Puzzle 100), so he could not have been in the lantern room at nine.
4. The only person who held the key, rowed to the Point, and could be at the lamp at 9 p.m. is Jonah Bell.

What really happened: Ada and her apprentice find Jonah at his ferry workshop with the lamp, its old reflector freshly re-silvered. The three blinks were his great-grandfather Silas Bell's "all's well" signal. The logbook went out to "S. Bell" on Silas's old library card, as a private joke. The flickers and the moved dinghy were Jonah's practice runs, the polished brass in November his first try at cleaning it, and his ferry, it turns out, is named the *Silas B.* That night the Keeper's Lamp gets its 150th-birthday lighting on time and shines brighter than anyone in Thimble Harbor can remember. Ada allows herself one exclamation mark: "Case closed, partner!"

Puzzle Index and Tracker

Tick each puzzle as you solve it, and fill in a ring for every hint you used.

No. Puzzle	Page	Stars	Done	Hints
1 Ada's Welcome Tea	6	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
2 The Seed Swap Envelopes	7	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
3 The Lunch Pail Mix-Up	8	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
4 The Rummage Sale Hats	9	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
5 The New Paper Route	10	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
6 The Muddled Umbrellas	11	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
7 Opening Day at the Light	12	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
8 The Sourdough Adoption	13	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
9 The Tulip Planting Gloves	14	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
10 The Unsigned Letters	15	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
11 The Regatta Pennants	22	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
12 The Swapped Jam Labels	23	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
13 The Book Drop Surprise	24	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
14 The Mother's Day Corsages	25	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
15 Kite Day Tangle	26	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
16 The Boatyard Paint Cans	27	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
17 The Rhubarb Social	28	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
18 The Buoys After the Storm	29	★☆☆☆☆	☐	○○○
19 The Memorial Day Floats	30	★★☆☆☆	☐	○○○
20 The Swapped Room Keys	32	★★☆☆☆	☐	○○○
21 The Spring Bird Count	34	★★☆☆☆	☐	○○○
22 The Lighthouse Paint Crew	36	★★☆☆☆	☐	○○○
23 The Ferry Lost-and-Found	38	★★☆☆☆	☐	○○○
24 The Garden Tour Signs	40	★★☆☆☆	☐	○○○

No.	Puzzle	Page	Stars	Done	Hints
25	Supper at the Clam Shack	42	★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
26	The Grown-Up Spelling Bee	44	★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
27	The Graduation Cakes	46	★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
28	The Tide Pool Walk	48	★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
29	The Water Day Photos	50	★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
30	The Borrowed Oars	52	★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
31	The Creamery Line	59	★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
32	The Fourth of July Parade	60	★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
33	The Twice-Punched Ticket	61	★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
34	The Sandcastle Row	62	★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
35	The Last Ear of Corn	63	★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
36	The Fireworks Blankets	64	★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
37	The Book Sale Early Birds	65	★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
38	The Committee Photo	66	★ ★ ☆ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
39	The Canoe-Sized Lobster	68	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
40	A Piano on the Ferry	70	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
41	The Blueberry Picking Map	72	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
42	Once Upon a Story Hour	74	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
43	A Flicker After Closing	76	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
44	Mostly Shipshape	78	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
45	Four Orders on the Back Shelf	80	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
46	Last Call for Pickles	82	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
47	Who Ate the Last Scone?	88	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
48	Who Let the Goat Out?	89	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
49	Who Tasted the Pie Early?	90	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
50	Who Sounded the Ferry Horn?	91	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○
51	Who Swapped the Quilt Ribbons?	92	★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆	☐	○○○

No.	Puzzle	Page	Stars	Done	Hints
52	Who Hid the Gavel?	93	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
53	Who Took the Postcards?	94	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
54	Who Borrowed the Berry Rake?	95	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
55	Who Unplugged the Ferris Wheel?	96	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
56	Who Salted the Lemonade?	97	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
57	Who Fed the Gulls?	98	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
58	Who Gave the Trophy a Mustache?	99	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
59	Apples by the Pound	106	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
60	The Elm Street Yard Sale	108	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
61	The Smudged Class Roll	110	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
62	The Fishing Derby Trophy	112	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
63	The Ferry Schedule Shuffle	114	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
64	The Whispered Fines	116	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
65	The Pumpkin Weigh-Off	118	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
66	The Harvest Supper Arrivals	120	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
67	The Corn Maze Chalkboard	122	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
68	The Sticky Auction Receipts	124	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
69	The Lobster Trap Tally	126	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
70	The Apple Pie Bake-Off	128	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
71	The Hiking Club Summits	130	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
72	The Gazette Ad Rates	132	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
73	The Lamp Fund Jar	134	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
74	The Firewood Orders	136	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
75	The Harvest Shuttle Fares	138	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
76	The Quilt Raffle	140	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
77	The Cider Press Batches	142	★★★★☆	☐	○○○

No.	Puzzle	Page	Stars	Done	Hints
78	The Costume Parade	144	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
79	The Case of the Pie Server	152	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
80	The Case of the Loose Mooring	154	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
81	The Case of the Recipe Card	156	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
82	The Case of the Copper Whale	158	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
83	The Case of the Crossword	160	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
84	The Case of the Wandering Key	162	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
85	The Case of the Silent Bell	164	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
86	The Case of the Muddy Footprints	166	★★★★☆	☐	○○○
87	The Case of the Vanishing Cameo	168	★★★★★	☐	○○○
88	The Case of the Fast Clock	170	★★★★★	☐	○○○
89	The Case of the Short Cash Box	172	★★★★★	☐	○○○
90	The Case of the Painted Buoys	174	★★★★★	☐	○○○
91	The Case of the Lantern Room	176	★★★★★	☐	○○○
92	The Case of the Jammed Press	178	★★★★★	☐	○○○
93	The Case of the Bottled Ship	180	★★★★★	☐	○○○
94	The Case of the Leaky Rowboat	182	★★★★★	☐	○○○
95	The Case of the Midnight Ovens	184	★★★★★	☐	○○○
96	The Harbor Office Sign-Out	188	★★★★★	☐	○○○
97	The Afternoon Boats	190	★★★★★	☐	○○○
98	The Ferry Dock Hand-Offs	192	★★★★★	☐	○○○
99	The Moonlight Dinghy	194	★★★★★	☐	○○○
100	The Rehearsal on the Green	196	★★★★★	☐	○○○

Clue Language at a Glance

What each kind of clue lets you mark.

- **"Gus brought the cherry pie."** A dot. Then X the rest of that row and that column.
- **"Gus did not bring the cherry pie."** One X.
- **"Gus brought either the apple or the cherry pie."** X every other pie in Gus's row. Come back later: once one of the two is ruled out, the other is a dot.
- **"Gus brought neither the apple nor the cherry pie."** Two X's.
- **"Of Gus and Rosa, one brought the apple pie and the other the cherry pie."** Gus and Rosa are different people. Each of them has apple or cherry, so X their other pies. Nobody else has apple or cherry. When you learn one of them, the other follows.
- **"Gus, Rosa and the peach pie's baker are three different people."** Put an X wherever two of them meet in the grid.
- **"Gus arrived later than Rosa."** Gus is not first, Rosa is not last, and they are different people.
- **"Gus arrived exactly two hours after Rosa."** A fixed gap. If you know one time, you know the other.
- **"Gus stood right behind Rosa."** No gap. Gus is not first, Rosa is not last.
- **"Gus stood next to Rosa."** Right in front of or right behind, either one.
- **"Gus stood at one end of the line."** First or last.

- **"The cherry pie's baker is not Gus."** The same as "Gus did not bring the cherry pie." Clues can name either side.

Common Mistakes and Quick Repairs

Placing a dot without its X's. Every dot means X for the rest of its row and column in that box. If you skip this, a later “only choice left” can look like two choices.

Reading “before” as “right before.” “Earlier than” leaves room for others in between. Only “right before,” “right behind” and the like mean no gap, and “one hour after” means exactly one step later.

Forgetting to carry. When a row in one box is settled, look at the other boxes. If Rosa has the tin and the tin holds the fig jam, Rosa made the fig jam.

Using a clue once and never again. Comparison and either-or clues often say more later. When you are stuck, read every clue again.

Filling a square because it “feels right.” A blank square means undecided. Mark only what a clue, or the rest of a row, forces.

Two dots in one row. Something went wrong earlier. Find the most recent mark that was not forced by a clue, erase back to it, and try again. This is why we use pencil.

A Suppose that “worked.” If testing an idea does not lead to a contradiction, it proves nothing. Erase it and test a different square.

Make Your Own Puzzle

Puzzle setters work backward. Here is the method I used for forty-one years.

1. **Choose a small world.** Three neighbors and two kinds of things are plenty: say, pies and jars.
2. **Write the answer first.** Fill in an answer table: who has what.
3. **Write a clue that is true.** “Hattie did not use the tin.”
4. **Solve your own puzzle with only the clues** on a blank grid. Where you get stuck, add one more true clue.
5. **Keep going until the clues lead to exactly one answer.** If you ever have a choice left at the end, you need another clue.
6. **Remove any clue you never used.** A good puzzle has no spare parts.
7. **Hand it to a friend.** If they get stuck, their sticking point is where your next hint goes.

There are blank grids on the following pages. You may copy them for your own use.

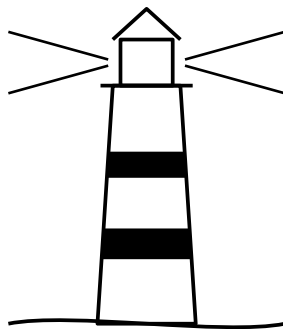
Blank Grids

For making your own puzzles or re-solving a favorite. You may copy these pages for your own use.

Category 1			Category 2		
Names					
Category 2					

[illegible]

	Category 1	Category 2	Category 3
Names			
Category 3			
Category 2			



THE THIMBLE HARBOR GAZETTE

Honorary Detective

This certifies that

has solved all one hundred cases of
Cozy Mystery Logic Puzzles for Beginners
and is hereby welcome at the puzzle desk any time.

Ada Quill, Puzzle Editor (retired)

Date

Until Next Time

That is the end of the season, partner, and of this book. Thank you for keeping me company at the puzzle desk.

If you enjoyed these puzzles, the next book in the series takes us into a new year in Thimble Harbor, with bigger grids, trickier clues, and more of the neighbors you know. Watch for *The Thimble Harbor Puzzle School, Book 2*.

If you have a moment, an honest review helps other puzzle lovers find this book, and it helps me make the next one better. Tell people what you liked and what you would change.

Until then, keep your pencil sharp.

Ada